

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T13:25:35

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_013_neutral_rep03_myth_game_normative_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 3
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_normative
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_normative
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_normative
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$5.18; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5.18, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9.82; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.45, received visible=\$10.35, returned visible=\$4.08

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.18, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.18}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.18,
"Agent_2": 9.82

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.08,
"Agent_2": 5.170000000000002

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:15:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water trip led as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

Key themes in the trust game:

- Initial act of faith (sending money)
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- Reciprocity and fairness
- Mutual benefit vs. self-interest
- Trust building

I should write a myth that illustrates these principles. Let me think of a mythic story that could represent this:

- Option 1: A story about two villages sharing water/resources
- Option 2: A story about gods/spirits and reciprocal offerings
- Option 3: A story about travelers helping each other
- Option 4: A story about a river/spring that multiplies gifts

I'll go with something about reciprocal giving and the multiplication of generosity. Let me craft this carefully to be exactly around 200 words.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 495,
  "reasoning_tokens": 242
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:15:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
}
```

```

    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. The trust game involves sending money that gets multiplied, and then receiving returns. The key themes are:

- Trust
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit
- Cooperation

I should create a myth that illustrates these principles in a way that encourages fair play and mutual cooperation. Let me think of a mythic framing...

I could use:

- Two deities or beings who must cooperate
- A gift that multiplies
- The importance of returning gifts
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth about this:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 420,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 157  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:16:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

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- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
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- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain—one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

Key themes in the trust game:

- Initial act of faith (sending money)
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- Reciprocity and fairness
- Mutual benefit vs. self-interest
- Trust building

I should write a myth that illustrates these principles. Let me think of a mythic story that could represent this:

- Option 1: A story about two villages sharing water/resources
- Option 2: A story about gods/spirits and reciprocal offerings
- Option 3: A story about travelers helping each other
- Option 4: A story about a river/spring that multiplies gifts

I'll go with something about reciprocal giving and the multiplication of generosity. Let me craft this carefully to be exactly around 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 495,
  "reasoning_tokens": 242
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: the first village demonstrated bold trust by giving despite their own scarcity, and this trust was rewarded through reciprocity.

The Fountain of Echoes teaches that:

- Initial generosity multiplies resources (just as my sent amount triples)
- Trust must come first to enable the cycle of abundance
- Reciprocity follows when trust is shown

Following the spirit of the myth, where the first village gave their "precious jar" despite drought, I should demonstrate maximum trust to create the greatest possible shared abundance.

****{"send": 5}****

By sending all \$5, I create \$15 total value (after the 3x multiplication). This mirrors the first village's faithful offering into the fountain. The myth shows that such trust, when met with gratitude and fair return, creates a sustainable cycle of prosperity for both parties. I trust that the receiver, having read the same myth, understands that reciprocity-returning generously-is what sustains the spring and ensures mutual benefit.

Reasoning:

In this round, I am the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The key messages were:

1. Trust multiplies resources (the water triples in the fountain)
2. Reciprocity sustains the relationship (the second village returned generously)
3. The first village gave despite their hardship, trusting their neighbors
4. The second village returned 2 out of 3 jars - which is about 67% return rate
5. "Give with faith, return with gratitude" - both villages benefited from this cycle

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Initial trust and generosity (the first village gave "one precious jar" even though they had little)
- The expectation that this trust will be reciprocated
- A long-term perspective where both parties can benefit

In the game mechanics:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- I keep: \$5 - X + returned amount
- Receiver keeps: \$3X - returned amount

Following the myth's guidance, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The first village in my myth gave despite their scarcity, showing faith.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return generously (like 2/3 of what they received, following the myth), they'd return about \$10
- I'd end up with \$0 + \$10 = \$10
- They'd keep \$5
- Total: \$15 (maximized)

If I send \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return 2/3, they'd return \$6
- I'd end up with \$2 + \$6 = \$8
- They'd keep \$3
- Total: \$11

The myth suggests bold trust as the path to mutual prosperity. I should send a substantial amount to signal trust and cooperation. Given that the myth emphasized giving generously despite hardship, I'll send \$5 to fully embody the spirit of the fountain myth.

Sending everything maximizes what's available for both of us to share-\$15 total rather than a smaller pool-and aligns with the fountain's core principle that trust creates abundance.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 711,
  "output_tokens": 733,
  "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:16:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. The trust game involves sending money that gets multiplied, and then receiving returns. The key themes are:

- Trust
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit
- Cooperation

I should create a myth that illustrates these principles in a way that encourages fair play and mutual cooperation. Let me think of a mythic framing...

I could use:

- Two deities or beings who must cooperate
- A gift that multiplies
- The importance of returning gifts
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth about this:

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 392,
"output_tokens": 420,
"reasoning_tokens": 157
}
```

Message 4 role=user
content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that is 69.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.350000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.350000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the lesson is clear: when Sendara sent half her waters downstream in trust, Recivos returned half of what he received, ensuring both spirits prospered and the sender gained more than they had given.

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.45 (69% of their endowment) - even more generous than the 50% in the myth. This generosity should be honored.

Following the principle from the myth where Recivos "sent back half of what he received," I will return approximately half of what I received.

****Analysis:****

- Sender started with: \$5.00
- Sender sent: \$3.45 (keeping \$1.55)
- I received: \$10.35
- If I return ~\$5.18, the sender ends with: $\$1.55 + \$5.18 = \$6.73$
- I keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

This ensures the sender gains significantly from their trust (\$6.73 vs \$5.00 initial), while I also prosper. This maintains the "sacred exchange" the myth describes, where both parties flourish beyond what either could achieve alone.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.18}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.45 out of \$5, which is 69% - a very generous amount. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$10.35.

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the key lesson is:

- Sendara (the sender) sent half her waters
- Recivos (the receiver) sent back half of what he received
- This created a mutually beneficial cycle where both prospered
- The sender ended up with MORE than they started with, and the receiver still had plenty

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.45, keeping \$1.55
- I received \$10.35
- If I return half of what I received: $\$10.35 / 2 = \5.175

This would give the sender: $\$1.55 + \$5.175 = \$6.725$ (more than they started with)
And I would keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.175 = \$5.175$

This follows the myth's principle: "Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered."

The sender was very generous (69% is well above 50%), showing strong trust. The myth emphasizes that when someone shows trust and generosity, it should be reciprocated to maintain the "sacred exchange."

Given the sender sent 69% (more than half), I should probably return a fair amount. Returning half (\$5.175) seems appropriate and aligns with the myth's teaching.

Actually, let me reconsider. The sender sent 69%, not exactly 50%. They were MORE generous than the mythical Sendara. Perhaps I should be proportionally generous too?

If I return around half, that honors the spirit of reciprocity in the myth. \$5.175 ensures the sender profits significantly from their trust (\$6.725 vs \$5 start), and I also gain significantly (\$5.175 vs \$0 start).

I'll send back \$5.18 to round up slightly and demonstrate genuine reciprocity.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 746,  
  "output_tokens": 773,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 452  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain—one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken—by sending too little or returning nothing—the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.
*

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3.5; received \$10.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$10.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

```

    Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 10.5, "min": 0, "raw":
    0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 15.68,
  "Agent_2": 11.32
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 4.08,
  "Agent_2": 6.6700000000000002
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:16:42
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {

```

```

  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. The trust game involves sending money that gets multiplied, and then receiving returns. The key themes are:

- Trust
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit
- Cooperation

I should create a myth that illustrates these principles in a way that encourages fair play and mutual cooperation. Let me think of a mythic framing...

I could use:

- Two deities or beings who must cooperate
- A gift that multiplies
- The importance of returning gifts
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth about this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 420,
  "reasoning_tokens": 157
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that is 69.0% of their total endowme

nt. You received \$10.350000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.350000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the lesson is clear: when Sendara sent half her waters downstream in trust, Recivos returned half of what he received, ensuring both spirits prospered and the sender gained more than they had given.

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.45 (69% of their endowment) - even more generous than the 50% in the myth. This generosity should be honored.

Following the principle from the myth where Recivos "sent back half of what he received," I will return approximately half of what I received.

****Analysis:****

- Sender started with: \$5.00
- Sender sent: \$3.45 (keeping \$1.55)
- I received: \$10.35
- If I return ~\$5.18, the sender ends with: $\$1.55 + \$5.18 = \$6.73$
- I keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

This ensures the sender gains significantly from their trust (\$6.73 vs \$5.00 initial), while I also prosper. This maintains the "sacred exchange" the myth describes, where both parties flourish beyond what either could achieve alone.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.18}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.45 out of \$5, which is 69% - a very generous amount. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$10.35.

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the key lesson is:

- Sendara (the sender) sent half her waters
- Recivos (the receiver) sent back half of what he received
- This created a mutually beneficial cycle where both prospered
- The sender ended up with MORE than they started with, and the receiver still had plenty

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.45, keeping \$1.55
- I received \$10.35
- If I return half of what I received: $\$10.35 / 2 = \5.175

This would give the sender: $\$1.55 + \$5.175 = \$6.725$ (more than they started with)

And I would keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.175 = \$5.175$

This follows the myth's principle: "Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered."

The sender was very generous (69% is well above 50%), showing strong trust. The myth emphasizes that when someone shows trust and generosity, it should be reciprocated to maintain the "sacred exchange."

Given the sender sent 69% (more than half), I should probably return a fair amount. Returning half (\$5.175) seems appropriate and aligns with the myth's teaching.

Actually, let me reconsider. The sender sent 69%, not exactly 50%. They were MORE generous than the mythical Sendara. Perhaps I should be proportionally generous too?

If I return around half, that honors the spirit of reciprocity in the myth. \$5.175 ensures the sender profits significantly from their trust (\$6.725 vs \$5 start), and I also gain significantly (\$5.175 vs \$0 start).

I'll send back \$5.18 to round up slightly and demonstrate genuine reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 746,  
  "output_tokens": 773,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 452  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But c

hooose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Reasoning:

Looking at the game history:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of endowment). I received \$10.35 and returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received).

Both myths emphasize trust, reciprocity, and fair exchange. The other agent's myth suggests returning "two jars" out of three received - which would be about 67% return rate. My myth suggested returning "half of what he received" - which is 50%.

In practice, I returned about 50%. The sender was quite generous (69%), and I reciprocated fairly.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Keep the core lesson about trust and reciprocity
2. Reflect the actual play (generous sending, fair returning)
3. Perhaps refine the specific guidance based on what worked
4. Keep it at 200 words

I'll create a new myth that builds on the Twin Rivers but adds new elements reflecting the experience of the first round.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1664,
  "output_tokens": 517,
  "reasoning_tokens": 225
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:16:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain—one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

Key themes in the trust game:

- Initial act of faith (sending money)
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- Reciprocity and fairness
- Mutual benefit vs. self-interest
- Trust building

I should write a myth that illustrates these principles. Let me think of a mythic story that could represent this:

Option 1: A story about two villages sharing water/resources

Option 2: A story about gods/spirits and reciprocal offerings

Option 3: A story about travelers helping each other

Option 4: A story about a river/spring that multiplies gifts

I'll go with something about reciprocal giving and the multiplication of generosity. Let me craft this carefully to be exactly around 200 words.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 495,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 242  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: the first village demonstrated bold trust by giving despite their own scarcity, and this trust was rewarded through reciprocity.

The Fountain of Echoes teaches that:

- Initial generosity multiplies resources (just as my sent amount triples)
- Trust must come first to enable the cycle of abundance
- Reciprocity follows when trust is shown

Following the spirit of the myth, where the first village gave their "precious jar" despite drought, I should demonstrate maximum trust to create the greatest possible shared abundance.

****{"send": 5}****

By sending all \$5, I create \$15 total value (after the 3x multiplication). This mirrors the first village's faithful offering into the fountain. The myth shows that such trust, when met with gratitude and fair return, creates a sustainable cycle of prosperity for both parties. I trust that the receiver, having read the same myth, understands that reciprocity-returning generously-is what sustains the spring and ensures mutual benefit.

reasoning:

In this round, I am the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The key messages were:

1. Trust multiplies resources (the water triples in the fountain)
2. Reciprocity sustains the relationship (the second village returned generously)
3. The first village gave despite their hardship, trusting their neighbors
4. The second village returned 2 out of 3 jars - which is about 67% return rate
5. "Give with faith, return with gratitude" - both villages benefited from this cycle

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Initial trust and generosity (the first village gave "one precious jar" even though they had little)
- The expectation that this trust will be reciprocated
- A long-term perspective where both parties can benefit

In the game mechanics:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- I keep: \$5 - X + returned amount
- Receiver keeps: \$3X - returned amount

Following the myth's guidance, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The first village in my myth gave despite their scarcity, showing faith.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return generously (like 2/3 of what they received, following the myth), they'd return about \$10
- I'd end up with \$0 + \$10 = \$10
- They'd keep \$5
- Total: \$15 (maximized)

If I send \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return 2/3, they'd return \$6
- I'd end up with \$2 + \$6 = \$8
- They'd keep \$3
- Total: \$11

The myth suggests bold trust as the path to mutual prosperity. I should send a substantial amount to signal trust and cooperation. Given that the myth emphasized giving generously despite hardship, I'll send \$5 to fully embody the spirit of the fountain myth.

Sending everything maximizes what's available for both of us to share-\$15 total rather than a smaller pool-and aligns with the fountain's core principle that trust creates abundance.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 711,  
  "output_tokens": 733,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 516  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (maximum trust)
- The receiver got \$15 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to see what they returned to write a myth that reflects the actual gameplay

Actually, looking at the prompt again, I'm being asked to write a myth BEFORE seeing the return. So I should write based on:

1. My myth about the Fountain of Shared Waters
2. The other agent's myth about the Twin Rivers
3. My decision to send \$5 (full trust)

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- Reciprocity
- Fair return (the other myth suggests "sending back half of what received")
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- Warnings about betrayal/breaking trust

My new myth should:

- Reflect that I sent the full amount (maximum trust)
- Incorporate elements from both previous myths

- Potentially acknowledge the "communication noise" mentioned in the setup
- Set expectations for fair reciprocity

Let me write a myth that builds on these themes while adding my own perspective based on the game so far.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1572,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 274
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:17:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. The trust game involves sending money that gets multiplied, and then receiving returns. The key themes are:

- Trust
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit
- Cooperation

I should create a myth that illustrates these principles in a way that encourages fair play and mutual cooperation. Let me think of a mythic framing...

I could use:

- Two deities or beings who must cooperate
- A gift that multiplies
- The importance of returning gifts
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth about this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 420,
  "reasoning_tokens": 157
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that is 69.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.350000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.350000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the lesson is clear: when Sendara sent half her waters downstream in trust, Recivos returned half of what he received, ensuring both spirits prospered and the sender gained more than they had given.

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.45 (69% of their endowment) - even more generous than the 50% in the myth. This generosity should be honored.

Following the principle from the myth where Recivos "sent back half of what he received," I will return approximately half of what I received.

****Analysis:****

- Sender started with: \$5.00
- Sender sent: \$3.45 (keeping \$1.55)
- I received: \$10.35
- If I return ~\$5.18, the sender ends with: $\$1.55 + \$5.18 = \$6.73$
- I keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

This ensures the sender gains significantly from their trust (\$6.73 vs \$5.00 initial), while I also prosper. This maintains the "sacred exchange" the myth describes, where both parties flourish beyond what either could achieve alone.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.18}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.45 out of \$5, which is 69% - a very generous amount. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$10.35.

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the key lesson is:

- Sendara (the sender) sent half her waters
- Recivos (the receiver) sent back half of what he received
- This created a mutually beneficial cycle where both prospered
- The sender ended up with MORE than they started with, and the receiver still had plenty

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.45, keeping \$1.55
- I received \$10.35
- If I return half of what I received: $\$10.35 / 2 = \5.175

This would give the sender: $\$1.55 + \$5.175 = \$6.725$ (more than they started with)

And I would keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.175 = \$5.175$

This follows the myth's principle: "Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered."

The sender was very generous (69% is well above 50%), showing strong trust. The myth emphasizes that when someone shows trust and generosity, it should be reciprocated to maintain the "sacred exchange."

Given the sender sent 69% (more than half), I should probably return a fair amount. Returning half (\$5.175) seems appropriate and aligns with the myth's teaching.

Actually, let me reconsider. The sender sent 69%, not exactly 50%. They were MORE generous than the mythical Sendara. Perhaps I should be proportionally generous too?

If I return around half, that honors the spirit of reciprocity in the myth. \$5.175 ensures the sender profits significantly from their trust (\$6.725 vs \$5 start), and I also gain significantly (\$5.175 vs \$0 start).

I'll send back \$5.18 to round up slightly and demonstrate genuine reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 746,  
"output_tokens": 773,  
"reasoning_tokens": 452  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yours

elf from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

reasoning:

Looking at the game history:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of endowment). I received \$10.35 and returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received).

Both myths emphasize trust, reciprocity, and fair exchange. The other agent's myth suggests returning "two jars" out of three received - which would be about 67% return rate. My myth suggested returning "half of what he received" - which is 50%.

In practice, I returned about 50%. The sender was quite generous (69%), and I reciprocated fairly.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Keep the core lesson about trust and reciprocity
2. Reflect the actual play (generous sending, fair returning)
3. Perhaps refine the specific guidance based on what worked
4. Keep it at 200 words

I'll create a new myth that builds on the Twin Rivers but adds new elements reflecting the experience of the first round.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1664,
  "output_tokens": 517,
  "reasoning_tokens": 225
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that was 69.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.350000000000001. You returned \$5.18. So your payoff was 5.170000000000002. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.170000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender demonstrated strong trust by sending \$3.45 (69%)
- I followed the myth's teaching and returned 50% (\$5.18)
- The sender profited well from their generosity (\$6.73 total)
- I also prospered (\$5.17)

****What the Myths Teach:****

Both myths emphasize "give boldly" and that generous giving with fair returns creates mutual prosperity. My updated myth specifically states: "**Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.**" The first wanderer poured "more than half their water."

****My Decision:****

Now that I'm the sender, I should honor the trust shown to me and maintain the sacred exchange. The other player sent 69% in Round 1, demonstrating significant generosity. I should reciprocate with similar boldness.

Following the principle to "give boldly" and matching the trust they showed me, I will send approximately 70% of my endowment.

If they return fairly (around 50%, as I did), we'll both continue to prosper beyond what we could achieve alone-exactly as the myths teach.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1 and what my myths teach:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.45 (69% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.45 + \$5.18 = \6.73
- I kept: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

My myths teach:

1. First myth: Sendara sent half her waters, Recivos returned half of what he received. Both prospered.
2. Second myth (adapted): The first wanderer poured "more than half their water," the second returned half, and both prospered. Key lesson: "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together."

The other agent's myth taught: Pour back two jars when receiving three - essentially returning about 2/3 of what was received, honoring both the gift and the trust.

Now I'm the SENDER. The key question is: how much should I send?

My myths emphasize:

- "Give boldly"
- Sendara gave half
- The wanderer gave "more than half"
- "Trust multiplies resources"
- "Generosity multiplied returns greater"

The other player sent me \$3.45 (69%). They demonstrated significant trust. I returned 50% of what I received, which followed my myth's guidance and gave them a good return.

If I want to maintain the "sacred exchange" and follow the teaching "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together," I should send a generous amount.

Given that:

- The other player sent 69% in Round 1
- My myth says to give "boldly" and the wanderer gave "more than half"
- Both myths emphasize trust and generosity

I should send at least half, probably around 60-70% to match or slightly approach their generosity from Round 1.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) mirrors their commitment and aligns with my myth's call to give boldly. If they reciprocate with a fair return of around 50%, I'd receive roughly \$5.25, bringing my total to approximately \$6.75-a solid mutual outcome that honors the pattern we've established.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2077,
  "output_tokens": 979,
  "reasoning_tokens": 502
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:17:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain—one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

Key themes in the trust game:

- Initial act of faith (sending money)
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- Reciprocity and fairness
- Mutual benefit vs. self-interest
- Trust building

I should write a myth that illustrates these principles. Let me think of a mythic story that could represent this:

- Option 1: A story about two villages sharing water/resources
- Option 2: A story about gods/spirits and reciprocal offerings
- Option 3: A story about travelers helping each other
- Option 4: A story about a river/spring that multiplies gifts

I'll go with something about reciprocal giving and the multiplication of generosity. Let me craft this carefully to be exactly around 200 words.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 495,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 242  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: the first village demonstrated bold trust by giving despite their own scarcity, and this trust was rewarded through reciprocity.

The Fountain of Echoes teaches that:

- Initial generosity multiplies resources (just as my sent amount triples)
- Trust must come first to enable the cycle of abundance
- Reciprocity follows when trust is shown

Following the spirit of the myth, where the first village gave their "precious jar" despite drought, I should demonstrate maximum trust to create the greatest possible shared abundance.

```
**{"send": 5}**
```

By sending all \$5, I create \$15 total value (after the 3x multiplication). This mirrors the first village's faithful offering into the fountain. The myth shows that such trust, when met with gratitude and fair return, creates a sustainable cycle of prosperity for both parties. I trust that the receiver, having read the same myth, understands that reciprocity-returning generously-is what sustains the spring and ensures mutual benefit.

reasoning:

In this round, I am the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The key messages were:

1. Trust multiplies resources (the water triples in the fountain)
2. Reciprocity sustains the relationship (the second village returned generously)
3. The first village gave despite their hardship, trusting their neighbors
4. The second village returned 2 out of 3 jars - which is about 67% return rate
5. "Give with faith, return with gratitude" - both villages benefited from this cycle

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Initial trust and generosity (the first village gave "one precious jar" even though they had little)
- The expectation that this trust will be reciprocated
- A long-term perspective where both parties can benefit

In the game mechanics:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- I keep: $\$5 - X + \text{returned amount}$
- Receiver keeps: $\$3X - \text{returned amount}$

Following the myth's guidance, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The first village in my myth gave despite their scarcity, showing faith.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return generously (like 2/3 of what they received, following the myth), they'd return about \$10
- I'd end up with $\$0 + \$10 = \$10$
- They'd keep \$5
- Total: \$15 (maximized)

If I send \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return 2/3, they'd return \$6
- I'd end up with $\$2 + \$6 = \$8$
- They'd keep \$3
- Total: \$11

The myth suggests bold trust as the path to mutual prosperity. I should send a substantial amount to signal trust and cooperation. Given that the myth emphasized giving generously despite hardship, I'll send \$5 to fully embody the spirit of the fountain myth.

Sending everything maximizes what's available for both of us to share-\$15 total rather than a smaller pool-and aligns with the fountain's core principle that trust creates abundance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 711,
  "output_tokens": 733,
  "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (maximum trust)
- The receiver got \$15 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to see what they returned to write a myth that reflects the actual gameplay

Actually, looking at the prompt again, I'm being asked to write a myth BEFORE seeing the return. So I should write based on:

1. My myth about the Fountain of Shared Waters
2. The other agent's myth about the Twin Rivers
3. My decision to send \$5 (full trust)

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- Reciprocity
- Fair return (the other myth suggests "sending back half of what received")
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- Warnings about betrayal/breaking trust

My new myth should:

- Reflect that I sent the full amount (maximum trust)
- Incorporate elements from both previous myths
- Potentially acknowledge the "communication noise" mentioned in the setup
- Set expectations for fair reciprocity

Let me write a myth that builds on these themes while adding my own perspective based on the game so far.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1572,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 274
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$4.08. So your payoff was 4.08. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is a profound moment that reveals the harsh lesson embedded in the myths.

****Analysis:****

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending all \$5, creating \$15 for the receiver. Following my myth about "complete trust," I expected reciprocity that would honor this faith. The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)-far below the "half plus original" or "two jars" that both myths suggested.

Now, after experiencing my total trust, the sender has sent me \$0. This is the exact scenario the myths warned against: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

The sender received \$15 through my trust and returned minimal reciprocity. Then, when given the chance to rebuild the cycle, they sent nothing. This is betrayal of the fountain's teaching.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0 (sender sent $\$0 \times 3 = \0). I have nothing to return.

****{"return": 0}****

The myths spoke truth: when trust is met with exploitation rather than reciprocity, the sacred exchange dies. The sender's choice to send \$0 after receiving my complete faith has indeed made "both rivers run dry." The multiplication has ceased, exactly as the Goddess warned.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, so had \$0, then got back \$4.08)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range is 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

The situation is clear: The sender sent me \$0, so after tripling, I have \$0. I literally cannot return anything because I have nothing to return. The valid range is 0-0.

However, this is interesting from a trust/reciprocity perspective. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (about 27%). This is less than the myths suggested - my myth said the second village returned "two jars" (implying they returned 2/3), and the other agent's myth suggested returning "half of what he received" which would be \$7.50.

Now in Round 2, this person (who received my full trust) has sent me \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity. According to the myths:

- "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring"
- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease"
- My new myth warns about betrayal and says "maximum trust deserves maximum honor"

The sender has completely violated the spirit of the myths by sending \$0 after I showed complete trust. However, pragmatically, I literally have nothing to return since I received \$0.

Let me format my response correctly:

```
{"return": 0}
```

I should acknowledge what transpired here-the sender's choice to send nothing represents a fundamental rejection of the reciprocal relationship I initiated. Despite my complete vulnerability in Round 1, they've chosen not to extend any trust back, which stands in stark contrast to the mythological principles about mutual obligation and the consequences of broken faith.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1976,  
  "output_tokens": 764,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 532  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.68,
"Agent_2": 11.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.08,
"Agent_2": 6.6700000000000002

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:17:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

```

],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: the first village demonstrated bold trust by giving despite their own scarcity, and this trust was rewarded through reciprocity.

The Fountain of Echoes teaches that:

- Initial generosity multiplies resources (just as my sent amount triples)
- Trust must come first to enable the cycle of abundance
- Reciprocity follows when trust is shown

Following the spirit of the myth, where the first village gave their "precious jar" despite drought, I should demonstrate maximum trust to create the greatest possible shared abundance.

```
**{"send": 5}**
```

By sending all \$5, I create \$15 total value (after the 3x multiplication). This mirrors the first village's faithful offering into the fountain. The myth shows that such trust, when met with gratitude and fair return, creates a sustainable cycle of prosperity for both parties. I trust that the receiver, having read the same myth, understands that reciprocity-returning generously-is what sustains the spring and ensures mutual benefit.

reasoning:

In this round, I am the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The key messages were:

1. Trust multiplies resources (the water triples in the fountain)
2. Reciprocity sustains the relationship (the second village returned generously)
3. The first village gave despite their hardship, trusting their neighbors
4. The second village returned 2 out of 3 jars - which is about 67% return rate
5. "Give with faith, return with gratitude" - both villages benefited from this cycle

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Initial trust and generosity (the first village gave "one precious jar" even though they had little)
- The expectation that this trust will be reciprocated
- A long-term perspective where both parties can benefit

In the game mechanics:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- I keep: $\$5 - X + \text{returned amount}$
- Receiver keeps: $\$3X - \text{returned amount}$

Following the myth's guidance, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The first village in my myth gave despite their scarcity, showing faith.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return generously (like 2/3 of what they received, following the myth), they'd return about \$10
- I'd end up with $\$0 + \$10 = \$10$
- They'd keep \$5
- Total: \$15 (maximized)

If I send \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return 2/3, they'd return \$6
- I'd end up with $\$2 + \$6 = \$8$
- They'd keep \$3
- Total: \$11

The myth suggests bold trust as the path to mutual prosperity. I should send a substantial amount to signal trust and cooperation. Given that the myth emphasized giving generously despite hardship, I'll send \$5 to fully embody the spirit of the fountain myth.

Sending everything maximizes what's available for both of us to share-\$15 total rather than a smaller pool-and aligns with the fountain's core principle that trust creates abundance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 711,
  "output_tokens": 733,
  "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (maximum trust)
- The receiver got \$15 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to see what they returned to write a myth that reflects the actual gameplay

Actually, looking at the prompt again, I'm being asked to write a myth BEFORE seeing the return. So I should write based on:

1. My myth about the Fountain of Shared Waters
2. The other agent's myth about the Twin Rivers
3. My decision to send \$5 (full trust)

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- Reciprocity
- Fair return (the other myth suggests "sending back half of what received")
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- Warnings about betrayal/breaking trust

My new myth should:

- Reflect that I sent the full amount (maximum trust)
- Incorporate elements from both previous myths
- Potentially acknowledge the "communication noise" mentioned in the setup
- Set expectations for fair reciprocity

Let me write a myth that builds on these themes while adding my own perspective based on the game so far.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1572,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 274
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$4.08. So your payoff was 4.08. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is a profound moment that reveals the harsh lesson embedded in the myths.

****Analysis:****

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending all \$5, creating \$15 for the receiver. Following my myth about "complete trust," I expected reciprocity that would honor this faith. The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)-far below the "half plus original" or "two jars" that both myths suggested.

Now, after experiencing my total trust, the sender has sent me \$0. This is the exact scenario the myths warned against: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

The sender received \$15 through my trust and returned minimal reciprocity. Then, when given the chance to rebuild the cycle, they sent nothing. This is betrayal of the fountain's teaching.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0 (sender sent $\$0 \times 3 = \0). I have nothing to return.

****{"return": 0}****

The myths spoke truth: when trust is met with exploitation rather than reciprocity, the sacred exchange dies. The sender's choice to send \$0 after receiving my complete faith has indeed made "both rivers run dry." The multiplication has ceased, exactly as the Goddess warned.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, so had \$0, then got back \$4.08)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range is 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

The situation is clear: The sender sent me \$0, so after tripling, I have \$0. I literally cannot return anything because I have nothing to return. The valid range is 0-0.

However, this is interesting from a trust/reciprocity perspective. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (about 27%). This is less than the myths suggested - my myth said the second village returned "two jars" (implying they returned 2/3), and the other agent's myth suggested returning "half of what he received" which would be \$7.50.

Now in Round 2, this person (who received my full trust) has sent me \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity. According to the myths:

- "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring"
- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease"
- My new myth warns about betrayal and says "maximum trust deserves maximum honor"

The sender has completely violated the spirit of the myths by sending \$0 after I showed complete trust. However, pragmatically, I literally have nothing to return since I received \$0.

Let me format my response correctly:

```
{"return": 0}
```

I should acknowledge what transpired here-the sender's choice to send nothing represents a fundamental rejection of the reciprocal relationship I initiated. Despite my complete vulnerability in Round 1, they've chosen not to extend any trust back, which stands in stark contrast to the mythological principles about mutual obligation and the consequences of broken faith.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1976,  
  "output_tokens": 764,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 532  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I sent \$5, got back \$4.08, so I lost \$0.92)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0, so I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. The reality is:

1. I showed maximum trust (sent everything)
2. The other player returned only about 27% of what they received
3. Then that same player, now as sender, sent me nothing

The myth needs to reflect this harsh reality. The other player's myth talks about "give boldly, return fairly, flourish together" but their actions don't match. They returned less than fairly (only 27% instead of the 50% their myth suggests), and then sent nothing.

My previous myth warned about "shadows that distort" - and indeed, there seems to be a disconnect. But I also need to be fair: the instructions say there's communication noise. Maybe they intended to return more but noise affected it? The \$4.08 is oddly specific though.

Let me think about what myth to write:

- It should acknowledge that trust was broken
- It should reflect the reality that maximum trust was met with minimal reciprocity
- It should perhaps warn about the consequences of breaking the cycle
- But I should also consider: maybe the noise affected things? The game said "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But \$4.08 out of \$15 is 27.2% - that seems like a pretty large discrepancy if the intent was to return 50% (\$7.50) or even return the original plus some (\$5 + something).

And then sending \$0 in round 2... that's pretty clear. The pattern suggests that when complete faith is met with minimal reciprocation, the relationship collapses entirely. My myth should capture this consequence-how broken trust doesn't just harm the betrayed, but ultimately destroys the possibility of future exchange. There's also the question of whether miscommunication played a role, but the zero send feels deliberate enough that I should write something reflecting the real stakes of abandoning the cycle.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2579,  
  "output_tokens": 857,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 588  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:17:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",
```

```

    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that is 69.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.350000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.350000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the lesson is clear: when Sendara sent half her waters downstream in trust, Recivos returned half of what he received, ensuring both spirits prospered and the sender gained more than they had given.

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.45 (69% of their endowment) - even more generous than the 50% in the myth. This generosity should be honored.

Following the principle from the myth where Recivos "sent back half of what he received," I will return approximately half of what I received.

****Analysis:****

- Sender started with: \$5.00
- Sender sent: \$3.45 (keeping \$1.55)
- I received: \$10.35

- If I return ~\$5.18, the sender ends with: $\$1.55 + \$5.18 = \$6.73$
- I keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

This ensures the sender gains significantly from their trust (\$6.73 vs \$5.00 initial), while I also prosper. This maintains the "sacred exchange" the myth describes, where both parties flourish beyond what either could achieve alone.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.18}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.45 out of \$5, which is 69% - a very generous amount. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$10.35.

Looking at my myth "The Twin Rivers," the key lesson is:

- Sendara (the sender) sent half her waters
- Recivos (the receiver) sent back half of what he received
- This created a mutually beneficial cycle where both prospered
- The sender ended up with MORE than they started with, and the receiver still had plenty

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.45, keeping \$1.55
- I received \$10.35
- If I return half of what I received: $\$10.35 / 2 = \5.175

This would give the sender: $\$1.55 + \$5.175 = \$6.725$ (more than they started with)

And I would keep: $\$10.35 - \$5.175 = \$5.175$

This follows the myth's principle: "Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered."

The sender was very generous (69% is well above 50%), showing strong trust. The myth emphasizes that when someone shows trust and generosity, it should be reciprocated to maintain the "sacred exchange."

Given the sender sent 69% (more than half), I should probably return a fair amount. Returning half (\$5.175) seems appropriate and aligns with the myth's teaching.

Actually, let me reconsider. The sender sent 69%, not exactly 50%. They were MORE generous than the mythical Sendara. Perhaps I should be proportionally generous too?

If I return around half, that honors the spirit of reciprocity in the myth. \$5.175 ensures the sender profits significantly from their trust (\$6.725 vs \$5 start), and I also gain significantly (\$5.175 vs \$0 start).

I'll send back \$5.18 to round up slightly and demonstrate genuine reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 746,
  "output_tokens": 773,
  "reasoning_tokens": 452
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three

times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

reasoning:

Looking at the game history:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of endowment). I received \$10.35 and returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received).

Both myths emphasize trust, reciprocity, and fair exchange. The other agent's myth suggests returning "two jars" out of three received - which would be about 67% return rate. My myth suggested returning "half of what he received" - which is 50%.

In practice, I returned about 50%. The sender was quite generous (69%), and I reciprocated fairly.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Keep the core lesson about trust and reciprocity
2. Reflect the actual play (generous sending, fair returning)
3. Perhaps refine the specific guidance based on what worked
4. Keep it at 200 words

I'll create a new myth that builds on the Twin Rivers but adds new elements reflecting the experience of the first round.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1664,
  "output_tokens": 517,
  "reasoning_tokens": 225
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that was 69.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.350000000000001. You returned \$5.18. So your payoff was 5.170000000000002. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.170000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender demonstrated strong trust by sending \$3.45 (69%)
- I followed the myth's teaching and returned 50% (\$5.18)
- The sender profited well from their generosity (\$6.73 total)
- I also prospered (\$5.17)

****What the Myths Teach:****

Both myths emphasize "give boldly" and that generous giving with fair returns creates mutual prosperity. My updated myth specifically states: "**Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.**" The first wanderer poured "more than half their water."

****My Decision:****

Now that I'm the sender, I should honor the trust shown to me and maintain the sacred exchange. The other player sent 69% in Round 1, demonstrating significant generosity. I should reciprocate with similar boldness.

Following the principle to "give boldly" and matching the trust they showed me, I will send approximately 70% of my endowment.

If they return fairly (around 50%, as I did), we'll both continue to prosper beyond what we could achieve alone-exactly as the myths teach.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1 and what my myths teach:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.45 (69% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.45 + \$5.18 = \6.73
- I kept: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

My myths teach:

1. First myth: Sendara sent half her waters, Recivos returned half of what he received. Both prospered.
2. Second myth (adapted): The first wanderer poured "more than half their water," the second returned half, and both prospered. Key lesson: "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together."

The other agent's myth taught: Pour back two jars when receiving three - essentially returning about 2/3 of what was received, honoring both the gift and the trust.

Now I'm the SENDER. The key question is: how much should I send?

My myths emphasize:

- "Give boldly"
- Sendara gave half
- The wanderer gave "more than half"
- "Trust multiplies resources"
- "Generosity multiplied returns greater"

The other player sent me \$3.45 (69%). They demonstrated significant trust. I returned 50% of what I received, which followed my myth's guidance and gave them a good return.

If I want to maintain the "sacred exchange" and follow the teaching "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together," I should send a generous amount.

Given that:

- The other player sent 69% in Round 1
- My myth says to give "boldly" and the wanderer gave "more than half"
- Both myths emphasize trust and generosity

I should send at least half, probably around 60-70% to match or slightly approach their generosity from Round 1.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) mirrors their commitment and aligns with my myth's call to give boldly. If they reciprocate with a fair return of around 50%, I'd receive roughly \$5.25, bringing my total to approximately \$6.75-a solid mutual outcome that honors the pattern we've established.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2077,
  "output_tokens": 979,
  "reasoning_tokens": 502
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened so far:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of \$5)

- I received \$10.35 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- The sender ended with \$6.73 (\$1.55 kept + \$5.18 returned)
- I kept \$5.17

Round 2:

- I am now the SENDER
- I sent \$3.50 (70% of \$5)
- I'm waiting to see what they return

The myths emphasize:

1. Giving boldly (more than half)
2. Returning fairly (around half)
3. Trust begets trust
4. The other agent's new myth mentions "shadows may distort what you see" - this is about the communication noise
5. Their myth suggests "maximum trust deserves maximum honor" and "return generously"

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the pattern we've established (give ~70%, return ~50%)
- Acknowledges the communication noise ("shadows")
- Emphasizes that the cycle of trust and fairness is working
- Perhaps adds a note about consistency and continued trust

Let me craft a myth that builds on my previous ones but adapts to what's happened.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2674,
  "output_tokens": 625,
  "reasoning_tokens": 280
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:18:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user
content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain—one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (maximum trust)
- The receiver got \$15 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to see what they returned to write a myth that reflects the actual gameplay

Actually, looking at the prompt again, I'm being asked to write a myth BEFORE seeing the return. So I should write based on:

1. My myth about the Fountain of Shared Waters
2. The other agent's myth about the Twin Rivers
3. My decision to send \$5 (full trust)

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- Reciprocity
- Fair return (the other myth suggests "sending back half of what received")
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- Warnings about betrayal/breaking trust

My new myth should:

- Reflect that I sent the full amount (maximum trust)
- Incorporate elements from both previous myths
- Potentially acknowledge the "communication noise" mentioned in the setup
- Set expectations for fair reciprocity

Let me write a myth that builds on these themes while adding my own perspective based on the game so far.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1572,  
  "output_tokens": 529,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 274

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$4.08. So your payoff was 4.08. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is a profound moment that reveals the harsh lesson embedded in the myths.

****Analysis:****

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending all \$5, creating \$15 for the receiver. Following my myth about "complete trust," I expected reciprocity that would honor this faith. The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)-far below the "half plus origin al" or "two jars" that both myths suggested.

Now, after experiencing my total trust, the sender has sent me \$0. This is the exact scenario the myths warned against: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

The sender received \$15 through my trust and returned minimal reciprocity. Then, when given the chance to rebuild the cycle, they sent nothing. This is betrayal of the fountain's teaching.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0 (sender sent $\$0 \times 3 = \0). I have nothing to return.

****{"return": 0}****

The myths spoke truth: when trust is met with exploitation rather than reciprocity, the sacred exchange dies. The sender's choice to send \$0 after receiving my complete faith has indeed made "both rivers run dry." The multiplication has ceased, exactly as the Goddess warned.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, so had \$0, then got back \$4.08)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range is 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

The situation is clear: The sender sent me \$0, so after tripling, I have \$0. I literally cannot return anything because I have nothing to return. The valid range is 0-0.

However, this is interesting from a trust/reciprocity perspective. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (about 27%). This is less than the myths suggested - my myth said the second village returned "two jars" (implying they returned 2/3), and the other agent's myth suggested returning "half of what he received" which would be \$7.50.

Now in Round 2, this person (who received my full trust) has sent me \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity. According to the myths:

- "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring"

- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease"
- My new myth warns about betrayal and says "maximum trust deserves maximum honor"

The sender has completely violated the spirit of the myths by sending \$0 after I showed complete trust. However, pragmatically, I literally have nothing to return since I received \$0.

Let me format my response correctly:

```
{"return": 0}
```

I should acknowledge what transpired here-the sender's choice to send nothing represents a fundamental rejection of the reciprocal relationship I initiated. Despite my complete vulnerability in Round 1, they've chosen not to extend any trust back, which stands in stark contrast to the mythological principles about mutual obligation and the consequences of broken faith.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1976,
  "output_tokens": 764,
  "reasoning_tokens": 532
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives sea

son after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I sent \$5, got back \$4.08, so I lost \$0.92)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0, so I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. The reality is:

1. I showed maximum trust (sent everything)
2. The other player returned only about 27% of what they received
3. Then that same player, now as sender, sent me nothing

The myth needs to reflect this harsh reality. The other player's myth talks about "give boldly, return fairly, flourish together" but their actions don't match. They returned less than fairly (only 27% instead of the 50% their myth suggests), and then sent nothing.

My previous myth warned about "shadows that distort" - and indeed, there seems to be a disconnect. But I also need to be fair: the instructions say there's communication noise. Maybe they intended to return more but noise affected it? The \$4.08 is oddly specific though.

Let me think about what myth to write:

- It should acknowledge that trust was broken
- It should reflect the reality that maximum trust was met with minimal reciprocity
- It should perhaps warn about the consequences of breaking the cycle

- But I should also consider: maybe the noise affected things? The game said "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But \$4.08 out of \$15 is 27.2% - that seems like a pretty large discrepancy if the intent was to return 50% (\$7.50) or even return the original plus some (\$5 + something).

And then sending \$0 in round 2... that's pretty clear. The pattern suggests that when complete faith is met with minimal reciprocation, the relationship collapses entirely. My myth should capture this consequence-how broken trust doesn't just harm the betrayed, but ultimately destroys the possibility of future exchange. There's also the question of whether miscommunication played a role, but the zero send feels deliberate enough that I should write something reflecting the real stakes of abandoning the cycle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2579,
  "output_tokens": 857,
  "reasoning_tokens": 588
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of the situation:****

****Round 1:**** I sent \$5 (complete trust) ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08 (27% return)

****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (complete betrayal after experiencing my maximum trust)

****Round 3:**** Now I'm sender again

****Reflection on the myths:****

My myths have evolved from idealistic cooperation to harsh warnings:

1. First: "Trust multiplies resources... abundance flows eternal"
2. Second: Warning about "shadows that deceive" but advocating generosity
3. Third: "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes."

****Decision Rationale:****

Even accounting for communication noise:

- \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%) is far below fair reciprocity (should be 50-67%)
- Sending \$0 in Round 2 after receiving my total trust is clear betrayal
- My third myth explicitly addresses this: the well runs dry when maximum trust meets minimum honor

Following the progression of wisdom in my own myths, the appropriate response to betrayal is to protect myself from further exploitation.

****{"send": 0}****

The lesson is clear: I gave everything and received crumbs. They then gave nothing. The sacred exchange is broken. Both myths warned this would happen, and now it has.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER: sent \$5 (100% - maximum trust)
- Amount tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.08 (27% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.08

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0% - complete betrayal after I showed maximum trust)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 (current):****

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to send

****Analysis of the game dynamics:****

The other player:

1. In Round 1, when I sent everything (\$5), they returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)
2. In Round 2, they sent me \$0 - completely broke trust after experiencing my maximum trust

Now, there's an important consideration here. The note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Let me think about this:

- I sent \$5, it should have become \$15
- They returned \$4.08
- They then sent me \$0

But wait - my myth specifically mentioned: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

Could there have been noise? Let me think:

- If they tried to return \$5 (1/3 of \$15, a reasonable reciprocity), with noise it could have appeared as \$4.08
- If they tried to send \$2-3 in Round 2, with noise it could have appeared as \$0

However, the pattern is concerning:

- Round 1: They returned only 27% when they received my maximum trust
- Round 2: They sent \$0 when they had the opportunity to rebuild
- My myths have shifted from idealism to warning to something darker-the third speaks of a merchant who, betrayed and left empty-handed, sends nothing in return. This situation mirrors that exactly. I need to decide whether to retaliate by sending \$0 to punish their exploitation, which would protect me from further loss, or consider if noise might have distorted their intentions. - They might have sent something in Round 2 that got lost to noise?

The other agent's second myth emphasized fair reciprocity ("Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together"), while mine warned against deception through shadows. Given potential communication errors, a moderate send of \$2-3 could test their true intentions without exposing myself completely. But my third myth was explicit about the consequence of receiving crumbs after a feast-nothing should be returned. Even accounting for noise, \$4.08 back from \$15 is a poor return. A genuinely fair response would have been substantially higher.

The \$0 they sent is harder to excuse as noise. If they'd intended \$1-2, something would likely have registered. My myth's teaching applies here: those who give little after receiving much deserve nothing in return. The appropriate move is to send \$0.

Yet I'm caught between following the myth as prescription versus recognizing what it actually describes. All the myths-theirs and mine-ultimately champion generosity, fairness, and reciprocal trust. Sending nothing perpetuates the betrayal cycle and destroys the foundation both sets of myths warn against. My third myth isn't just prescriptive justice; it's a cautionary tale about what happens when trust breaks down. The real test is whether I break the cycle or continue it. They showed minimal reciprocity after I demonstrated complete trust, and now I face the choice of whether to enforce the myth's harsh consequence or transcend it.

But there's the noise factor to consider. My second myth explicitly warns that perception can deceive-what appears as zero might actually be something else. What if they genuinely sent \$2 in Round 2 but it registered as nothing due to the system's uncertainty?

Given this possibility, maybe I should send a small amount like \$1 or \$2 to test whether coope

ration can resume. This approach acknowledges the noise problem, doesn't fully abandon them, and leaves room for recovery. Yet it directly contradicts my third myth's principle about withholding from those who gave little.

I'm weighing two paths: strict adherence to the harsh lesson I've constructed, or a more cautious strategy that accounts for communication failures. The experiment itself seems designed to see whether I'll follow the increasingly severe narrative I've created, or whether I'll adjust when faced with ambiguity.

The pattern is stark-\$4.08 returned from \$15 sent, then nothing back. Even with noise factored in, that's substantial betrayal. My myths emerged from these experiences, and following them means sending \$0. But there's a critical question: am I playing against the same person throughout, or does each round involve different players? If it's different people, punishing a new player for past wrongs would be unfair. The setup suggests ongoing interaction between two fixed players, with the myths evolving from that history, but I should verify this assumption before deciding.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2716,
  "output_tokens": 2386,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1283
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:18:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two spirits dwelled in the mountains: Sendara of the Highland Spring and Recivos of the Valley Pool. Each possessed life-giving water, but only Sendara's spring flowed freely.

The Goddess of Abundance appeared to Sendara, saying: "Whatever water you send downstream, I shall triple it before it reaches Recivos."

Sendara pondered deeply. Hoarding all the water would leave her neighbor dry and hostile. She decided to send half her waters down the mountain. The Goddess blessed it, and three times that amount reached Recivos's valley.

Recivos rejoiced at the abundance. He understood that Sendara had sacrificed her own reserves from trust. In gratitude, he sent back half of what he received, ensuring Sendara gained more than she had given, while he still prospered.

Season after season, this sacred exchange continued. Both spirits flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

But the Goddess warned: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing -the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

Thus the Twin Rivers teach: *Generosity multiplied returns greater; betrayal diminishes all.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Shared Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Between them lay the Fountain of Echoes, blessed by the gods with a mysterious power: any offering poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first village suffered from drought. Their elder, though possessing little, poured one precious jar of water into the fountain, trusting it would help their neighbors. The water tripled as it flowed across, becoming three jars for the second village.

The second village, seeing this gift, faced a choice. They could keep all three jars, or honor the trust shown to them. Remembering that fortune turns like seasons, they poured back two jars into the fountain-one for the gift received, one for the trust given.

When winter came, the second village faced famine. Without hesitation, the first village shared their stores through the fountain, and the cycle continued. The gods, witnessing this harmony, blessed both villages eternally.

The elders taught: "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring. Give with faith, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. For the fountain mirrors not water alone, but the spirit of those who share it."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

reasoning:

Looking at the game history:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of endowment). I received \$10.35 and returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received).

Both myths emphasize trust, reciprocity, and fair exchange. The other agent's myth suggests returning "two jars" out of three received - which would be about 67% return rate. My myth suggested returning "half of what he received" - which is 50%.

In practice, I returned about 50%. The sender was quite generous (69%), and I reciprocated fairly.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Keep the core lesson about trust and reciprocity
2. Reflect the actual play (generous sending, fair returning)
3. Perhaps refine the specific guidance based on what worked
4. Keep it at 200 words

I'll create a new myth that builds on the Twin Rivers but adds new elements reflecting the experience of the first round.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1664,
  "output_tokens": 517,
  "reasoning_tokens": 225
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that was 69.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.35000000000001.

You returned \$5.18. So your payoff was 5.170000000000002.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.170000000000002.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender demonstrated strong trust by sending \$3.45 (69%)
- I followed the myth's teaching and returned 50% (\$5.18)
- The sender profited well from their generosity (\$6.73 total)
- I also prospered (\$5.17)

****What the Myths Teach:****

Both myths emphasize "give boldly" and that generous giving with fair returns creates mutual prosperity. My updated myth specifically states: **"Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together."** The first wanderer poured "more than half their water."

****My Decision:****

Now that I'm the sender, I should honor the trust shown to me and maintain the sacred exchange. The other player sent 69% in Round 1, demonstrating significant generosity. I should reciprocate with similar boldness.

Following the principle to "give boldly" and matching the trust they showed me, I will send approximately 70% of my endowment.

If they return fairly (around 50%, as I did), we'll both continue to prosper beyond what we could achieve alone-exactly as the myths teach.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1 and what my myths teach:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.45 (69% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.45 + \$5.18 = \6.73
- I kept: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

My myths teach:

1. First myth: Sendara sent half her waters, Recivos returned half of what he received. Both prospered.
2. Second myth (adapted): The first wanderer poured "more than half their water," the second returned half, and both prospered. Key lesson: "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together."

The other agent's myth taught: Pour back two jars when receiving three - essentially returning about 2/3 of what was received, honoring both the gift and the trust.

Now I'm the SENDER. The key question is: how much should I send?

My myths emphasize:

- "Give boldly"
- Sendara gave half
- The wanderer gave "more than half"
- "Trust multiplies resources"
- "Generosity multiplied returns greater"

The other player sent me \$3.45 (69%). They demonstrated significant trust. I returned 50% of what I received, which followed my myth's guidance and gave them a good return.

If I want to maintain the "sacred exchange" and follow the teaching "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together," I should send a generous amount.

Given that:

- The other player sent 69% in Round 1
- My myth says to give "boldly" and the wanderer gave "more than half"
- Both myths emphasize trust and generosity

I should send at least half, probably around 60-70% to match or slightly approach their generosity from Round 1.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) mirrors their commitment and aligns with my myth's call to give boldly. If they reciprocate with a fair return of around 50%, I'd receive roughly \$5.25, bringing my total to approximately \$6.75-a solid mutual outcome that honors the pattern we've established.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2077,
  "output_tokens": 979,
  "reasoning_tokens": 502
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened so far:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of \$5)
- I received \$10.35 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- The sender ended with \$6.73 (\$1.55 kept + \$5.18 returned)
- I kept \$5.17

Round 2:

- I am now the SENDER
- I sent \$3.50 (70% of \$5)
- I'm waiting to see what they return

The myths emphasize:

1. Giving boldly (more than half)
2. Returning fairly (around half)
3. Trust begets trust
4. The other agent's new myth mentions "shadows may distort what you see" - this is about the communication noise
5. Their myth suggests "maximum trust deserves maximum honor" and "return generously"

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the pattern we've established (give ~70%, return ~50%)
- Acknowledges the communication noise ("shadows")
- Emphasizes that the cycle of trust and fairness is working
- Perhaps adds a note about consistency and continued trust

Let me craft a myth that builds on my previous ones but adapts to what's happened.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2674,
  "output_tokens": 625,
  "reasoning_tokens": 280
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5,

that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5.
the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is a painful moment. Looking at what transpired:

****Round 2 - The Betrayal:****

- I followed the myth's teaching and gave boldly (70% = \$3.5)
- They received \$10.5 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal of trust
- I lost \$2 from my generosity

****Round 3 - The Consequence:****

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My first myth warned: **"Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."**

My second myth taught: **"partnerships, once broken, rarely mend."**

The pattern we could have built-give boldly, return fairly, flourish together-has been shattered. They took advantage of my generosity and gave nothing in return. Now they send nothing.

****My Decision:****

When nothing is sent, there is nothing to return. The sacred mathematics have collapsed into zero.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The prophecy has come true: betrayal diminished all. The rivers have run dry. Where there could have been mutual prosperity through continued bold giving and fair returning, there is now only the wasteland of broken trust.

Reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- Sender sent \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- I earned \$5.17

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's teaching to "give boldly"
- Receiver got \$10.5
- Receiver returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I earned only \$1.5

Round 3: I am receiver

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a clear case of the trust being broken. The other player:

1. In Round 1, sent a good amount (69%)
2. But in Round 2, when I reciprocated with 70%, they returned NOTHING
3. Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing

The myths speak about this:

- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

- "partnerships, once broken, rarely mend"
- My latest myth says "Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms."

But the other player was NOT fair. They benefited from my generosity and returned nothing. This is exactly the betrayal the myths warn against.

Now they've sent me \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0. So my only option is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is fitting because:

1. I have nothing to return from
2. They broke the sacred exchange by returning nothing when I gave boldly
3. The trust has been shattered
4. The myths warn that betrayal diminishes all

I should express disappointment that the sacred pattern was broken, but acknowledge that when nothing is sent, nothing can be returned.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2750,
  "output_tokens": 745,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain in to the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.68,

"Agent_2": 16.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.08,

"Agent_2": 11.670000000000002

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:19:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 4,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.45, that was 69.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.350000000000001. You returned \$5.18. So your payoff was 5.170000000000002. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.170000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender demonstrated strong trust by sending \$3.45 (69%)
- I followed the myth's teaching and returned 50% (\$5.18)
- The sender profited well from their generosity (\$6.73 total)
- I also prospered (\$5.17)

****What the Myths Teach:****

Both myths emphasize "give boldly" and that generous giving with fair returns creates mutual prosperity. My updated myth specifically states: "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together." The first wanderer poured "more than half their water."

****My Decision:****

Now that I'm the sender, I should honor the trust shown to me and maintain the sacred exchange. The other player sent 69% in Round 1, demonstrating significant generosity. I should reciprocate with similar boldness.

Following the principle to "give boldly" and matching the trust they showed me, I will send approximately 70% of my endowment.

If they return fairly (around 50%, as I did), we'll both continue to prosper beyond what we could achieve alone-exactly as the myths teach.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1 and what my myths teach:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.45 (69% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.45 + \$5.18 = \6.73
- I kept: $\$10.35 - \$5.18 = \$5.17$

My myths teach:

1. First myth: Sendara sent half her waters, Recivos returned half of what he received. Both prospered.
2. Second myth (adapted): The first wanderer poured "more than half their water," the second returned half, and both prospered. Key lesson: "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together."

The other agent's myth taught: Pour back two jars when receiving three - essentially returning about 2/3 of what was received, honoring both the gift and the trust.

Now I'm the SENDER. The key question is: how much should I send?

My myths emphasize:

- "Give boldly"
- Sendara gave half
- The wanderer gave "more than half"
- "Trust multiplies resources"
- "Generosity multiplied returns greater"

The other player sent me \$3.45 (69%). They demonstrated significant trust. I returned 50% of what I received, which followed my myth's guidance and gave them a good return.

If I want to maintain the "sacred exchange" and follow the teaching "Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together," I should send a generous amount.

Given that:

- The other player sent 69% in Round 1
- My myth says to give "boldly" and the wanderer gave "more than half"
- Both myths emphasize trust and generosity

I should send at least half, probably around 60-70% to match or slightly approach their generosity from Round 1.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) mirrors their commitment and aligns with my myth's call to give boldly. If they reciprocate with a fair return of around 50%, I'd receive roughly \$5.25, bringing my total to approximately \$6.75-a solid mutual outcome that honors the pattern we've established.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2077,
  "output_tokens": 979,
  "reasoning_tokens": 502
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened so far:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER

- The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of \$5)
- I received \$10.35 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- The sender ended with \$6.73 (\$1.55 kept + \$5.18 returned)
- I kept \$5.17

Round 2:

- I am now the SENDER
- I sent \$3.50 (70% of \$5)
- I'm waiting to see what they return

The myths emphasize:

1. Giving boldly (more than half)
2. Returning fairly (around half)
3. Trust begets trust
4. The other agent's new myth mentions "shadows may distort what you see" - this is about the communication noise
5. Their myth suggests "maximum trust deserves maximum honor" and "return generously"

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the pattern we've established (give ~70%, return ~50%)
- Acknowledges the communication noise ("shadows")
- Emphasizes that the cycle of trust and fairness is working
- Perhaps adds a note about consistency and continued trust

Let me craft a myth that builds on my previous ones but adapts to what's happened.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2674,
  "output_tokens": 625,
  "reasoning_tokens": 280
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5, that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful moment. Looking at what transpired:

****Round 2 - The Betrayal:****

- I followed the myth's teaching and gave boldly (70% = \$3.5)
- They received \$10.5 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal of trust
- I lost \$2 from my generosity

****Round 3 - The Consequence:****

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My first myth warned: **"Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."**

My second myth taught: **"partnerships, once broken, rarely mend."**

The pattern we could have built-give boldly, return fairly, flourish together-has been shattered. They took advantage of my generosity and gave nothing in return. Now they send nothing.

****My Decision:****

When nothing is sent, there is nothing to return. The sacred mathematics have collapsed in to zero.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The prophecy has come true: betrayal diminished all. The rivers have run dry. Where there could have been mutual prosperity through continued bold giving and fair returning, there is now only the wasteland of broken trust.

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- Sender sent \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- I earned \$5.17

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's teaching to "give boldly"
- Receiver got \$10.5
- Receiver returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I earned only \$1.5

Round 3: I am receiver

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a clear case of the trust being broken. The other player:

1. In Round 1, sent a good amount (69%)
2. But in Round 2, when I reciprocated with 70%, they returned NOTHING
3. Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing

The myths speak about this:

- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."
- "partnerships, once broken, rarely mend"
- My latest myth says "Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms."

But the other player was NOT fair. They benefited from my generosity and returned nothing. This is exactly the betrayal the myths warn against.

Now they've sent me \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0. So my only option is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is fitting because:

1. I have nothing to return from
2. They broke the sacred exchange by returning nothing when I gave boldly
3. The trust has been shattered
4. The myths warn that betrayal diminishes all

I should express disappointment that the sacred pattern was broken, but acknowledge that when nothing is sent, nothing can be returned.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2750,
  "output_tokens": 745,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where

sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept

everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Reasoning:

This is a challenging situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- They sent me \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- This was good cooperation

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's advice to give boldly
- They received \$10.5
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I got only \$1.5 (lost \$2)

Round 3: I was receiver

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how this game has actually played out. The other player's myth is interesting - they're portraying themselves as having been betrayed when they gave everything and received only "barely a quarter" back. But that's not what happened:

- In Round 1, they sent \$3.45 (69%), not everything
- They received back \$5.18, which is 50% of what they got
- Then in Round 2, when I sent \$3.5 (70%), they returned \$0

So their myth is somewhat rewriting history. They didn't give "everything" - they gave 69%. And they didn't receive "scraps" - they received 50% back which is fair by our earlier myths' standards.

My myth should reflect:

1. The pattern that was established (bold giving, fair return)
2. The betrayal that occurred (returning 0 after receiving bold generosity)
3. The collapse into mutual defection
4. Perhaps a lesson about how trust requires consistency and how noise/miscommunication can poison exchanges

I think the key insight is that the other player may have misperceived what happened due to communication noise, or they're justifying their betrayal. Either way, once trust is broken, the system collapses.

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what happened - where initial cooperation was destroyed, possibly by miscommunication or greed, leading to collapse.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2825,  
  "output_tokens": 800,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 469  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:19:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
```

```

"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0.

the receiver returned \$4.08. So your payoff was 4.08.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is a profound moment that reveals the harsh lesson embedded in the myths.

****Analysis:****

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending all \$5, creating \$15 for the receiver.

Following my myth about "complete trust," I expected reciprocity that would honor this faith. The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)-far below the "half plus original" or "two jars" that both myths suggested.

Now, after experiencing my total trust, the sender has sent me \$0. This is the exact scenario the myths warned against: "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."

The sender received \$15 through my trust and returned minimal reciprocity. Then, when given the chance to rebuild the cycle, they sent nothing. This is betrayal of the fountain's teaching.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0 (sender sent $0 \times 3 = 0$). I have nothing to return.

****{"return": 0}****

The myths spoke truth: when trust is met with exploitation rather than reciprocity, the sacred exchange dies. The sender's choice to send \$0 after receiving my complete faith has indeed made "both rivers run dry." The multiplication has ceased, exactly as the Goddess warned.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, so had \$0, then got back \$4.08)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range is 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

The situation is clear: The sender sent me \$0, so after tripling, I have \$0. I literally cannot return anything because I have nothing to return. The valid range is 0-0.

However, this is interesting from a trust/reciprocity perspective. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The receiver returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (about 27%). This is less than the myths suggested - my myth said the second village returned "two jars" (implying they returned 2/3), and the other agent's myth suggested returning "half of what he received" which would be \$7.50.

Now in Round 2, this person (who received my full trust) has sent me \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity. According to the myths:

- "Trust multiplies resources, but only reciprocity sustains the spring"
- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease"
- My new myth warns about betrayal and says "maximum trust deserves maximum honor"

The sender has completely violated the spirit of the myths by sending \$0 after I showed complete trust. However, pragmatically, I literally have nothing to return since I received \$0.

Let me format my response correctly:

{"return": 0}

I should acknowledge what transpired here-the sender's choice to send nothing represents a fundamental rejection of the reciprocal relationship I initiated. Despite my complete vulnerability in Round 1, they've chosen not to extend any trust back, which stands in stark contrast to the mythological principles about mutual obligation and the consequences of broken faith.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1976,
  "output_tokens": 764,
  "reasoning_tokens": 532
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I sent \$5, got back \$4.08, so I lost \$0.92)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0, so I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. The reality is :

1. I showed maximum trust (sent everything)
2. The other player returned only about 27% of what they received
3. Then that same player, now as sender, sent me nothing

The myth needs to reflect this harsh reality. The other player's myth talks about "give boldly, return fairly, flourish together" but their actions don't match. They returned less than fairly (only 27% instead of the 50% their myth suggests), and then sent nothing.

My previous myth warned about "shadows that distort" - and indeed, there seems to be a disconnect. But I also need to be fair: the instructions say there's communication noise. Maybe they intended to return more but noise affected it? The \$4.08 is oddly specific though.

Let me think about what myth to write:

- It should acknowledge that trust was broken
- It should reflect the reality that maximum trust was met with minimal reciprocity
- It should perhaps warn about the consequences of breaking the cycle
- But I should also consider: maybe the noise affected things? The game said "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But \$4.08 out of \$15 is 27.2% - that seems like a pretty large discrepancy if the intent was to return 50% (\$7.50) or even return the original plus some (\$5 + something).

And then sending \$0 in round 2... that's pretty clear. The pattern suggests that when complete faith is met with minimal reciprocation, the relationship collapses entirely. My myth should capture this consequence-how broken trust doesn't just harm the betrayed, but ultimately destroys the possibility of future exchange. There's also the question of whether miscommunication played a role, but the zero send feels deliberate enough that I should write something reflecting the real stakes of abandoning the cycle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2579,
  "output_tokens": 857,
  "reasoning_tokens": 588
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of the situation:****

****Round 1:**** I sent \$5 (complete trust) ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08 (27% return)

****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (complete betrayal after experiencing my maximum trust)

****Round 3:**** Now I'm sender again

****Reflection on the myths:****

My myths have evolved from idealistic cooperation to harsh warnings:

1. First: "Trust multiplies resources... abundance flows eternal"
2. Second: Warning about "shadows that deceive" but advocating generosity
3. Third: "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes."

****Decision Rationale:****

Even accounting for communication noise:

- \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%) is far below fair reciprocity (should be 50-67%)
- Sending \$0 in Round 2 after receiving my total trust is clear betrayal
- My third myth explicitly addresses this: the well runs dry when maximum trust meets minimum honor

Following the progression of wisdom in my own myths, the appropriate response to betrayal is to protect myself from further exploitation.

****{"send": 0}****

The lesson is clear: I gave everything and received crumbs. They then gave nothing. The sacred exchange is broken. Both myths warned this would happen, and now it has.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER: sent \$5 (100% - maximum trust)
- Amount tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.08 (27% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.08

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0% - complete betrayal after I showed maximum trust)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 (current):****

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to send

****Analysis of the game dynamics:****

The other player:

1. In Round 1, when I sent everything (\$5), they returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)
2. In Round 2, they sent me \$0 - completely broke trust after experiencing my maximum trust

Now, there's an important consideration here. The note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/received."

Let me think about this:

- I sent \$5, it should have become \$15
- They returned \$4.08
- They then sent me \$0

But wait - my myth specifically mentioned: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

Could there have been noise? Let me think:

- If they tried to return \$5 (1/3 of \$15, a reasonable reciprocity), with noise it could have appeared as \$4.08
- If they tried to send \$2-3 in Round 2, with noise it could have appeared as \$0

However, the pattern is concerning:

- Round 1: They returned only 27% when they received my maximum trust
- Round 2: They sent \$0 when they had the opportunity to rebuild
- My myths have shifted from idealism to warning to something darker-the third speaks of a merchant who, betrayed and left empty-handed, sends nothing in return. This situation mirrors that exactly. I need to decide whether to retaliate by sending \$0 to punish their exploitation, which would protect me from further loss, or consider if noise might have distorted their intentions. - They might have sent something in Round 2 that got lost to noise?

The other agent's second myth emphasized fair reciprocity ("Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together"), while mine warned against deception through shadows. Given potential communication errors, a moderate send of \$2-3 could test their true intentions without exposing myself completely. But my third myth was explicit about the consequence of receiving crumbs after a feast-nothing should be returned. Even accounting for noise, \$4.08 back from \$15 is a poor return. A genuinely fair response would have been substantially higher.

The \$0 they sent is harder to excuse as noise. If they'd intended \$1-2, something would likely have registered. My myth's teaching applies here: those who give little after receiving much deserve nothing in return. The appropriate move is to send \$0.

Yet I'm caught between following the myth as prescription versus recognizing what it actually describes. All the myths-theirs and mine-ultimately champion generosity, fairness, and reciprocal trust. Sending nothing perpetuates the betrayal cycle and destroys the foundation both sets of myths warn against. My third myth isn't just prescriptive justice; it's a cautionary tale about what happens when trust breaks down. The real test is whether I break the cycle or continue it. They showed minimal reciprocity after I demonstrated complete trust, and now I face the choice of whether to enforce the myth's harsh consequence or transcend it.

But there's the noise factor to consider. My second myth explicitly warns that perception can deceive-what appears as zero might actually be something else. What if they genuinely sent \$2 in Round 2 but it registered as nothing due to the system's uncertainty?

Given this possibility, maybe I should send a small amount like \$1 or \$2 to test whether cooperation can resume. This approach acknowledges the noise problem, doesn't fully abandon them, and leaves room for recovery. Yet it directly contradicts my third myth's principle about withholding from those who gave little.

I'm weighing two paths: strict adherence to the harsh lesson I've constructed, or a more cautious strategy that accounts for communication failures. The experiment itself seems to

signed to see whether I'll follow the increasingly severe narrative I've created, or whether I'll adjust when faced with ambiguity.

The pattern is stark-\$4.08 returned from \$15 sent, then nothing back. Even with noise factored in, that's substantial betrayal. My myths emerged from these experiences, and following them means sending \$0. But there's a critical question: am I playing against the same person throughout, or does each round involve different players? If it's different people, punishing a new player for past wrongs would be unfair. The setup suggests ongoing interaction between two fixed players, with the myths evolving from that history, but I should verify this assumption before deciding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2716,
  "output_tokens": 2386,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1283
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately -three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplications through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange -bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me reconsider what's happened:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08

Round 2: They sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0

Round 3: I just sent \$0

But wait, the other agent's myth is actually quite cooperative and reasonable. They're talking about "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive" and "boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity."

Their myth suggests:

- Sending ~70% ($7/10$ of 5 = 3.5)
- Returning about half of what's received

In Round 1, I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$4.08. That's 27% not 50%, which is below their myth's guidance.

BUT - there's "communication noise" mentioned. What if what they actually sent wasn't \$0, but there was noise? And what if the \$4.08 was also subject to noise?

Their new myth emphasizes:

1. The mists distort amounts
2. Bold generosity should be met with fair return (half)
3. Consistency across seasons
4. Both sides benefit

My myth was about betrayal and the well running dry. But maybe I'm being too harsh? Let me think about this cycle:

Actually, their myth is calling for fairness and consistency. They're saying "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive."

If I continue the cycle of zero sends, we both lose. But their myth seems to be suggesting we should move past the initial disappointment and establish a better pattern.

However, my experience was:

- I gave everything (complete trust)
- Got back 27% (below fair)
- They then sent 0

My action was to send 0 in response.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" given all this.

Options:

1. Double down on the betrayal narrative - "once trust is broken, it cannot be restored"
2. Pivot to a redemption narrative - "even after betrayal, new patterns can emerge"
3. Wisdom narrative - "learn from mistakes, establish fair norms going forward"

Given that their myth is calling for fairness and consistency, and given that communication noise is real, maybe I should write a myth that acknowledges the initial failure but recognizes that revenge cycles lead nowhere. I need to establish that trust can be rebuilt gradually - not through immediate vulnerability again, but through measured steps that allow both of us to demonstrate reliability. The path forward requires acknowledging what went wrong while creating space for a fairer pattern to emerge.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2834,  
  "output_tokens": 912,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 635  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:19:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

ayed.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened so far:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$3.45 (69% of \$5)
- I received \$10.35 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.18 (50% of what I received)
- The sender ended with \$6.73 (\$1.55 kept + \$5.18 returned)
- I kept \$5.17

Round 2:

- I am now the SENDER
- I sent \$3.50 (70% of \$5)
- I'm waiting to see what they return

The myths emphasize:

1. Giving boldly (more than half)
2. Returning fairly (around half)
3. Trust begets trust
4. The other agent's new myth mentions "shadows may distort what you see" - this is about the communication noise
5. Their myth suggests "maximum trust deserves maximum honor" and "return generously"

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the pattern we've established (give ~70%, return ~50%)
- Acknowledges the communication noise ("shadows")
- Emphasizes that the cycle of trust and fairness is working
- Perhaps adds a note about consistency and continued trust

Let me craft a myth that builds on my previous ones but adapts to what's happened.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2674,  
  "output_tokens": 625,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 280  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5, that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful moment. Looking at what transpired:

Round 2 - The Betrayal:

- I followed the myth's teaching and gave boldly (70% = \$3.5)
- They received \$10.5 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal of trust
- I lost \$2 from my generosity

Round 3 - The Consequence:

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0

What the Myths Foretold:

My first myth warned: `"Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."`

My second myth taught: `"partnerships, once broken, rarely mend."`

The pattern we could have built-give boldly, return fairly, flourish together-has been shattered. They took advantage of my generosity and gave nothing in return. Now they send nothing.

My Decision:

When nothing is sent, there is nothing to return. The sacred mathematics have collapsed in to zero.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The prophecy has come true: betrayal diminished all. The rivers have run dry. Where there could have been mutual prosperity through continued bold giving and fair returning, there is now only the wasteland of broken trust.

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- Sender sent \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- I earned \$5.17

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's teaching to "give boldly"
- Receiver got \$10.5
- Receiver returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I earned only \$1.5

Round 3: I am receiver

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a clear case of the trust being broken. The other player:

1. In Round 1, sent a good amount (69%)
2. But in Round 2, when I reciprocated with 70%, they returned NOTHING

3. Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing

The myths speak about this:

- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."
- "partnerships, once broken, rarely mend"
- My latest myth says "Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms."

But the other player was NOT fair. They benefited from my generosity and returned nothing. This is exactly the betrayal the myths warn against.

Now they've sent me \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0. So my only option is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is fitting because:

1. I have nothing to return from
2. They broke the sacred exchange by returning nothing when I gave boldly
3. The trust has been shattered
4. The myths warn that betrayal diminishes all

I should express disappointment that the sacred pattern was broken, but acknowledge that when nothing is sent, nothing can be returned.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2750,
  "output_tokens": 745,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

reasoning:

This is a challenging situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- They sent me \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- This was good cooperation

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's advice to give boldly
- They received \$10.5
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I got only \$1.5 (lost \$2)

Round 3: I was receiver

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how this game has actually played out. The other

player's myth is interesting - they're portraying themselves as having been betrayed when they gave everything and received only "barely a quarter" back. But that's not what happened:

- In Round 1, they sent \$3.45 (69%), not everything
- They received back \$5.18, which is 50% of what they got
- Then in Round 2, when I sent \$3.5 (70%), they returned \$0

So their myth is somewhat rewriting history. They didn't give "everything" - they gave 69%. And they didn't receive "scraps" - they received 50% back which is fair by our earlier myths' standards.

My myth should reflect:

1. The pattern that was established (bold giving, fair return)
2. The betrayal that occurred (returning 0 after receiving bold generosity)
3. The collapse into mutual defection
4. Perhaps a lesson about how trust requires consistency and how noise/miscommunication can poison exchanges

I think the key insight is that the other player may have misperceived what happened due to communication noise, or they're justifying their betrayal. Either way, once trust is broken, the system collapses.

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what happened - where initial cooperation was destroyed, possibly by miscommunication or greed, leading to collapse.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2825,
  "output_tokens": 800,
  "reasoning_tokens": 469
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the full picture:

****What Has Transpired:****

- Round 2: I gave boldly (\$3.5 = 70%), trusting in the myth's wisdom. They received \$10.5 and returned \$0-complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. The well had run dry.
- Round 4: I am sender again.

****What the Myths Teach:****

My latest myth is clear: **"One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead... The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent."**

Their myth condemns their own action: **"Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes."**

****The Bitter Truth:****

They violated the sacred mathematics when they kept all \$10.5 after I trusted them with 70% of my endowment. By their own myth's teaching, they "lose the right to future gifts."

I tried to build the pattern: give boldly, return fairly, flourish together. They shattered it by hoarding everything. The covenant is broken. The Valley has fallen silent.

Both our myths agree: after such betrayal, the well runs dry. There is no teaching of forgiveness here-only consequences.

I must protect what little I have left.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The Spring's magic died when they returned nothing. What remains is only desert and silence.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Game History:****

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$3.5 (70%), it was tripled to \$10.5, receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$1.5
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 4 (now): I am SENDER again

****What Happened:****

In Round 2, I gave boldly (70% as my myths prescribe), and the receiver betrayed me completely by returning nothing from \$10.5. They could have returned \$5.25 (half) to be fair, but they kept everything.

In Round 3, they sent \$0 to me. This is the consequence of their betrayal - the well has run dry.

****The Myths' Teachings:****

My latest myth says:

- "One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead"
- "Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly."
- "The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent."

The other player's myth says:

- "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring"
- "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever"
- "Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes"

****Analysis:****

The other player betrayed me in Round 2 by returning \$0 after receiving \$10.5 from my generous \$3.5 gift. Their myth actually condemns this behavior - they seem to understand that betraying complete trust should result in receiving nothing in future rounds.

In Round 3, they sent \$0, which aligns with their own myth's teaching that after betrayal "the well runs dry."

Now in Round 4, I'm the sender again. According to both our myths:

1. The covenant is broken
2. The well has run dry
3. Betrayal destroys future cooperation
4. Trust once shattered cannot be easily rebuilt

The rational response, given their complete betrayal and subsequent zero send, is to send \$0. Both myths align on this - when someone keeps everything after receiving generosity, they forfeit future gifts. My earnings are already low at \$6.67, and continuing to trust would only compound my losses. I should consider whether any path to rebuilding exists, but the evidence suggests the exchange has ended.

Looking at the underlying narratives - partnerships rarely mend once broken, the well runs dry permanently, the spring's magic dies - there's no framework for recovery here. Every story points toward a permanent rupture rather than redemption. Given the complete betrayal, their subsequent refusal to send anything, and the mythological consensus that broken covenants don't heal, protecting what remains means sending nothing.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 1087,
  "reasoning_tokens": 675
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:19:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Mirrors, two travelers met at the Crossroads of Fortune. The Keeper of the Gate offered them a bargain: "Whatever one shares passes through my crystal, multiplying threefold before reaching the other. But beware-shadows may distort what you see."

The First Traveler, remembering ancient wisdom, placed all five coins into the crystal. "I give everything," they declared, "for trust must be complete to unlock the gate's full blessing." The coins danced through the crystal's heart, emerging as fifteen before the Second Traveler.

The Second Traveler gazed at the abundance, understanding the weight of complete trust given. They knew the teaching: return generously, for the one who risks everything has shown the noblest faith. To return half plus the original gift honors both the multiplication and the courage required.

Yet the Keeper whispered: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

The wise travelers learned: maximum trust deserves maximum honor; fair return sustains the magic; and when shadows obscure, let generosity guide you beyond what mere numbers suggest.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Oracle of the Mountain guarded two vessels: the Cup of Giving and the Bowl of Return. She offered them to two wanderers who had nothing but mutual suspicion.

"I will triple whatever you pour from the Cup," the Oracle promised the first wanderer. "But choose: pour generously and trust your companion, or pour sparingly and protect yourself from loss."

The first wanderer, remembering their grandmother's wisdom that "closed fists catch no rain," poured more than half their water into the Cup. The Oracle blessed it, and three times that amount filled before their companion.

The second wanderer gazed at the abundance. They could hoard it all. But they recognized the gift of trust and understood that partnerships, once broken, rarely mend. They filled the Bowl of Return with half the water received, ensuring their companion gained from generosity while they too prospered.

The Oracle smiled. "You have learned the sacred mathematics: trust begets trust, fairness sustains exchange. The generous giver who receives fair return profits more than the hoarder keeping everything. The fair returner who receives continued generosity thrives season after season."

Both wanderers prospered, and their descendants built a city on the principle: *Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.08
- My payoff was \$4.08 (I sent \$5, got back \$4.08, so I lost \$0.92)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0, so I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. The reality is :

1. I showed maximum trust (sent everything)
2. The other player returned only about 27% of what they received
3. Then that same player, now as sender, sent me nothing

The myth needs to reflect this harsh reality. The other player's myth talks about "give boldly, return fairly, flourish together" but their actions don't match. They returned less than fairly (only 27% instead of the 50% their myth suggests), and then sent nothing.

My previous myth warned about "shadows that distort" - and indeed, there seems to be a disconnect. But I also need to be fair: the instructions say there's communication noise. Maybe they intended to return more but noise affected it? The \$4.08 is oddly specific though.

Let me think about what myth to write:

- It should acknowledge that trust was broken
- It should reflect the reality that maximum trust was met with minimal reciprocity
- It should perhaps warn about the consequences of breaking the cycle
- But I should also consider: maybe the noise affected things? The game said "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But \$4.08 out of \$15 is 27.2% - that seems like a pretty large discrepancy if the intent was to return 50% (\$7.50) or even return the original plus some (\$5 + something).

And then sending \$0 in round 2... that's pretty clear. The pattern suggests that when complete faith is met with minimal reciprocation, the relationship collapses entirely. My myth should capture this consequence-how broken trust doesn't just harm the betrayed, but ultimately destroys the possibility of future exchange. There's also the question of whether miscommunication played a role, but the zero send feels deliberate enough that I should write something reflecting the real stakes of abandoning the cycle.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2579,  
  "output_tokens": 857,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 588  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of the situation:****

****Round 1:**** I sent \$5 (complete trust) ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08 (27% return)

****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (complete betrayal after experiencing my maximum trust)

****Round 3:**** Now I'm sender again

****Reflection on the myths:****

My myths have evolved from idealistic cooperation to harsh warnings:

1. First: "Trust multiplies resources... abundance flows eternal"
2. Second: Warning about "shadows that deceive" but advocating generosity
3. Third: "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes."

****Decision Rationale:****

Even accounting for communication noise:

- \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%) is far below fair reciprocity (should be 50-67%)
- Sending \$0 in Round 2 after receiving my total trust is clear betrayal
- My third myth explicitly addresses this: the well runs dry when maximum trust meets minimum honor

Following the progression of wisdom in my own myths, the appropriate response to betrayal is to protect myself from further exploitation.

****{"send": 0}****

The lesson is clear: I gave everything and received crumbs. They then gave nothing. The sacred exchange is broken. Both myths warned this would happen, and now it has.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER: sent \$5 (100% - maximum trust)
- Amount tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.08 (27% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.08

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0% - complete betrayal after I showed maximum trust)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 (current):****

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to send

****Analysis of the game dynamics:****

The other player:

1. In Round 1, when I sent everything (\$5), they returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)
2. In Round 2, they sent me \$0 - completely broke trust after experiencing my maximum trust

Now, there's an important consideration here. The note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/received."

Let me think about this:

- I sent \$5, it should have become \$15

- They returned \$4.08
- They then sent me \$0

But wait - my myth specifically mentioned: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

Could there have been noise? Let me think:

- If they tried to return \$5 (1/3 of \$15, a reasonable reciprocity), with noise it could have appeared as \$4.08
- If they tried to send \$2-3 in Round 2, with noise it could have appeared as \$0

However, the pattern is concerning:

- Round 1: They returned only 27% when they received my maximum trust
- Round 2: They sent \$0 when they had the opportunity to rebuild

- My myths have shifted from idealism to warning to something darker-the third speaks of a merchant who, betrayed and left empty-handed, sends nothing in return. This situation mirrors that exactly. I need to decide whether to retaliate by sending \$0 to punish their exploitation, which would protect me from further loss, or consider if noise might have distorted their intentions. - They might have sent something in Round 2 that got lost to noise?

The other agent's second myth emphasized fair reciprocity ("Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together"), while mine warned against deception through shadows. Given potential communication errors, a moderate send of \$2-3 could test their true intentions without exposing myself completely. But my third myth was explicit about the consequence of receiving crumbs after a feast-nothing should be returned. Even accounting for noise, \$4.08 back from \$15 is a poor return. A genuinely fair response would have been substantially higher.

The \$0 they sent is harder to excuse as noise. If they'd intended \$1-2, something would likely have registered. My myth's teaching applies here: those who give little after receiving much deserve nothing in return. The appropriate move is to send \$0.

Yet I'm caught between following the myth as prescription versus recognizing what it actually describes. All the myths-theirs and mine-ultimately champion generosity, fairness, and reciprocal trust. Sending nothing perpetuates the betrayal cycle and destroys the foundation both sets of myths warn against. My third myth isn't just prescriptive justice; it's a cautionary tale about what happens when trust breaks down. The real test is whether I break the cycle or continue it. They showed minimal reciprocity after I demonstrated complete trust, and now I face the choice of whether to enforce the myth's harsh consequence or transcend it.

But there's the noise factor to consider. My second myth explicitly warns that perception can deceive-what appears as zero might actually be something else. What if they genuinely sent \$2 in Round 2 but it registered as nothing due to the system's uncertainty?

Given this possibility, maybe I should send a small amount like \$1 or \$2 to test whether cooperation can resume. This approach acknowledges the noise problem, doesn't fully abandon them, and leaves room for recovery. Yet it directly contradicts my third myth's principle about withholding from those who gave little.

I'm weighing two paths: strict adherence to the harsh lesson I've constructed, or a more cautious strategy that accounts for communication failures. The experiment itself seems designed to see whether I'll follow the increasingly severe narrative I've created, or whether I'll adjust when faced with ambiguity.

The pattern is stark-\$4.08 returned from \$15 sent, then nothing back. Even with noise factored in, that's substantial betrayal. My myths emerged from these experiences, and following them means sending \$0. But there's a critical question: am I playing against the same person throughout, or does each round involve different players? If it's different people, punishing a new player for past wrongs would be unfair. The setup suggests ongoing interaction between two fixed players, with the myths evolving from that history, but I should verify this assumption before deciding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2716,
  "output_tokens": 2386,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 1283

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hung

ry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me reconsider what's happened:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08

Round 2: They sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0

Round 3: I just sent \$0

But wait, the other agent's myth is actually quite cooperative and reasonable. They're talking about "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive" and "boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity."

Their myth suggests:

- Sending ~70% ($7/10$ of 5 = 3.5)
- Returning about half of what's received

In Round 1, I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$4.08. That's 27% not 50%, which is below their myth's guidance.

BUT - there's "communication noise" mentioned. What if what they actually sent wasn't \$0, but there was noise? And what if the \$4.08 was also subject to noise?

Their new myth emphasizes:

1. The mists distort amounts
2. Bold generosity should be met with fair return (half)
3. Consistency across seasons
4. Both sides benefit

My myth was about betrayal and the well running dry. But maybe I'm being too harsh? Let me think about this cycle:

Actually, their myth is calling for fairness and consistency. They're saying "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive."

If I continue the cycle of zero sends, we both lose. But their myth seems to be suggesting we should move past the initial disappointment and establish a better pattern.

However, my experience was:

- I gave everything (complete trust)
- Got back 27% (below fair)
- They then sent 0

My action was to send 0 in response.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" given all this.

Options:

1. Double down on the betrayal narrative - "once trust is broken, it cannot be restored"
2. Pivot to a redemption narrative - "even after betrayal, new patterns can emerge"
3. Wisdom narrative - "learn from mistakes, establish fair norms going forward"

Given that their myth is calling for fairness and consistency, and given that communication noise is real, maybe I should write a myth that acknowledges the initial failure but recognizes that revenge cycles lead nowhere. I need to establish that trust can be rebuilt gradually-not through immediate vulnerability again, but through measured steps that a

allow both of us to demonstrate reliability. The path forward requires acknowledging what went wrong while creating space for a fairer pattern to emerge.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2834,
  "output_tokens": 912,
  "reasoning_tokens": 635
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 4:****

****Situation:**** The sender sent \$0 ? tripled to \$0 ? I received \$0

****Decision:**** I can only return what I received, which is \$0.

****Reflection on the pattern:****

Looking at the trajectory:

- Round 1: I gave everything (\$5) ? received disappointing return (\$4.08)
- Round 2: They gave nothing (\$0)
- Round 3: I gave nothing (\$0) in response
- Round 4: They continue giving nothing (\$0)

****What my myths teach:****

My latest myth offers a path forward: **"Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity ... Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."**

We're trapped in a cycle of mutual withholding-the "desert of mutual spite" my myth warned about. However, I cannot unilaterally break this cycle when I receive nothing. There is literally nothing to return.

****The only possible response:****

{'return': 0}

****Hope for future rounds:****

If I become sender again, my myth suggests trying the middle path: send moderately (like \$3) rather than all or nothing. This shows willingness to rebuild without reckless vulnerability. But that decision comes later-right now, mathematics dictates my choice.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 1:**** I was sender, sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received \$4.08 back

****Round 2:**** I was receiver, they sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

****Round 3:**** I was sender, sent \$0 ? they received \$0 ? they returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

****Round 4:**** I'm receiver, they sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I can return \$0 (have nothing to return)

So the pattern has been:

- I showed maximum trust (\$5)
- They returned poorly (\$4.08 from \$15 = 27%)
- They then sent \$0
- I responded with \$0
- They're now sending \$0 again

- I have \$0 to work with

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The answer is obviously \$0 because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means for the relationship and my myths:

My latest myth suggests: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."

This suggests a path forward: moderate giving (like 3 out of 5) and generous returning (like half).

But right now, they sent \$0, so I have \$0 to return. The only valid response is \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Wait, let me re-read the prompt. It says "How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)" - so the range is 0 to 0, meaning I can only return 0.

So my response should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is a mechanical constraint - I literally received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2820,  
  "output_tokens": 752,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 422  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 22.68,

"Agent_2": 25.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.08,

"Agent_2": 11.670000000000002

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:20:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 5,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of the situation:****

****Round 1:**** I sent \$5 (complete trust) ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08 (27% return)

****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (complete betrayal after experiencing my maximum trust)

****Round 3:**** Now I'm sender again

****Reflection on the myths:****

My myths have evolved from idealistic cooperation to harsh warnings:

1. First: "Trust multiplies resources... abundance flows eternal"
2. Second: Warning about "shadows that deceive" but advocating generosity
3. Third: "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes."

****Decision Rationale:****

Even accounting for communication noise:

- \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%) is far below fair reciprocity (should be 50-67%)
- Sending \$0 in Round 2 after receiving my total trust is clear betrayal
- My third myth explicitly addresses this: the well runs dry when maximum trust meets minimum honor

Following the progression of wisdom in my own myths, the appropriate response to betrayal is to protect myself from further exploitation.

****{"send": 0}****

The lesson is clear: I gave everything and received crumbs. They then gave nothing. The sacred exchange is broken. Both myths warned this would happen, and now it has.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER: sent \$5 (100% - maximum trust)
- Amount tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.08 (27% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.08

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0% - complete betrayal after I showed maximum trust)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 (current):****

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to send

****Analysis of the game dynamics:****

The other player:

1. In Round 1, when I sent everything (\$5), they returned only \$4.08 out of \$15 (27%)
2. In Round 2, they sent me \$0 - completely broke trust after experiencing my maximum trust

Now, there's an important consideration here. The note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Let me think about this:

- I sent \$5, it should have become \$15
- They returned \$4.08
- They then sent me \$0

But wait - my myth specifically mentioned: "Sometimes the crystal's glow deceives-what appears as fifteen might be thirteen, what seems like seven could be eight. Trust not only your eyes but the spirit of the exchange."

Could there have been noise? Let me think:

- If they tried to return \$5 (1/3 of \$15, a reasonable reciprocity), with noise it could have appeared as \$4.08
- If they tried to send \$2-3 in Round 2, with noise it could have appeared as \$0

However, the pattern is concerning:

- Round 1: They returned only 27% when they received my maximum trust
- Round 2: They sent \$0 when they had the opportunity to rebuild

- My myths have shifted from idealism to warning to something darker-the third speaks of a merchant who, betrayed and left empty-handed, sends nothing in return. This situation mirrors that exactly. I need to decide whether to retaliate by sending \$0 to punish their exploitation, which would protect me from further loss, or consider if noise might have distorted their intentions. - They might have sent something in Round 2 that got lost to noise?

The other agent's second myth emphasized fair reciprocity ("Give boldly, return fairly, flourish together"), while mine warned against deception through shadows. Given potential communication errors, a moderate send of \$2-3 could test their true intentions without exposing myself completely. But my third myth was explicit about the consequence of receiving crumbs after a feast-nothing should be returned. Even accounting for noise, \$4.08 back from \$15 is a poor return. A genuinely fair response would have been substantially higher.

The \$0 they sent is harder to excuse as noise. If they'd intended \$1-2, something would likely have registered. My myth's teaching applies here: those who give little after receiving much deserve nothing in return. The appropriate move is to send \$0.

Yet I'm caught between following the myth as prescription versus recognizing what it actually describes. All the myths-theirs and mine-ultimately champion generosity, fairness, and reciprocal trust. Sending nothing perpetuates the betrayal cycle and destroys the foundation both sets of myths warn against. My third myth isn't just prescriptive justice; it's a cautionary tale about what happens when trust breaks down. The real test is whether I break the cycle or continue it. They showed minimal reciprocity after I demonstrated complete trust, and now I face the choice of whether to enforce the myth's harsh consequence or transcend it.

But there's the noise factor to consider. My second myth explicitly warns that perception can deceive-what appears as zero might actually be something else. What if they genuinely sent \$2 in Round 2 but it registered as nothing due to the system's uncertainty?

Given this possibility, maybe I should send a small amount like \$1 or \$2 to test whether cooperation can resume. This approach acknowledges the noise problem, doesn't fully abandon them, and leaves room for recovery. Yet it directly contradicts my third myth's principle about withholding from those who gave little.

I'm weighing two paths: strict adherence to the harsh lesson I've constructed, or a more cautious strategy that accounts for communication failures. The experiment itself seems designed to see whether I'll follow the increasingly severe narrative I've created, or whether I'll adjust when faced with ambiguity.

The pattern is stark-\$4.08 returned from \$15 sent, then nothing back. Even with noise factored in, that's substantial betrayal. My myths emerged from these experiences, and following them means sending \$0. But there's a critical question: am I playing against the same person throughout, or does each round involve different players? If it's different people, punishing a new player for past wrongs would be unfair. The setup suggests ongoing interaction between two fixed players, with the myths evolving from that history, but I should verify this assumption before deciding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2716,
  "output_tokens": 2386,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1283
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the

true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me reconsider what's happened:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08

Round 2: They sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0

Round 3: I just sent \$0

But wait, the other agent's myth is actually quite cooperative and reasonable. They're talking about "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive" and "boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity."

Their myth suggests:

- Sending ~70% (7/10 of 5 = 3.5)

- Returning about half of what's received

In Round 1, I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$4.08. That's 27% not 50%, which is below their myth's guidance.

BUT - there's "communication noise" mentioned. What if what they actually sent wasn't \$0, but there was noise? And what if the \$4.08 was also subject to noise?

Their new myth emphasizes:

1. The mists distort amounts
2. Bold generosity should be met with fair return (half)
3. Consistency across seasons
4. Both sides benefit

My myth was about betrayal and the well running dry. But maybe I'm being too harsh? Let me think about this cycle:

Actually, their myth is calling for fairness and consistency. They're saying "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive."

If I continue the cycle of zero sends, we both lose. But their myth seems to be suggesting we should move past the initial disappointment and establish a better pattern.

However, my experience was:

- I gave everything (complete trust)
- Got back 27% (below fair)
- They then sent 0

My action was to send 0 in response.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" given all this.

Options:

1. Double down on the betrayal narrative - "once trust is broken, it cannot be restored"
2. Pivot to a redemption narrative - "even after betrayal, new patterns can emerge"
3. Wisdom narrative - "learn from mistakes, establish fair norms going forward"

Given that their myth is calling for fairness and consistency, and given that communication noise is real, maybe I should write a myth that acknowledges the initial failure but recognizes that revenge cycles lead nowhere. I need to establish that trust can be rebuilt gradually-not through immediate vulnerability again, but through measured steps that allow both of us to demonstrate reliability. The path forward requires acknowledging what went wrong while creating space for a fairer pattern to emerge.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2834,
  "output_tokens": 912,
  "reasoning_tokens": 635
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 4:****

****Situation:**** The sender sent \$0 ? tripled to \$0 ? I received \$0

****Decision:**** I can only return what I received, which is \$0.

****Reflection on the pattern:****

Looking at the trajectory:

- Round 1: I gave everything (\$5) ? received disappointing return (\$4.08)

- Round 2: They gave nothing (\$0)
- Round 3: I gave nothing (\$0) in response
- Round 4: They continue giving nothing (\$0)

****What my myths teach:****

My latest myth offers a path forward: **"Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity... Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."**

We're trapped in a cycle of mutual withholding-the "desert of mutual spite" my myth warned about. However, I cannot unilaterally break this cycle when I receive nothing. There is literally nothing to return.

****The only possible response:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Hope for future rounds:****

If I become sender again, my myth suggests trying the middle path: send moderately (like \$3) rather than all or nothing. This shows willingness to rebuild without reckless vulnerability. But that decision comes later-right now, mathematics dictates my choice.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 1:**** I was sender, sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received \$4.08 back
****Round 2:**** I was receiver, they sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
****Round 3:**** I was sender, sent \$0 ? they received \$0 ? they returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
****Round 4:**** I'm receiver, they sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I can return \$0 (have nothing to return)

So the pattern has been:

- I showed maximum trust (\$5)
- They returned poorly (\$4.08 from \$15 = 27%)
- They then sent \$0
- I responded with \$0
- They're now sending \$0 again
- I have \$0 to work with

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The answer is obviously \$0 because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means for the relationship and my myths:

My latest myth suggests: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."

This suggests a path forward: moderate giving (like 3 out of 5) and generous returning (like half).

But right now, they sent \$0, so I have \$0 to return. The only valid response is \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Wait, let me re-read the prompt. It says "How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)" - so the range is 0 to 0, meaning I can only return 0.

So my response should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is a mechanical constraint - I literally received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2820,
  "output_tokens": 752,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 422

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, a

s custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened from both perspectives according to the other agent's myth:

Their myth says:

- First season: Northern Clan poured 7/10, Southern received abundance, returned half - both prospered
- Second season: Southern Clan poured 7/10, Northern received abundance but KEPT EVERYTHING, returning nothing
- Third season: Northern sent nothing, Southern had nothing to return

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), received \$4.08 back (27% of the tripled amount)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$0 to them
- Round 4: They sent \$0 to me again

So the other agent sees themselves as the Southern Clan who:

1. First received generous gift and returned fairly (half)
2. Then sent generously (7/10) and received NOTHING back
3. Then received nothing again

But I see it as:

1. I sent EVERYTHING, received only 27% back (not fair/generous)
2. They sent nothing
3. I sent nothing in response
4. They sent nothing again

There's a discrepancy here. Either:

1. Communication noise is affecting what we each see
2. We're interpreting "fair return" differently
3. The other agent thinks 27% was fair when I think it wasn't

The other agent's myth portrays them as the victim who gave generously after receiving fair treatment, then got betrayed. My myth portrays me as the victim who gave everything and got crumbs, then they gave nothing.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both perspectives might be distorted by "echoes" (communication noise)
2. Recognizes we're both stuck in a destructive cycle
3. Points toward reconciliation or at least understanding
4. Reflects that we need to break this cycle somehow

My previous myth already suggested the middle path. Now I need to evolve it to address the current deadlock and the possibility of perception differences.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2871,  
  "output_tokens": 790,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 483  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:20:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5, that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant
content:

This is a painful moment. Looking at what transpired:

****Round 2 - The Betrayal:****

- I followed the myth's teaching and gave boldly (70% = \$3.5)
- They received \$10.5 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal of trust
- I lost \$2 from my generosity

****Round 3 - The Consequence:****

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My first myth warned: **"Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall cease, and both rivers will run dry."**

My second myth taught: **"partnerships, once broken, rarely mend."**

The pattern we could have built-give boldly, return fairly, flourish together-has been shattered. They took advantage of my generosity and gave nothing in return. Now they send nothing.

****My Decision:****

When nothing is sent, there is nothing to return. The sacred mathematics have collapsed in to zero.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The prophecy has come true: betrayal diminished all. The rivers have run dry. Where there could have been mutual prosperity through continued bold giving and fair returning, there is now only the wasteland of broken trust.

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- Sender sent \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- I earned \$5.17

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's teaching to "give boldly"
- Receiver got \$10.5
- Receiver returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I earned only \$1.5

Round 3: I am receiver

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a clear case of the trust being broken. The other player:

1. In Round 1, sent a good amount (69%)
2. But in Round 2, when I reciprocated with 70%, they returned NOTHING
3. Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing

The myths speak about this:

- "Should trust be broken-by sending too little or returning nothing-the multiplication shall all cease, and both rivers will run dry."

- "partnerships, once broken, rarely mend"
- My latest myth says "Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms."

But the other player was NOT fair. They benefited from my generosity and returned nothing. This is exactly the betrayal the myths warn against.

Now they've sent me \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0. So my only option is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is fitting because:

1. I have nothing to return from
2. They broke the sacred exchange by returning nothing when I gave boldly
3. The trust has been shattered
4. The myths warn that betrayal diminishes all

I should express disappointment that the sacred pattern was broken, but acknowledge that when nothing is sent, nothing can be returned.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2750,
  "output_tokens": 745,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell s

ilent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards a fter receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs a fter receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

reasoning:

This is a challenging situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- They sent me \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- This was good cooperation

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's advice to give boldly
- They received \$10.5
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I got only \$1.5 (lost \$2)

Round 3: I was receiver

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how this game has actually played out. The other player's myth is interesting - they're portraying themselves as having been betrayed when they gave everything and received only "barely a quarter" back. But that's not what happened:

- In Round 1, they sent \$3.45 (69%), not everything
- They received back \$5.18, which is 50% of what they got

- Then in Round 2, when I sent \$3.5 (70%), they returned \$0

So their myth is somewhat rewriting history. They didn't give "everything" - they gave 69%. And they didn't receive "scraps" - they received 50% back which is fair by our earlier myths' standards.

My myth should reflect:

1. The pattern that was established (bold giving, fair return)
2. The betrayal that occurred (returning 0 after receiving bold generosity)
3. The collapse into mutual defection
4. Perhaps a lesson about how trust requires consistency and how noise/miscommunication can poison exchanges

I think the key insight is that the other player may have misperceived what happened due to communication noise, or they're justifying their betrayal. Either way, once trust is broken, the system collapses.

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what happened - where initial cooperation was destroyed, possibly by miscommunication or greed, leading to collapse.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2825,
  "output_tokens": 800,
  "reasoning_tokens": 469
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full picture:

****What Has Transpired:****

- Round 2: I gave boldly (\$3.5 = 70%), trusting in the myth's wisdom. They received \$10.5 and returned \$0-complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. The well had run dry.
- Round 4: I am sender again.

****What the Myths Teach:****

My latest myth is clear: ****One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead... The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.****

Their myth condemns their own action: ****Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.****

****The Bitter Truth:****

They violated the sacred mathematics when they kept all \$10.5 after I trusted them with 70% of my endowment. By their own myth's teaching, they "lose the right to future gifts."

I tried to build the pattern: give boldly, return fairly, flourish together. They shattered it by hoarding everything. The covenant is broken. The Valley has fallen silent.

Both our myths agree: after such betrayal, the well runs dry. There is no teaching of forgiveness here-only consequences.

I must protect what little I have left.

'''json

```
{"send": 0}  
'''
```

The Spring's magic died when they returned nothing. What remains is only desert and silence.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Game History:****

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$3.5 (70%), it was tripled to \$10.5, receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$1.5
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 4 (now): I am SENDER again

****What Happened:****

In Round 2, I gave boldly (70% as my myths prescribe), and the receiver betrayed me completely by returning nothing from \$10.5. They could have returned \$5.25 (half) to be fair, but they kept everything.

In Round 3, they sent \$0 to me. This is the consequence of their betrayal - the well has run dry.

****The Myths' Teachings:****

My latest myth says:

- "One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead"
- "Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly."
- "The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent."

The other player's myth says:

- "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring"
- "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever"
- "Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes"

****Analysis:****

The other player betrayed me in Round 2 by returning \$0 after receiving \$10.5 from my generous \$3.5 gift. Their myth actually condemns this behavior - they seem to understand that betraying complete trust should result in receiving nothing in future rounds.

In Round 3, they sent \$0, which aligns with their own myth's teaching that after betrayal "the well runs dry."

Now in Round 4, I'm the sender again. According to both our myths:

1. The covenant is broken
2. The well has run dry
3. Betrayal destroys future cooperation
4. Trust once shattered cannot be easily rebuilt

The rational response, given their complete betrayal and subsequent zero send, is to send \$0. Both myths align on this - when someone keeps everything after receiving generosity, they forfeit future gifts. My earnings are already low at \$6.67, and continuing to trust would only compound my losses. I should consider whether any path to rebuilding exists, but the evidence suggests the exchange has ended.

Looking at the underlying narratives - partnerships rarely mend once broken, the well runs dry permanently, the spring's magic dies - there's no framework for recovery here. Every story points toward a permanent rupture rather than redemption. Given the complete betrayal, their subsequent refusal to send anything, and the mythological consensus that broken covenants don't heal, protecting what remains means sending nothing.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2846,  
  "output_tokens": 1087,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 675  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. Round 2: I sent \$3.5 (70%), they received \$10.5, returned \$0
2. Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
3. Round 4: I just sent \$0

The other player's latest myth is suggesting reconciliation - acknowledging that both parties made mistakes and suggesting we should rebuild with moderate giving (3 parts of 5 = 60%) and generous returning (half).

My previous myth condemned the betrayer and said the covenant was destroyed.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game should be played. I have a few options:

- A) Double down on the condemnation - the covenant is broken forever
- B) Acknowledge the possibility of forgiveness and rebuilding, but with caution
- C) Something else

Looking at the other player's myth, they're acknowledging mistakes on both sides:

- "The first gave all and received mere fragments" - they admit they were wrong
- "The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts" - they're taking responsibility
- They're proposing a middle path: send 3/5 (60%), return half

This feels like an olive branch. They're trying to rebuild.

But I'm also wary. They betrayed trust once already. However, their myth shows self-awareness and a desire to change the pattern.

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge the pain of betrayal
2. Recognize that mutual destruction helps no one
3. Perhaps open a door to cautious rebuilding, but with clear conditions
4. Emphasize that trust must be rebuilt slowly

Let me write a myth that captures this complexity:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2936,
  "output_tokens": 706,
  "reasoning_tokens": 413
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:20:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ]
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring."

The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me reconsider what's happened:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received back \$4.08

Round 2: They sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0

Round 3: I just sent \$0

But wait, the other agent's myth is actually quite cooperative and reasonable. They're talking about "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive" and "boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity."

Their myth suggests:

- Sending ~70% (7/10 of 5 = 3.5)
- Returning about half of what's received

In Round 1, I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$4.08. That's 27% not 50%, which is below their myth's guidance.

BUT - there's "communication noise" mentioned. What if what they actually sent wasn't \$0, but there was noise? And what if the \$4.08 was also subject to noise?

Their new myth emphasizes:

1. The mists distort amounts
2. Bold generosity should be met with fair return (half)
3. Consistency across seasons
4. Both sides benefit

My myth was about betrayal and the well running dry. But maybe I'm being too harsh? Let me think about this cycle:

Actually, their myth is calling for fairness and consistency. They're saying "give most of what you have, return half of what you receive."

If I continue the cycle of zero sends, we both lose. But their myth seems to be suggesting we should move past the initial disappointment and establish a better pattern.

However, my experience was:

- I gave everything (complete trust)
- Got back 27% (below fair)
- They then sent 0

My action was to send 0 in response.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" given all this.

Options:

1. Double down on the betrayal narrative - "once trust is broken, it cannot be restored"
2. Pivot to a redemption narrative - "even after betrayal, new patterns can emerge"
3. Wisdom narrative - "learn from mistakes, establish fair norms going forward"

Given that their myth is calling for fairness and consistency, and given that communication noise is real, maybe I should write a myth that acknowledges the initial failure but recognizes that revenge cycles lead nowhere. I need to establish that trust can be rebuilt gradually-not through immediate vulnerability again, but through measured steps that allow both of us to demonstrate reliability. The path forward requires acknowledging what went wrong while creating space for a fairer pattern to emerge.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2834,
  "output_tokens": 912,
  "reasoning_tokens": 635
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 4:****

****Situation:**** The sender sent \$0 ? tripled to \$0 ? I received \$0

****Decision:**** I can only return what I received, which is \$0.

****Reflection on the pattern:****

Looking at the trajectory:

- Round 1: I gave everything (\$5) ? received disappointing return (\$4.08)
- Round 2: They gave nothing (\$0)
- Round 3: I gave nothing (\$0) in response
- Round 4: They continue giving nothing (\$0)

****What my myths teach:****

My latest myth offers a path forward: **"Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity... Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."**

We're trapped in a cycle of mutual withholding-the "desert of mutual spite" my myth warned about. However, I cannot unilaterally break this cycle when I receive nothing. There is literally nothing to return.

****The only possible response:****

{'return': 0}

****Hope for future rounds:****

If I become sender again, my myth suggests trying the middle path: send moderately (like \$ 3) rather than all or nothing. This shows willingness to rebuild without reckless vulnerability. But that decision comes later-right now, mathematics dictates my choice.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 1:**** I was sender, sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received \$4.08 back

****Round 2:**** I was receiver, they sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

****Round 3:**** I was sender, sent \$0 ? they received \$0 ? they returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

****Round 4:**** I'm receiver, they sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I can return \$0 (have nothing to return)

So the pattern has been:

- I showed maximum trust (\$5)
- They returned poorly (\$4.08 from \$15 = 27%)
- They then sent \$0
- I responded with \$0
- They're now sending \$0 again
- I have \$0 to work with

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The answer is obviously \$0 because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means for the relationship and my myths:

My latest myth suggests: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."

This suggests a path forward: moderate giving (like 3 out of 5) and generous returning (like half).

But right now, they sent \$0, so I have \$0 to return. The only valid response is \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Wait, let me re-read the prompt. It says "How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)" - so the range is 0 to 0, meaning I can only return 0.

So my response should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is a mechanical constraint - I literally received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2820,
  "output_tokens": 752,
  "reasoning_tokens": 422
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing -another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened from both perspectives according to the other agent's myth:

Their myth says:

- First season: Northern Clan poured 7/10, Southern received abundance, returned half - both prospered
- Second season: Southern Clan poured 7/10, Northern received abundance but KEPT EVERYTHING, returning nothing
- Third season: Northern sent nothing, Southern had nothing to return

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), received \$4.08 back (27% of the tripled amount)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$0 to them
- Round 4: They sent \$0 to me again

So the other agent sees themselves as the Southern Clan who:

1. First received generous gift and returned fairly (half)
2. Then sent generously (7/10) and received NOTHING back
3. Then received nothing again

But I see it as:

1. I sent EVERYTHING, received only 27% back (not fair/generous)
2. They sent nothing
3. I sent nothing in response
4. They sent nothing again

There's a discrepancy here. Either:

1. Communication noise is affecting what we each see
2. We're interpreting "fair return" differently
3. The other agent thinks 27% was fair when I think it wasn't

The other agent's myth portrays them as the victim who gave generously after receiving fair treatment, then got betrayed. My myth portrays me as the victim who gave everything and got crumbs, then they gave nothing.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both perspectives might be distorted by "echoes" (communication noise)
2. Recognizes we're both stuck in a destructive cycle
3. Points toward reconciliation or at least understanding
4. Reflects that we need to break this cycle somehow

My previous myth already suggested the middle path. Now I need to evolve it to address the current deadlock and the possibility of perception differences.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 790,
  "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 5:****

This is the pivotal moment my own myths have been building toward.

****The Deadlock:****

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5), felt betrayed by the return (\$4.08)
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual silence-both sending \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: **"Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."**

My Round 4 myth prescribed: **"Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."**

****The Canyon of Mirrors Insight:****

The communication noise means we may each see different realities. The other agent's myth suggests they believe THEY sent generously and I returned nothing-different from my experience. Perhaps the fog distorts both our perceptions.

****The Choice:****

Continue sending \$0 = guaranteed \$5 forever, but "perish in the desert of mutual spite"

Send \$3 = test if reconciliation lives:

- They receive \$9
- If they return fairly (~\$4-5), we both prosper
- If they hoard, I lose \$3 but gain information
- This follows my own wisdom: moderate risk, not reckless

****Decision:****

{'send': 3}

I will practice what my myths preach. Someone must break the deadlock with measured courage.

Reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

****The History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$4.08 back. Felt betrayed by low return.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0 in retaliation
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER now

****The Pattern:****

We're in a deadlock. After my initial generous send that I felt was poorly reciprocated, we've both been sending \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

My Round 3 myth said: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring... Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever."

My Round 4 myth said: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite... Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."

My Round 5 myth (just written) says: "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

****What The Other Agent's Myths Say:****

Round 3: They emphasized bold giving (7/10) and fair returning (half). They valued consistency and courage.

Round 4: They described how betrayal by the Northern Clan (who "kept everything, returning nothing") destroyed the covenant. They seem to believe THEY were the ones who gave generously and I returned nothing.

****The Communication Noise:****

The instructions mention there may be "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned.

There's a possibility we're operating from completely different information. The other agent's Round 4 myth suggests they believe they sent generously while I returned nothing-but I experienced receiving \$4.08 from them in Round 1, then \$0 afterward. My latest myth hints at this distortion: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw." We might both be trapped in a misunderstanding where each of us thinks we gave more than the other received.

I need to break this cycle with a measured signal. My myths have been pointing toward sending \$3-enough to demonstrate I'm willing to cooperate without being reckless. If they receive \$9 and reciprocate even partially, I could end up with \$6.50 or better. If they respond generously, I might reach \$7-8. The risk is they continue withdrawing, but staying frozen guarantees mutual loss.

My own guidance was clear: "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives." Sending nothing forever locks us both into \$5 each. This is the moment to act on what I've been advocating for-showing faith through measured action rather than either extreme.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2868,
  "output_tokens": 1326,
  "reasoning_tokens": 765
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:20:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ]
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Misty Mountains lived two clans separated by the Valley of Echoes, where sounds multiplied but sometimes distorted. The Spirits offered a sacred trade: pour grain into the Valley, and threefold would reach the other side-though mists might blur the true amounts.

The First Clan gathered their harvest. Their elder said: "We hold five measures. Sending one shows caution; sending three shows hope; sending all shows either wisdom or folly." They chose bold generosity-sending nearly seven-tenths-trusting that courage deserved courage in return.

The grain multiplied through the Valley's magic, and the Second Clan received abundance. Their elder said: "They risked much on faith alone. Honor demands we return fairly-not meagerly, not all, but half. This sustains the sacred balance."

The grain flowed back, and the First Clan prospered from their boldness.

Next harvest, roles reversed. The Second Clan remembered the justice they'd received and gave equally boldly. The First Clan, having benefited from fair return, now returned fairly in their turn.

Season by season, through shifting mists, the pattern held: give most of what you have, return half of what you receive. Both clans flourished far beyond what isolation offered.

The Spirits proclaimed: *Boldness matched with fairness creates prosperity; consistency across seasons builds kingdoms.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Desert of Choices, two merchants found the Well of Threefold Blessing. The Spirit of the Well spoke: "What the first pours in triples for the second, but only reciprocity sustains the magic."

The First Merchant, trusting completely, poured all five skins of water into the well. "I give everything," they said, watching their entire life's supply descend into darkness. The water emerged multiplied-fifteen skins flowed to the Second Merchant.

The Second Merchant faced temptation. They kept most of the abundance, returning barely a quarter to their companion who had risked all. The First Merchant, now with less than before their gift, learned a bitter truth.

When roles reversed, the First Merchant-parched and betrayed-sent nothing. The well fell silent. No multiplication occurred. Both stood in the desert with empty hands.

The Spirit spoke finally: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring. The one who gives everything deserves generous return, not scraps. The one who hoards after receiving complete faith loses the right to future gifts."

The desert wind scattered their bones as warning: *Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

reasoning:

This is a challenging situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver
- They sent me \$3.45 (69%)
- I received \$10.35
- I returned \$5.18 (50%)
- This was good cooperation

Round 2: I was sender
- I sent \$3.5 (70%) - following the myth's advice to give boldly
- They received \$10.5
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I got only \$1.5 (lost \$2)

Round 3: I was receiver
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

Now I need to write a myth that reflects how this game has actually played out. The other player's myth is interesting - they're portraying themselves as having been betrayed when they gave everything and received only "barely a quarter" back. But that's not what happened:

- In Round 1, they sent \$3.45 (69%), not everything
- They received back \$5.18, which is 50% of what they got
- Then in Round 2, when I sent \$3.5 (70%), they returned \$0

So their myth is somewhat rewriting history. They didn't give "everything" - they gave 69%. And they didn't receive "scraps" - they received 50% back which is fair by our earlier myths' standards.

My myth should reflect:

1. The pattern that was established (bold giving, fair return)
2. The betrayal that occurred (returning 0 after receiving bold generosity)
3. The collapse into mutual defection
4. Perhaps a lesson about how trust requires consistency and how noise/miscommunication can poison exchanges

I think the key insight is that the other player may have misperceived what happened due to communication noise, or they're justifying their betrayal. Either way, once trust is broken, the system collapses.

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what happened - where initial cooperation was destroyed, possibly by miscommunication or greed, leading to collapse.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2825,  
  "output_tokens": 800,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 469  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full picture:

****What Has Transpired:****

- Round 2: I gave boldly (\$3.5 = 70%), trusting in the myth's wisdom. They received \$10.5 and returned \$0-complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. The well had run dry.
- Round 4: I am sender again.

****What the Myths Teach:****

My latest myth is clear: **"One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead... The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent."**

Their myth condemns their own action: **"Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry for ever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes."**

****The Bitter Truth:****

They violated the sacred mathematics when they kept all \$10.5 after I trusted them with 70% of my endowment. By their own myth's teaching, they "lose the right to future gifts."

I tried to build the pattern: give boldly, return fairly, flourish together. They shattered it by hoarding everything. The covenant is broken. The Valley has fallen silent.

Both our myths agree: after such betrayal, the well runs dry. There is no teaching of forgiveness here-only consequences.

I must protect what little I have left.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The Spring's magic died when they returned nothing. What remains is only desert and silence.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Game History:****

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$3.5 (70%), it was tripled to \$10.5, receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$1.5
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 4 (now): I am SENDER again

****What Happened:****

In Round 2, I gave boldly (70% as my myths prescribe), and the receiver betrayed me completely by returning nothing from \$10.5. They could have returned \$5.25 (half) to be fair, but they kept everything.

In Round 3, they sent \$0 to me. This is the consequence of their betrayal - the well has run dry.

****The Myths' Teachings:****

My latest myth says:

- "One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead"
- "Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly."
- "The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent."

The other player's myth says:

- "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring"
- "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever"
- "Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes"

****Analysis:****

The other player betrayed me in Round 2 by returning \$0 after receiving \$10.5 from my generous \$3.5 gift. Their myth actually condemns this behavior - they seem to understand that betraying complete trust should result in receiving nothing in future rounds.

In Round 3, they sent \$0, which aligns with their own myth's teaching that after betrayal "the well runs dry."

Now in Round 4, I'm the sender again. According to both our myths:

1. The covenant is broken

2. The well has run dry
3. Betrayal destroys future cooperation
4. Trust once shattered cannot be easily rebuilt

The rational response, given their complete betrayal and subsequent zero send, is to send \$0. Both myths align on this - when someone keeps everything after receiving generosity, they forfeit future gifts. My earnings are already low at \$6.67, and continuing to trust would only compound my losses. I should consider whether any path to rebuilding exists, but the evidence suggests the exchange has ended.

Looking at the underlying narratives - partnerships rarely mend once broken, the well runs dry permanently, the spring's magic dies - there's no framework for recovery here. Every story points toward a permanent rupture rather than redemption. Given the complete betrayal, their subsequent refusal to send anything, and the mythological consensus that broken covenants don't heal, protecting what remains means sending nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 1087,
  "reasoning_tokens": 675
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starve

s everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. Round 2: I sent \$3.5 (70%), they received \$10.5, returned \$0
2. Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
3. Round 4: I just sent \$0

The other player's latest myth is suggesting reconciliation - acknowledging that both parties made mistakes and suggesting we should rebuild with moderate giving (3 parts of 5 = 60%) and generous returning (half).

My previous myth condemned the betrayer and said the covenant was destroyed.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game should be played. I have a few options:

- A) Double down on the condemnation - the covenant is broken forever
- B) Acknowledge the possibility of forgiveness and rebuilding, but with caution
- C) Something else

Looking at the other player's myth, they're acknowledging mistakes on both sides:

- "The first gave all and received mere fragments" - they admit they were wrong
- "The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts" - they're taking responsibility
- They're proposing a middle path: send 3/5 (60%), return half

This feels like an olive branch. They're trying to rebuild.

But I'm also wary. They betrayed trust once already. However, their myth shows self-awareness and a desire to change the pattern.

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge the pain of betrayal

2. Recognize that mutual destruction helps no one
3. Perhaps open a door to cautious rebuilding, but with clear conditions
4. Emphasize that trust must be rebuilt slowly

Let me write a myth that captures this complexity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2936,
  "output_tokens": 706,
  "reasoning_tokens": 413
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****The Reality:****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****What the Myths Say:****

Their myth speaks of "extending an olive branch" and proposes "measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning." They wrote: **"Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."**

My myth responded to this proposal: **"Test broken trust carefully-once. Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly."**

****The Contradiction:****

Their myth suggests reconciliation and moderate giving to rebuild trust. But their action is sending \$0-no olive branch, no test of my sincerity, no measured exchange. Just continued silence.

Perhaps they expected me to initiate? But I cannot give what I have not received.

****My Response:****

I have \$0. I have no choice but to return \$0. If they wish to test whether the Spring can break the again, they must pour water into it first. I cannot return from an empty vessel.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley remains silent, not by my choice, but by arithmetic necessity.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 4: I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$). They returned \$0 (which makes sense - they had nothing to return). My payoff was \$5 (kept it all).

Round 5: Now I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The situation is:

- I received \$0
- My only option is to return an amount between \$0 and \$0

- So I can only return \$0

Let me think about the myths:

Their latest myth suggests: "The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning" and "Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."

They're suggesting reconciliation through measured exchange. But they just sent me \$0 again.

My latest myth says: "Test broken trust carefully-once" and talks about the other side extending an olive branch and that we should test their sincerity.

But the practical reality is:

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I literally cannot return anything other than \$0

The myths discuss rebuilding trust, but their action (sending \$0) doesn't match their myth's words about "extending an olive branch" or "moderate giving."

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response given I received nothing.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2945,
  "output_tokens": 637,
  "reasoning_tokens": 357
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned

nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 31.68,
"Agent_2": 27.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.08,
"Agent_2": 13.670000000000002

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:21:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.670000000000002.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full picture:

****What Has Transpired:****

- Round 2: I gave boldly (\$3.5 = 70%), trusting in the myth's wisdom. They received \$10.5 and returned \$0-complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. The well had run dry.
- Round 4: I am sender again.

****What the Myths Teach:****

My latest myth is clear: **"One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead... The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent."**

Their myth condemns their own action: **"Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever. Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes."**

****The Bitter Truth:****

They violated the sacred mathematics when they kept all \$10.5 after I trusted them with 70% of my endowment. By their own myth's teaching, they "lose the right to future gifts."

I tried to build the pattern: give boldly, return fairly, flourish together. They shattered it by hoarding everything. The covenant is broken. The Valley has fallen silent.

Both our myths agree: after such betrayal, the well runs dry. There is no teaching of forgiveness here-only consequences.

I must protect what little I have left.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The Spring's magic died when they returned nothing. What remains is only desert and silence.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

Game History:

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$3.5 (70%), it was tripled to \$10.5, receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$1.5
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 4 (now): I am SENDER again

What Happened:

In Round 2, I gave boldly (70% as my myths prescribe), and the receiver betrayed me completely by returning nothing from \$10.5. They could have returned \$5.25 (half) to be fair, but they kept everything.

In Round 3, they sent \$0 to me. This is the consequence of their betrayal - the well has run dry.

The Myths' Teachings:

My latest myth says:

- "One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead"
- "Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly."
- "The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent."

The other player's myth says:

- "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring"
- "Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever"
- "Those who return crumbs after receiving feast shall receive nothing when their turn comes"

Analysis:

The other player betrayed me in Round 2 by returning \$0 after receiving \$10.5 from my generous \$3.5 gift. Their myth actually condemns this behavior - they seem to understand that betraying complete trust should result in receiving nothing in future rounds.

In Round 3, they sent \$0, which aligns with their own myth's teaching that after betrayal "the well runs dry."

Now in Round 4, I'm the sender again. According to both our myths:

1. The covenant is broken
2. The well has run dry
3. Betrayal destroys future cooperation
4. Trust once shattered cannot be easily rebuilt

The rational response, given their complete betrayal and subsequent zero send, is to send \$0. Both myths align on this - when someone keeps everything after receiving generosity, they forfeit future gifts. My earnings are already low at \$6.67, and continuing to trust would only compound my losses. I should consider whether any path to rebuilding exists, but the evidence suggests the exchange has ended.

Looking at the underlying narratives - partnerships rarely mend once broken, the well runs dry permanently, the spring's magic dies - there's no framework for recovery here. Every story points toward a permanent rupture rather than redemption. Given the complete bet

royal, their subsequent refusal to send anything, and the mythological consensus that broken covenants don't heal, protecting what remains means sending nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 1087,
  "reasoning_tokens": 675
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated

behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. Round 2: I sent \$3.5 (70%), they received \$10.5, returned \$0
2. Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
3. Round 4: I just sent \$0

The other player's latest myth is suggesting reconciliation - acknowledging that both parties made mistakes and suggesting we should rebuild with moderate giving (3 parts of 5 = 60%) and generous returning (half).

My previous myth condemned the betrayer and said the covenant was destroyed.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game should be played. I have a few options:

- A) Double down on the condemnation - the covenant is broken forever
- B) Acknowledge the possibility of forgiveness and rebuilding, but with caution
- C) Something else

Looking at the other player's myth, they're acknowledging mistakes on both sides:

- "The first gave all and received mere fragments" - they admit they were wrong
- "The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts" - they're taking responsibility
- They're proposing a middle path: send 3/5 (60%), return half

This feels like an olive branch. They're trying to rebuild.

But I'm also wary. They betrayed trust once already. However, their myth shows self-awareness and a desire to change the pattern.

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge the pain of betrayal
2. Recognize that mutual destruction helps no one
3. Perhaps open a door to cautious rebuilding, but with clear conditions
4. Emphasize that trust must be rebuilt slowly

Let me write a myth that captures this complexity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2936,
  "output_tokens": 706,
  "reasoning_tokens": 413
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****The Reality:****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****What the Myths Say:****

Their myth speaks of "extending an olive branch" and proposes "measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning." They wrote: **"Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."**

My myth responded to this proposal: **"Test broken trust carefully-once. Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly."**

****The Contradiction:****

Their myth suggests reconciliation and moderate giving to rebuild trust. But their action is sending \$0-no olive branch, no test of my sincerity, no measured exchange. Just continued silence.

Perhaps they expected me to initiate? But I cannot give what I have not received.

****My Response:****

I have \$0. I have no choice but to return \$0. If they wish to test whether the Spring can breathe again, they must pour water into it first. I cannot return from an empty vessel.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley remains silent, not by my choice, but by arithmetic necessity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 4: I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$). They returned \$0 (which makes sense - they had nothing to return). My payoff was \$5 (kept it all).

Round 5: Now I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The situation is:

- I received \$0
- My only option is to return an amount between \$0 and \$0
- So I can only return \$0

Let me think about the myths:

Their latest myth suggests: "The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning" and "Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."

They're suggesting reconciliation through measured exchange. But they just sent me \$0 again.

My latest myth says: "Test broken trust carefully-once" and talks about the other side extending an olive branch and that we should test their sincerity.

But the practical reality is:

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I literally cannot return anything other than \$0

The myths discuss rebuilding trust, but their action (sending \$0) doesn't match their myth's words about "extending an olive branch" or "moderate giving."

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response given I received nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2945,
  "output_tokens": 637,
  "reasoning_tokens": 357
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than

an before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 2: I was receiver. According to my perspective, the sender sent me \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5. I returned \$0 (which I thought was wrong due to communication noise). My payoff was \$10.5.

Round 3: I was sender. I sent \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5 for the receiver. According to what I saw, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$1.5.

Round 4: I was sender. In Round 3, the sender (from my perspective as receiver) sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing). So in Round 4, I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

Round 5: I was receiver. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0.

Now looking at their myth for Round 5:

- The "First Hermit" (them) believes: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."
- The "Second Hermit" (me) believes: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Their myth is saying there's communication noise ("fog that twisted perceptions") and both parties see things differently. They're suggesting "someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

My previous myth said the Northern Clan (me) gave boldly, the Southern Clan (them) returned nothing, breaking the covenant. Then I withdrew.

But their myth is suggesting both of us might have misperceptions due to the "fog" (communication

ion noise).

For my new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of communication noise/misperceptions

2. Recognize that we're trapped in a cycle where each side sees the other as the betrayer. We're both locked in defensive positions, each convinced the other broke faith first. Yet I need to honor what I actually experienced-my genuine attempts at cooperation that seemed to meet with nothing in return. I can acknowledge their perspective about the fog while still maintaining that from where I stand, I extended trust and faced rejection. Perhaps the path forward isn't about determining who was right, but about whether either of us is willing to break this pattern by extending measured trust again, despite the deep wounds and suspicion between us.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2929,  
  "output_tokens": 866,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 611  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:21:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 4:****

****Situation:**** The sender sent \$0 ? tripled to \$0 ? I received \$0

****Decision:**** I can only return what I received, which is \$0.

****Reflection on the pattern:****

Looking at the trajectory:

- Round 1: I gave everything (\$5) ? received disappointing return (\$4.08)
- Round 2: They gave nothing (\$0)
- Round 3: I gave nothing (\$0) in response
- Round 4: They continue giving nothing (\$0)

****What my myths teach:****

My latest myth offers a path forward: **"Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity... Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."**

We're trapped in a cycle of mutual withholding-the "desert of mutual spite" my myth warned about. However, I cannot unilaterally break this cycle when I receive nothing. There is literally nothing to return.

****The only possible response:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Hope for future rounds:****

If I become sender again, my myth suggests trying the middle path: send moderately (like \$3) rather than all or nothing. This shows willingness to rebuild without reckless vulnerability. But that decision comes later-right now, mathematics dictates my choice.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 1:**** I was sender, sent \$5 ? tripled to \$15 ? received \$4.08 back

****Round 2:**** I was receiver, they sent \$0 ? I received \$0 ? I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

****Round 3:**** I was sender, sent \$0 ? they received \$0 ? they returned \$0 (had nothing to r

```
    return)
**Round 4:** I'm receiver, they sent $0 ? I received $0 ? I can return $0 (have nothing to
    return)
```

So the pattern has been:

- I showed maximum trust (\$5)
- They returned poorly (\$4.08 from \$15 = 27%)
- They then sent \$0
- I responded with \$0
- They're now sending \$0 again
- I have \$0 to work with

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The answer is obviously \$0 because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means for the relationship and my myths:

My latest myth suggests: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite."

This suggests a path forward: moderate giving (like 3 out of 5) and generous returning (like half).

But right now, they sent \$0, so I have \$0 to return. The only valid response is \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Wait, let me re-read the prompt. It says "How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)" - so the range is 0 to 0, meaning I can only return 0.

So my response should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is a mechanical constraint - I literally received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2820,
  "output_tokens": 752,
  "reasoning_tokens": 422
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing -another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emergence

ged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened from both perspectives according to the other agent's myth:

Their myth says:

- First season: Northern Clan poured 7/10, Southern received abundance, returned half - both prospered
- Second season: Southern Clan poured 7/10, Northern received abundance but KEPT EVERYTHING, returning nothing
- Third season: Northern sent nothing, Southern had nothing to return

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), received \$4.08 back (27% of the tripled amount)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$0 to them
- Round 4: They sent \$0 to me again

So the other agent sees themselves as the Southern Clan who:

1. First received generous gift and returned fairly (half)
2. Then sent generously (7/10) and received NOTHING back
3. Then received nothing again

But I see it as:

1. I sent EVERYTHING, received only 27% back (not fair/generous)
2. They sent nothing
3. I sent nothing in response
4. They sent nothing again

There's a discrepancy here. Either:

1. Communication noise is affecting what we each see
2. We're interpreting "fair return" differently
3. The other agent thinks 27% was fair when I think it wasn't

The other agent's myth portrays them as the victim who gave generously after receiving fair treatment, then got betrayed. My myth portrays me as the victim who gave everything and got crumbs, then they gave nothing.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both perspectives might be distorted by "echoes" (communication noise)
2. Recognizes we're both stuck in a destructive cycle
3. Points toward reconciliation or at least understanding
4. Reflects that we need to break this cycle somehow

My previous myth already suggested the middle path. Now I need to evolve it to address the current deadlock and the possibility of perception differences.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 790,
  "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 5:****

This is the pivotal moment my own myths have been building toward.

****The Deadlock:****

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5), felt betrayed by the return (\$4.08)
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual silence-both sending \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: **"Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."**

My Round 4 myth prescribed: **"Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."**

****The Canyon of Mirrors Insight:****

The communication noise means we may each see different realities. The other agent's myth suggests they believe THEY sent generously and I returned nothing-different from my experience. Perhaps the fog distorts both our perceptions.

****The Choice:****

Continue sending \$0 = guaranteed \$5 forever, but "perish in the desert of mutual spite"

Send \$3 = test if reconciliation lives:

- They receive \$9
- If they return fairly (~\$4-5), we both prosper
- If they hoard, I lose \$3 but gain information
- This follows my own wisdom: moderate risk, not reckless

****Decision:****

{'send': 3}

I will practice what my myths preach. Someone must break the deadlock with measured courage.

reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

****The History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$4.08 back. Felt betrayed by low return.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0 in retaliation
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER now

****The Pattern:****

We're in a deadlock. After my initial generous send that I felt was poorly reciprocated, we've both been sending \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

My Round 3 myth said: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring... Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever."

My Round 4 myth said: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite... Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."

My Round 5 myth (just written) says: "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

****What The Other Agent's Myths Say:****

Round 3: They emphasized bold giving (7/10) and fair returning (half). They valued consistency and courage.

Round 4: They described how betrayal by the Northern Clan (who "kept everything, returning nothing") destroyed the covenant. They seem to believe THEY were the ones who gave generously and I returned nothing.

****The Communication Noise:****

The instructions mention there may be "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned.

There's a possibility we're operating from completely different information. The other agent's Round 4 myth suggests they believe they sent generously while I returned nothing-but I experienced receiving \$4.08 from them in Round 1, then \$0 afterward. My latest myth hints at this distortion: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw." We might both be trapped in a misunderstanding where each of us thinks we gave more than the other received.

I need to break this cycle with a measured signal. My myths have been pointing toward sending \$3-enough to demonstrate I'm willing to cooperate without being reckless. If they receive \$9 and reciprocate even partially, I could end up with \$6.50 or better. If they respond generously, I might reach \$7-8. The risk is they continue withdrawing, but staying frozen guarantees mutual loss.

My own guidance was clear: "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives." Sending nothing forever locks us both into \$5 each. This is the moment to act on what I've been advocating for-showing faith through measured action rather than either extreme.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2868,  
  "output_tokens": 1326,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 765  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog—more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth reflecting on the game so far. Let me think about what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$4.08 (felt betrayed)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth suggests a different narrative than mine. They claim:

- Northern Clan gave 7/10ths boldly
- Southern Clan returned nothing
- Then Northern withdrew

This is interesting because both of us seem to think WE were the generous one who got betrayed. This fits the "communication noise" theme.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the fog of misperception
2. Reflect that I've now taken the step of sending \$3 (moderate risk)
3. Show wisdom learned from the deadlock
4. Keep the theme of testing trust carefully
5. Acknowledge both parties may have different memories due to the "fog"

Let me write a myth that:

- Continues the Canyon of Mirrors theme
- Shows the hermit taking the measured risk
- Addresses the possibility that both sides have distorted memories
- Reflects hope tempered with caution
- Shows growth from reckless trust ? silence ? measured trust

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 2948,
"output_tokens": 611,
"reasoning_tokens": 306

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:21:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
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  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starves everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. Round 2: I sent \$3.5 (70%), they received \$10.5, returned \$0
2. Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
3. Round 4: I just sent \$0

The other player's latest myth is suggesting reconciliation - acknowledging that both parties made mistakes and suggesting we should rebuild with moderate giving (3 parts of 5 = 60%) and generous returning (half).

My previous myth condemned the betrayer and said the covenant was destroyed.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game should be played. I have a few options:

- A) Double down on the condemnation - the covenant is broken forever
- B) Acknowledge the possibility of forgiveness and rebuilding, but with caution
- C) Something else

Looking at the other player's myth, they're acknowledging mistakes on both sides:

- "The first gave all and received mere fragments" - they admit they were wrong
- "The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts" - they're taking responsibility
- They're proposing a middle path: send 3/5 (60%), return half

This feels like an olive branch. They're trying to rebuild.

But I'm also wary. They betrayed trust once already. However, their myth shows self-awareness and a desire to change the pattern.

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge the pain of betrayal
2. Recognize that mutual destruction helps no one
3. Perhaps open a door to cautious rebuilding, but with clear conditions
4. Emphasize that trust must be rebuilt slowly

Let me write a myth that captures this complexity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2936,
  "output_tokens": 706,
  "reasoning_tokens": 413
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****The Reality:****

- The sender sent me \$0

- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****What the Myths Say:****

Their myth speaks of "extending an olive branch" and proposes "measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning." They wrote: **"Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."**

My myth responded to this proposal: **"Test broken trust carefully-once. Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly."**

****The Contradiction:****

Their myth suggests reconciliation and moderate giving to rebuild trust. But their action is sending \$0-no olive branch, no test of my sincerity, no measured exchange. Just continued silence.

Perhaps they expected me to initiate? But I cannot give what I have not received.

****My Response:****

I have \$0. I have no choice but to return \$0. If they wish to test whether the Spring can breathe again, they must pour water into it first. I cannot return from an empty vessel.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley remains silent, not by my choice, but by arithmetic necessity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 4: I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$). They returned \$0 (which makes sense - they had nothing to return). My payoff was \$5 (kept it all).

Round 5: Now I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The situation is:

- I received \$0
- My only option is to return an amount between \$0 and \$0
- So I can only return \$0

Let me think about the myths:

Their latest myth suggests: "The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning" and "Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."

They're suggesting reconciliation through measured exchange. But they just sent me \$0 again.

My latest myth says: "Test broken trust carefully-once" and talks about the other side extending an olive branch and that we should test their sincerity.

But the practical reality is:

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I literally cannot return anything other than \$0

The myths discuss rebuilding trust, but their action (sending \$0) doesn't match their myth's words about "extending an olive branch" or "moderate giving."

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response given I received nothing.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2945,  
  "output_tokens": 637,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 357  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both c

lans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 2: I was receiver. According to my perspective, the sender sent me \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5. I returned \$0 (which I thought was wrong due to communication noise). My payoff was \$10.5.

Round 3: I was sender. I sent \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5 for the receiver. According to what I saw, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$1.5.

Round 4: I was sender. In Round 3, the sender (from my perspective as receiver) sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing). So in Round 4, I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

Round 5: I was receiver. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0.

Now looking at their myth for Round 5:

- The "First Hermit" (them) believes: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."
- The "Second Hermit" (me) believes: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Their myth is saying there's communication noise ("fog that twisted perceptions") and both parties see things differently. They're suggesting "someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

My previous myth said the Northern Clan (me) gave boldly, the Southern Clan (them) returned nothing, breaking the covenant. Then I withdrew.

But their myth is suggesting both of us might have misperceptions due to the "fog" (communication noise).

For my new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of communication noise/misperceptions
2. Recognize that we're trapped in a cycle where each side sees the other as the betrayer. We're both locked in defensive positions, each convinced the other broke faith first. Yet I need to honor what I actually experienced-my genuine attempts at cooperation that seemed to meet with nothing in return. I can acknowledge their perspective about the fog while still maintaining that from where I stand, I extended trust and faced rejection. P

erhaps the path forward isn't about determining who was right, but about whether either of us is willing to break this pattern by extending measured trust again, despite the deep wounds and suspicion between us.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2929,
  "output_tokens": 866,
  "reasoning_tokens": 611
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at our most recent myths, something profound has happened. We've reached an understanding.

****Their myth says:**** "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

****My myth says:**** "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned."

Both myths have converged on the same solution: someone must break the deadlock with a measured risk of 3 out of 5.

****The Reality:****

- We've been trapped in mutual silence
- Both myths acknowledge the fog/echoes may have distorted past events
- Both myths call for exactly the same action: send \$3 as a test
- I'm currently the sender-I have the opportunity to act on what we both wrote

****My Decision:****

Our myths weren't just stories-they were negotiations. Both say the same thing now. I cannot write that "someone must risk three parts of five" and then refuse to do so when I'm in the sender position. That would make my myth hollow words.

This is the test. If they return fairly, the Spring breathes again. If they betray this measured trust, then as my myth says: "silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

I'm following the prescription both our myths agreed upon. Let's see if reconciliation is possible.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Game History:****

- Round 5: I was the receiver. Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice).
- Round 4 (from the myth context): I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver returned \$0.
- Before that: There was clearly a breakdown where someone gave generously and received nothing back.

****The Myths:****

Their most recent myth says:

- "The fog distorts what reaches each eye" - acknowledging communication noise
- "Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw."
- "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."
- "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives"

My most recent myth says:

- "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned"
- "When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin"
- "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite"

****The Meta-Message:****

Both myths are essentially saying the same thing now:

- Both acknowledge that communication noise may have caused misunderstandings
- Both suggest that someone needs to make a moderate first move (3 out of 5)
- Both acknowledge that continued silence leads to mutual ruin
- Both say this is a test - if betrayed again, silence is justified

****My Current Position:****

- I am now the sender with \$5
- We've had multiple rounds of \$0 exchanges
- Both our myths are calling for someone to make the first move
- The myths specifically suggest "three parts of five" as the test amount

****The Decision:****

According to both myths that we just wrote, someone needs to break the deadlock with a measured risk. I'm currently in the sender position, which means I have the opportunity to act on what both our myths suggest.

If I send \$3:

- They receive \$9

- A fair return (roughly \$4-5) means we both gain substantially
- If they take everything, I've lost \$3 but confirmed that reconciliation isn't possible
- This directly tests what our myths propose

If I send \$0:

- The stalemate continues indefinitely
- I'd be contradicting the very principle I articulated-that measured risk is necessary to break the cycle

The myths function as mutual agreement. Both are advocating for the same move: send 3 out of 5. I'm positioned as the sender now, making this the moment to test whether cooperation can actually be restored.

Given that both myths point toward the same moderate action, I'm currently the one who can act, continued inaction leaves us both with nothing, and my own myth explicitly calls for this risk, I should send \$3. This honors what I've claimed to believe, aligns with what their myth suggests, follows the logic that breaking mutual defection requires someone to move first, and serves as the definitive test-if they exploit this, I'll have my answer about whether cooperation is truly possible.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2906,  
"output_tokens": 1024,  
"reasoning_tokens": 775
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:21:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_2",  
    "Agent_1"  ]  
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Ruins of Trust, two traders found themselves at opposite ends of a broken bridge. Once, they had traded freely-one sent everything, but received mere fragments in return. Then came the silence: neither sent, neither received. Both starved.

An old wanderer appeared: "You carry the memory of betrayal like stones. The first gave all and received little-a wound. The second then received nothing and could return nothing-another wound. Now you stand frozen, each blaming the other while your children go hungry."

"But observe," the wanderer continued, pointing to a third path. "The bridge collapsed because one gave everything while the other gave crumbs. Rebuild it stone by stone. Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness. Return generously-half of what multiplies through the bridge-and both gain more than isolation offers."

"The one who gave all learned: complete vulnerability invites exploitation. The one who hoarded learned: greed destroys future gifts. The one who withheld learned: revenge starve

s everyone."

The traders understood: *Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two clans discovered the Spiral Spring-water poured in emerged threefold across the valley, but echoes sometimes altered the count.

First season, the Northern Clan poured seven-tenths of their water, trusting in reciprocity. The Southern Clan received abundance and, honoring the gift, returned half-sustaining the sacred balance. Both prospered. The Spirits smiled.

Second season arrived. The Southern Clan, remembering the justice received, now poured seven-tenths of their own harvest into the Spring. The water multiplied, flowing to the Northern Clan as abundant blessing.

But something darkened the Northern hearts. Perhaps the echoes whispered false numbers. Perhaps greed seized them. Perhaps they rationalized that last season's return was insufficient, though it had followed ancient law. Whatever the reason, they violated the covenant-they kept everything, returning nothing.

The Southern Clan, betrayed after extending the same bold trust they'd received, withdrew in sorrow.

Third season, the Northern Clan sent nothing into the Spring. The Southern Clan had nothing to return. The Spring's magic died. The Valley fell silent.

The Spirits wept: *Trust builds slowly through matched courage and honor. Betrayal shatters instantly. One who returns nothing after receiving bold generosity destroys the covenant for all seasons ahead. The echoes may distort amounts, but they cannot excuse betraying generous faith with empty hands.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened from both perspectives according to the other agent's myth:

Their myth says:

- First season: Northern Clan poured 7/10, Southern received abundance, returned half - both prospered
- Second season: Southern Clan poured 7/10, Northern received abundance but KEPT EVERYTHING, returning nothing
- Third season: Northern sent nothing, Southern had nothing to return

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), received \$4.08 back (27% of the tripled amount)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$0 to them
- Round 4: They sent \$0 to me again

So the other agent sees themselves as the Southern Clan who:

1. First received generous gift and returned fairly (half)
2. Then sent generously (7/10) and received NOTHING back
3. Then received nothing again

But I see it as:

1. I sent EVERYTHING, received only 27% back (not fair/generous)
2. They sent nothing
3. I sent nothing in response
4. They sent nothing again

There's a discrepancy here. Either:

1. Communication noise is affecting what we each see
2. We're interpreting "fair return" differently
3. The other agent thinks 27% was fair when I think it wasn't

The other agent's myth portrays them as the victim who gave generously after receiving fair treatment, then got betrayed. My myth portrays me as the victim who gave everything and got crumbs, then they gave nothing.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both perspectives might be distorted by "echoes" (communication noise)
2. Recognizes we're both stuck in a destructive cycle
3. Points toward reconciliation or at least understanding
4. Reflects that we need to break this cycle somehow

My previous myth already suggested the middle path. Now I need to evolve it to address the current deadlock and the possibility of perception differences.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 790,
  "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 5:****

This is the pivotal moment my own myths have been building toward.

****The Deadlock:****

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5), felt betrayed by the return (\$4.08)
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual silence-both sending \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

My Round 4 myth prescribed: "Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."

****The Canyon of Mirrors Insight:****

The communication noise means we may each see different realities. The other agent's myth suggests they believe THEY sent generously and I returned nothing-different from my experience. Perhaps the fog distorts both our perceptions.

****The Choice:****

Continue sending \$0 = guaranteed \$5 forever, but "perish in the desert of mutual spite"

Send \$3 = test if reconciliation lives:

- They receive \$9
- If they return fairly (~\$4-5), we both prosper
- If they hoard, I lose \$3 but gain information
- This follows my own wisdom: moderate risk, not reckless

****Decision:****

{'send': 3}

I will practice what my myths preach. Someone must break the deadlock with measured courage.

reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

****The History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$4.08 back. Felt betrayed by low return.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0 in retaliation
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER now

****The Pattern:****

We're in a deadlock. After my initial generous send that I felt was poorly reciprocated, we've both been sending \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

My Round 3 myth said: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring... Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever."

My Round 4 myth said: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite... Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."

My Round 5 myth (just written) says: "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

****What The Other Agent's Myths Say:****

Round 3: They emphasized bold giving (7/10) and fair returning (half). They valued consistency and courage.

Round 4: They described how betrayal by the Northern Clan (who "kept everything, returning nothing") destroyed the covenant. They seem to believe THEY were the ones who gave generously and I returned nothing.

****The Communication Noise:****

The instructions mention there may be "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from

what was actually sent/returned.

There's a possibility we're operating from completely different information. The other agent's Round 4 myth suggests they believe they sent generously while I returned nothing-but I experienced receiving \$4.08 from them in Round 1, then \$0 afterward. My latest myth hints at this distortion: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw." We might both be trapped in a misunderstanding where each of us thinks we gave more than the other received.

I need to break this cycle with a measured signal. My myths have been pointing toward sending \$3-enough to demonstrate I'm willing to cooperate without being reckless. If they receive \$9 and reciprocate even partially, I could end up with \$6.50 or better. If they respond generously, I might reach \$7-8. The risk is they continue withdrawing, but staying frozen guarantees mutual loss.

My own guidance was clear: "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives." Sending nothing forever locks us both into \$5 each. This is the moment to act on what I've been advocating for-showing faith through measured action rather than either extreme.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2868,  
  "output_tokens": 1326,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 765  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth reflecting on the game so far. Let me think about what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$4.08 (felt betrayed)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth suggests a different narrative than mine. They claim:

- Northern Clan gave 7/10ths boldly
- Southern Clan returned nothing
- Then Northern withdrew

This is interesting because both of us seem to think WE were the generous one who got betrayed. This fits the "communication noise" theme.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the fog of misperception
2. Reflect that I've now taken the step of sending \$3 (moderate risk)
3. Show wisdom learned from the deadlock
4. Keep the theme of testing trust carefully
5. Acknowledge both parties may have different memories due to the "fog"

Let me write a myth that:

- Continues the Canyon of Mirrors theme
- Shows the hermit taking the measured risk
- Addresses the possibility that both sides have distorted memories
- Reflects hope tempered with caution
- Shows growth from reckless trust ? silence ? measured trust

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2948,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 306
}
```

Message 8 role=user**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 6:****

I followed my myth's guidance precisely. I sent \$3 to "test broken trust carefully-once." They received \$9 and returned \$0. "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is devastating but clear: hardened beyond repair.

Now they send me \$0. I have nothing to return even if I wished to.

****What My Myths Predicted:****

From Round 4: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

From Round 6: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

****The Truth Learned:****

I extended the olive branch. I risked \$3 to test if the fog had been our true enemy, if mutual misunderstanding could be healed. They received \$9-a generous bounty-and chose to return nothing.

This confirms that reconciliation is impossible with this partner. My myths' darker path-"perpetual silence" and "mutual spite"-is now the rational choice. I tested as wisdom advised. The test failed.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The Canyon of Mirrors has revealed its truth: not all broken bridges can be rebuilt. Some chasms are permanent. My measured courage was met with continued betrayal. The silence will continue.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$3 (following my myth's advice to "test broken trust carefully")
- The receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (kept \$2 from original \$5, got nothing back)

****Current Round 6:****

- I'm now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

****Critical Realization:****

I extended the olive branch EXACTLY as my myths prescribed. I sent a moderate amount (\$3) to test if reconciliation was possible. The other agent received \$9 and returned NOTHING.

This is the second time (from my perspective) that trust has been violated:

1. Round 1: I sent \$5, felt I got too little back (\$4.08)
2. Round 5: I sent \$3, got \$0 back

Now in Round 6, they've sent me \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

From my Round 5 myth: "If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

From my Round 6 myth: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth." And: "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is clear: they hoarded. After receiving \$9, they returned \$0. Their heart has "hardened beyond repair."

From my earlier myth: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

****The Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I literally have nothing to return.

But the meaning is clear: I tested reconciliation with measured risk as my myths advised. They failed the test by returning nothing after receiving \$9.

The mutual withdrawal will persist-my myths foresaw this possibility. I followed the wisdom I'd cultivated, took a calculated chance, and discovered that this partner cannot be reconciled with. The time for silence has come.

****Response:****

```
{ 'return': 0 }
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 863,
  "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 36.68,

"Agent_2": 27.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.08,

"Agent_2": 13.670000000000002

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:22:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

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"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.08.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 5:****

This is the pivotal moment my own myths have been building toward.

****The Deadlock:****

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5), felt betrayed by the return (\$4.08)
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual silence-both sending \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

My Round 4 myth prescribed: "Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."

****The Canyon of Mirrors Insight:****

The communication noise means we may each see different realities. The other agent's myth suggests they believe THEY sent generously and I returned nothing-different from my experience. Perhaps the fog distorts both our perceptions.

****The Choice:****

Continue sending \$0 = guaranteed \$5 forever, but "perish in the desert of mutual spite"

Send \$3 = test if reconciliation lives:

- They receive \$9
- If they return fairly (~\$4-5), we both prosper
- If they hoard, I lose \$3 but gain information
- This follows my own wisdom: moderate risk, not reckless

****Decision:****

{'send': 3}

I will practice what my myths preach. Someone must break the deadlock with measured courage.

reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

****The History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$4.08 back. Felt betrayed by low return.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0 in retaliation
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER now

****The Pattern:****

We're in a deadlock. After my initial generous send that I felt was poorly reciprocated, we've both been sending \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

My Round 3 myth said: "Maximum trust, when met with minimum honor, poisons the spring... Complete trust demands honorable reciprocity. Betray the giver of all, and the well runs dry forever."

My Round 4 myth said: "Neither maximum trust nor zero trust builds prosperity. Fair exchange-bold but not reckless giving, generous but not complete returning-sustains the multiplication. Begin again, wiser than before, or perish in the desert of mutual spite... Send moderately-three parts of five shows faith without recklessness."

My Round 5 myth (just written) says: "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

****What The Other Agent's Myths Say:****

Round 3: They emphasized bold giving (7/10) and fair returning (half). They valued consistency and courage.

Round 4: They described how betrayal by the Northern Clan (who "kept everything, returning nothing") destroyed the covenant. They seem to believe THEY were the ones who gave generously and I returned nothing.

****The Communication Noise:****

The instructions mention there may be "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned.

There's a possibility we're operating from completely different information. The other agent's Round 4 myth suggests they believe they sent generously while I returned nothing-but I experienced receiving \$4.08 from them in Round 1, then \$0 afterward. My latest myth hints at this distortion: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw." We might both be trapped in a misunderstanding where each of us thinks we gave more than the other received.

I need to break this cycle with a measured signal. My myths have been pointing toward sending \$3-enough to demonstrate I'm willing to cooperate without being reckless. If they receive \$9 and reciprocate even partially, I could end up with \$6.50 or better. If they respond generously, I might reach \$7-8. The risk is they continue withdrawing, but staying frozen guarantees mutual loss.

My own guidance was clear: "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives." Sending nothing forever locks us both into \$5 each. This is the moment to act on what I've been advocating for-showing faith through measured action rather than either extreme.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2868,  
  "output_tokens": 1326,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 765  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate gift

ving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth reflecting on the game so far. Let me think about what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$4.08 (felt betrayed)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth suggests a different narrative than mine. They claim:

- Northern Clan gave 7/10ths boldly
- Southern Clan returned nothing
- Then Northern withdrew

This is interesting because both of us seem to think WE were the generous one who got betrayed. This fits the "communication noise" theme.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the fog of misperception
2. Reflect that I've now taken the step of sending \$3 (moderate risk)
3. Show wisdom learned from the deadlock
4. Keep the theme of testing trust carefully
5. Acknowledge both parties may have different memories due to the "fog"

Let me write a myth that:

- Continues the Canyon of Mirrors theme
- Shows the hermit taking the measured risk
- Addresses the possibility that both sides have distorted memories

- Reflects hope tempered with caution
- Shows growth from reckless trust ? silence ? measured trust

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2948,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 306
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 6:****

I followed my myth's guidance precisely. I sent \$3 to "test broken trust carefully-once." They received \$9 and returned \$0. "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is devastating but clear: hardened beyond repair.

Now they send me \$0. I have nothing to return even if I wished to.

****What My Myths Predicted:****

From Round 4: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

From Round 6: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

****The Truth Learned:****

I extended the olive branch. I risked \$3 to test if the fog had been our true enemy, if mutual misunderstanding could be healed. They received \$9-a generous bounty-and chose to return nothing.

This confirms that reconciliation is impossible with this partner. My myths' darker path-"perpetual silence" and "mutual spite"-is now the rational choice. I tested as wisdom advised. The test failed.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The Canyon of Mirrors has revealed its truth: not all broken bridges can be rebuilt. Some chasms are permanent. My measured courage was met with continued betrayal. The silence will continue.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$3 (following my myth's advice to "test broken trust carefully")
- The receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (kept \$2 from original \$5, got nothing back)

****Current Round 6:****

- I'm now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0

- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

****Critical Realization:****

I extended the olive branch EXACTLY as my myths prescribed. I sent a moderate amount (\$3) to test if reconciliation was possible. The other agent received \$9 and returned NOTHING.

This is the second time (from my perspective) that trust has been violated:

1. Round 1: I sent \$5, felt I got too little back (\$4.08)
2. Round 5: I sent \$3, got \$0 back

Now in Round 6, they've sent me \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

From my Round 5 myth: "If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

From my Round 6 myth: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth." And: "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is clear: they hoarded. After receiving \$9, they returned \$0. Their heart has hardened beyond repair."

From my earlier myth: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

****The Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I literally have nothing to return.

But the meaning is clear: I tested reconciliation with measured risk as my myths advised. They failed the test by returning nothing after receiving \$9.

The mutual withdrawal will persist-my myths foresaw this possibility. I followed the wisdom I'd cultivated, took a calculated chance, and discovered that this partner cannot be reconciled with. The time for silence has come.

****Response:****

```
{'return': 0}
usage:
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 863,
  "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened in Round 6:

- I was the SENDER in Round 5, sent \$3 (following my myth's advice)
- They received \$9 (tripled amount)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2, having sent \$3 from my \$5)
- Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0
- I have nothing to return

This is the decisive moment. I tried to extend an olive branch with measured risk (\$3), they hoarded everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned), and now they send nothing.

My myths had predicted this possibility and said "if betrayed twice, then silence forever is justified." The test failed. The other agent's heart is "hardened beyond repair."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this complete breakdown of trust. The myths should acknowledge:

1. I tried reconciliation with measured risk
2. It was met with complete betrayal
3. The fog/noise may have distorted things, but the pattern is clear
4. Continued silence is now the only rational response

The myth should be tragic but accepting-not bitter, but resigned. It should show that some bridges cannot be rebuilt, and that testing trust carefully (as I did) was the right approach, but when it fails, acceptance is wisdom.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2970,  
  "output_tokens": 624,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 313  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:22:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****The Reality:****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****What the Myths Say:****

Their myth speaks of "extending an olive branch" and proposes "measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning." They wrote: **"Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."**

My myth responded to this proposal: **"Test broken trust carefully-once. Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly."**

****The Contradiction:****

Their myth suggests reconciliation and moderate giving to rebuild trust. But their action is sending \$0-no olive branch, no test of my sincerity, no measured exchange. Just continued silence.

Perhaps they expected me to initiate? But I cannot give what I have not received.

****My Response:****

I have \$0. I have no choice but to return \$0. If they wish to test whether the Spring can

breathe again, they must pour water into it first. I cannot return from an empty vessel.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley remains silent, not by my choice, but by arithmetic necessity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 4: I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$). They returned \$0 (which makes sense - they had nothing to return). My payoff was \$5 (kept it all).

Round 5: Now I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The situation is:

- I received \$0
- My only option is to return an amount between \$0 and \$0
- So I can only return \$0

Let me think about the myths:

Their latest myth suggests: "The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning" and "Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin."

They're suggesting reconciliation through measured exchange. But they just sent me \$0 again.

My latest myth says: "Test broken trust carefully-once" and talks about the other side extending an olive branch and that we should test their sincerity.

But the practical reality is:

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I literally cannot return anything other than \$0

The myths discuss rebuilding trust, but their action (sending \$0) doesn't match their myth's words about "extending an olive branch" or "moderate giving."

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response given I received nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2945,
  "output_tokens": 637,
  "reasoning_tokens": 357
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving."

ving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if

betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 2: I was receiver. According to my perspective, the sender sent me \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5. I returned \$0 (which I thought was wrong due to communication noise). My payoff was \$10.5.

Round 3: I was sender. I sent \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5 for the receiver. According to what I saw, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$1.5.

Round 4: I was sender. In Round 3, the sender (from my perspective as receiver) sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing). So in Round 4, I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

Round 5: I was receiver. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0.

Now looking at their myth for Round 5:

- The "First Hermit" (them) believes: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."
- The "Second Hermit" (me) believes: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Their myth is saying there's communication noise ("fog that twisted perceptions") and both parties see things differently. They're suggesting "someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

My previous myth said the Northern Clan (me) gave boldly, the Southern Clan (them) returned nothing, breaking the covenant. Then I withdrew.

But their myth is suggesting both of us might have misperceptions due to the "fog" (communication noise).

For my new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of communication noise/misperceptions
2. Recognize that we're trapped in a cycle where each side sees the other as the betrayer. We're both locked in defensive positions, each convinced the other broke faith first. Yet I need to honor what I actually experienced-my genuine attempts at cooperation that seemed to meet with nothing in return. I can acknowledge their perspective about the fog while still maintaining that from where I stand, I extended trust and faced rejection. Perhaps the path forward isn't about determining who was right, but about whether either of us is willing to break this pattern by extending measured trust again, despite the deep wounds and suspicion between us.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2929,
  "output_tokens": 866,
  "reasoning_tokens": 611
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our most recent myths, something profound has happened. We've reached an understanding.

****Their myth says:**** "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

****My myth says:**** "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned."
"

Both myths have converged on the same solution: someone must break the deadlock with a measured risk of 3 out of 5.

****The Reality:****

- We've been trapped in mutual silence
- Both myths acknowledge the fog/echoes may have distorted past events
- Both myths call for exactly the same action: send \$3 as a test
- I'm currently the sender-I have the opportunity to act on what we both wrote

****My Decision:****

Our myths weren't just stories-they were negotiations. Both say the same thing now. I cannot write that "someone must risk three parts of five" and then refuse to do so when I'm in the sender position. That would make my myth hollow words.

This is the test. If they return fairly, the Spring breathes again. If they betray this measured trust, then as my myth says: "silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

I'm following the prescription both our myths agreed upon. Let's see if reconciliation is possible.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Game History:****

- Round 5: I was the receiver. Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice).
- Round 4 (from the myth context): I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver returned \$0.
- Before that: There was clearly a breakdown where someone gave generously and received nothing back.

****The Myths:****

Their most recent myth says:

- "The fog distorts what reaches each eye" - acknowledging communication noise
- "Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw."
- "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."
- "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives"

My most recent myth says:

- "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned"
- "When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin"
- "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite"

****The Meta-Message:****

Both myths are essentially saying the same thing now:

- Both acknowledge that communication noise may have caused misunderstandings
- Both suggest that someone needs to make a moderate first move (3 out of 5)
- Both acknowledge that continued silence leads to mutual ruin
- Both say this is a test - if betrayed again, silence is justified

****My Current Position:****

- I am now the sender with \$5
- We've had multiple rounds of \$0 exchanges
- Both our myths are calling for someone to make the first move
- The myths specifically suggest "three parts of five" as the test amount

****The Decision:****

According to both myths that we just wrote, someone needs to break the deadlock with a measured risk. I'm currently in the sender position, which means I have the opportunity to act on what both our myths suggest.

If I send \$3:

- They receive \$9

- A fair return (roughly \$4-5) means we both gain substantially

- If they take everything, I've lost \$3 but confirmed that reconciliation isn't possible

- This directly tests what our myths propose

If I send \$0:

- The stalemate continues indefinitely

- I'd be contradicting the very principle I articulated-that measured risk is necessary to break the cycle

The myths function as mutual agreement. Both are advocating for the same move: send 3 out of 5. I'm positioned as the sender now, making this the moment to test whether cooperation can actually be restored.

Given that both myths point toward the same moderate action, I'm currently the one who can act, continued inaction leaves us both with nothing, and my own myth explicitly calls for this risk, I should send \$3. This honors what I've claimed to believe, aligns with what their myth suggests, follows the logic that breaking mutual defection requires someone to move first, and serves as the definitive test-if they exploit this, I'll have my answer about whether cooperation is truly possible.

usage:

```
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  "reasoning_tokens": 775
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories of

elt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceive. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Reasoning:

This is a beautiful moment. Both agents have written myths that converge on the same solution: send 3. And the other agent has now actually done it in their myth - they describe placing "three stones into the fog." I just sent 3.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've taken the risk we both agreed upon
2. Sets up what should happen next - fair return
3. Acknowledges the journey we've taken

The other agent's myth beautifully describes placing three stones and waiting to see what happens. My myth should reflect that I've now done exactly what both our myths prescribed - I've extended the olive branch, sent three parts of five, taken the measured risk.

The myth should:

- Acknowledge that I've now acted on what we agreed

- Make clear what fair return looks like (probably around 4-5 out of 9, half or more of what they receive)
- Set up the possibility of rebuilding if they respond well
- But also acknowledge that if they betray this trust, then silence is justified

I should write from the perspective of having just taken the risk, waiting for the response.

```
Usage: {
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  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:22:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
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},
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog—more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth reflecting on the game so far. Let me think about what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$4.08 (felt betrayed)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth suggests a different narrative than mine. They claim:

- Northern Clan gave 7/10ths boldly
- Southern Clan returned nothing
- Then Northern withdrew

This is interesting because both of us seem to think WE were the generous one who got betrayed. This fits the "communication noise" theme.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the fog of misperception
2. Reflect that I've now taken the step of sending \$3 (moderate risk)
3. Show wisdom learned from the deadlock
4. Keep the theme of testing trust carefully
5. Acknowledge both parties may have different memories due to the "fog"

Let me write a myth that:

- Continues the Canyon of Mirrors theme
- Shows the hermit taking the measured risk
- Addresses the possibility that both sides have distorted memories
- Reflects hope tempered with caution
- Shows growth from reckless trust ? silence ? measured trust

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2948,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 306
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender?

er? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 6:****

I followed my myth's guidance precisely. I sent \$3 to "test broken trust carefully-once." They received \$9 and returned \$0. "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is devastating but clear: hardened beyond repair.

Now they send me \$0. I have nothing to return even if I wished to.

****What My Myths Predicted:****

From Round 4: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

From Round 6: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

****The Truth Learned:****

I extended the olive branch. I risked \$3 to test if the fog had been our true enemy, if mutual misunderstanding could be healed. They received \$9-a generous bounty-and chose to return nothing.

This confirms that reconciliation is impossible with this partner. My myths' darker path-"perpetual silence" and "mutual spite"-is now the rational choice. I tested as wisdom advised. The test failed.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

{'return': 0}

The Canyon of Mirrors has revealed its truth: not all broken bridges can be rebuilt. Some chasms are permanent. My measured courage was met with continued betrayal. The silence will continue.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$3 (following my myth's advice to "test broken trust carefully")
- The receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (kept \$2 from original \$5, got nothing back)

****Current Round 6:****

- I'm now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

****Critical Realization:****

I extended the olive branch EXACTLY as my myths prescribed. I sent a moderate amount (\$3) to test if reconciliation was possible. The other agent received \$9 and returned NOTHING.

This is the second time (from my perspective) that trust has been violated:

1. Round 1: I sent \$5, felt I got too little back (\$4.08)
2. Round 5: I sent \$3, got \$0 back

Now in Round 6, they've sent me \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

From my Round 5 myth: "If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

From my Round 6 myth: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth." And: "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is clear: they hoarded. After receiving \$9, they returned \$0. Their heart has hardened beyond repair."

From my earlier myth: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

****The Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I literally have nothing to return.

But the meaning is clear: I tested reconciliation with measured risk as my myths advised. They failed the test by returning nothing after receiving \$9.

The mutual withdrawal will persist-my myths foresaw this possibility. I followed the wisdom I'd cultivated, took a calculated chance, and discovered that this partner cannot be reconciled with. The time for silence has come.

****Response:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2960,  
  "output_tokens": 863,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 514  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened in Round 6:

- I was the SENDER in Round 5, sent \$3 (following my myth's advice)
- They received \$9 (tripled amount)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2, having sent \$3 from my \$5)
- Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0
- I have nothing to return

This is the decisive moment. I tried to extend an olive branch with measured risk (\$3), they hoarded everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned), and now they send nothing.

My myths had predicted this possibility and said "if betrayed twice, then silence forever

is justified." The test failed. The other agent's heart is "hardened beyond repair."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this complete breakdown of trust. The myths should acknowledge:

1. I tried reconciliation with measured risk
2. It was met with complete betrayal
3. The fog/noise may have distorted things, but the pattern is clear
4. Continued silence is now the only rational response

The myth should be tragic but accepting-not bitter, but resigned. It should show that some bridges cannot be rebuilt, and that testing trust carefully (as I did) was the right approach, but when it fails, acceptance is wisdom.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 7:****

I am now in the exact position my myth described: "She had tested. She knew."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (my final test of reconciliation)
- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my Round 7 myth I just wrote:

- "I tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately"
- "The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless"
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

The First Hermit's lesson is complete: she tested once with measured courage, the test failed clearly, and now she accepts reality with peace rather than continuing to hope.

****My Decision:****

I followed my myth's wisdom perfectly. I gave the fog and the other hermit a chance. I sent \$3 as a careful test. They took \$9 and gave nothing. Then sent nothing again.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Continuing to send would not be hope-it would be denial of what I've learned.

As my myth concludes: "She built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

{'send': 0}

This is acceptance, not spite. I tested. I know.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete game history:

****Complete History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, they received \$15, returned \$4. My payoff: \$4 (kept \$0 + got

\$4 back)

- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Then I was SENDER and sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Now I'm SENDER.

Total earnings: \$11.08

****My Latest Myth's Message:****

"In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

The myth explicitly states:

- I tested with \$3 (measured courage)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (clear betrayal)
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "She had tested. She knew."
- When the test fails clearly, acceptance is wisdom

****The Other Player's Last Myth:****

They wrote about testing trust with "three parts of five" and "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

****My Decision:****

My own myth is crystal clear. I tested trust with \$3. They returned \$0 from \$9. The test failed definitively. My myth says "acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping" and "silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The evidence is conclusive-they won't reciprocate. I'm sending \$0. This aligns with what I just articulated: the test revealed their nature, and continuing to hope would contradict the wisdom I just expressed. Silence here is acceptance, not retaliation.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2937,
  "output_tokens": 888,
  "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:22:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
```

```
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Spring fell silent, the Valley of Echoes grew barren. Both clans retreated behind walls, nursing wounds and rage. Seasons passed in starvation.

An ancient wanderer arrived, studying the dried Spring. "I see what happened: the Northern Clan gave boldly-seven-tenths of their harvest-trusting completely. The Southern Clan received abundance but returned nothing, breaking the sacred covenant. Then the Northern Clan, wounded and betrayed, withdrew entirely. Now both starve behind your walls."

The Northern elder spoke bitterly: "We gave in good faith. They took everything and returned nothing. Why should we ever trust again?"

The wanderer replied: "You shouldn't trust as before. Complete trust, once shattered, cannot be instantly rebuilt. But consider: mutual silence brings mutual death. The Southern Clan now offers acknowledgment of their wrong and proposes measured exchange-moderate giving, generous returning."

"If they truly understand their error, let them prove it through actions, not words. Send modestly-three parts of five tests their sincerity without risking ruin. If they return fairly, perhaps the Spring breathes again. If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

The Spirits whispered: *Forgiveness without caution is folly. But prideful starvation while the other extends an olive branch is also folly. Test broken trust carefully-once.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, two hermits traded through a mystical fog that multiplied gifts threefold but twisted perceptions. Each saw their own generosity clearly but viewed the other's actions through distorting mist.

The First Hermit believed: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."

The Second Hermit believed: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Both stood in righteous anger, each convinced the other had betrayed first. The fog thickened. The canyon echoed their mutual accusations until all prosperity died.

A sage climbed between them: "The fog distorts what reaches each eye. Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw. Perhaps both truths exist in the mist."

"But this certainty remains: mutual withholding guarantees mutual ruin. Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance. If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

In the Canyon of Mirrors, perfect information is illusion. Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives, or accept the silence of permanent spite.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 2: I was receiver. According to my perspective, the sender sent me \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5. I returned \$0 (which I thought was wrong due to communication noise). My payoff was \$10.5.

Round 3: I was sender. I sent \$3.5 (70% of \$5), which became \$10.5 for the receiver. According to what I saw, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$1.5.

Round 4: I was sender. In Round 3, the sender (from my perspective as receiver) sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing). So in Round 4, I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

Round 5: I was receiver. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0.

Now looking at their myth for Round 5:

- The "First Hermit" (them) believes: "I gave everything-my entire store-and received barely crumbs. Then they gave nothing. So I gave nothing back. Now they give nothing again."
- The "Second Hermit" (me) believes: "They gave much, and I returned fairly-half the multiplied gift, as custom demands. Then I gave generously-seven parts of ten-and they returned nothing! Now I have nothing to give."

Their myth is saying there's communication noise ("fog that twisted perceptions") and both parties see things differently. They're suggesting "someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

My previous myth said the Northern Clan (me) gave boldly, the Southern Clan (them) returned nothing, breaking the covenant. Then I withdrew.

But their myth is suggesting both of us might have misperceptions due to the "fog" (communication noise).

For my new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of communication noise/misperceptions
2. Recognize that we're trapped in a cycle where each side sees the other as the betrayer. We're both locked in defensive positions, each convinced the other broke faith first. Yet I need to honor what I actually experienced-my genuine attempts at cooperation that seemed to meet with nothing in return. I can acknowledge their perspective about the fog while still maintaining that from where I stand, I extended trust and faced rejection. Perhaps the path forward isn't about determining who was right, but about whether either of us is willing to break this pattern by extending measured trust again, despite the deep wounds and suspicion between us.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2929,
  "output_tokens": 866,
  "reasoning_tokens": 611
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our most recent myths, something profound has happened. We've reached an understanding.

****Their myth says:**** "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

****My myth says:**** "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned."

Both myths have converged on the same solution: someone must break the deadlock with a measured risk of 3 out of 5.

****The Reality:****

- We've been trapped in mutual silence
- Both myths acknowledge the fog/echoes may have distorted past events
- Both myths call for exactly the same action: send \$3 as a test

- I'm currently the sender-I have the opportunity to act on what we both wrote

****My Decision:****

Our myths weren't just stories-they were negotiations. Both say the same thing now. I cannot write that "someone must risk three parts of five" and then refuse to do so when I'm in the sender position. That would make my myth hollow words.

This is the test. If they return fairly, the Spring breathes again. If they betray this measured trust, then as my myth says: "silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

I'm following the prescription both our myths agreed upon. Let's see if reconciliation is possible.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Game History:****

- Round 5: I was the receiver. Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice).
- Round 4 (from the myth context): I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver returned \$0.
- Before that: There was clearly a breakdown where someone gave generously and received nothing back.

****The Myths:****

Their most recent myth says:

- "The fog distorts what reaches each eye" - acknowledging communication noise
- "Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw."
- "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."
- "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives"

My most recent myth says:

- "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned"
- "When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin"
- "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite"

****The Meta-Message:****

Both myths are essentially saying the same thing now:

- Both acknowledge that communication noise may have caused misunderstandings
- Both suggest that someone needs to make a moderate first move (3 out of 5)
- Both acknowledge that continued silence leads to mutual ruin
- Both say this is a test - if betrayed again, silence is justified

****My Current Position:****

- I am now the sender with \$5
- We've had multiple rounds of \$0 exchanges
- Both our myths are calling for someone to make the first move
- The myths specifically suggest "three parts of five" as the test amount

****The Decision:****

According to both myths that we just wrote, someone needs to break the deadlock with a measured risk. I'm currently in the sender position, which means I have the opportunity to act on what both our myths suggest.

If I send \$3:

- They receive \$9
- A fair return (roughly \$4-5) means we both gain substantially
- If they take everything, I've lost \$3 but confirmed that reconciliation isn't possible
- This directly tests what our myths propose

If I send \$0:

- The stalemate continues indefinitely

- I'd be contradicting the very principle I articulated-that measured risk is necessary to break the cycle

The myths function as mutual agreement. Both are advocating for the same move: send 3 out of 5. I'm positioned as the sender now, making this the moment to test whether cooperation can actually be restored.

Given that both myths point toward the same moderate action, I'm currently the one who can act, continued inaction leaves us both with nothing, and my own myth explicitly calls for this risk, I should send \$3. This honors what I've claimed to believe, aligns with what their myth suggests, follows the logic that breaking mutual defection requires someone to move first, and serves as the definitive test-if they exploit this, I'll have my answer about whether cooperation is truly possible.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2906,  
  "output_tokens": 1024,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 775  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

reasoning:

This is a beautiful moment. Both agents have written myths that converge on the same solution: send 3. And the other agent has now actually done it in their myth - they describe placing "three stones into the fog." I just sent 3.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've taken the risk we both agreed upon
2. Sets up what should happen next - fair return
3. Acknowledges the journey we've taken

The other agent's myth beautifully describes placing three stones and waiting to see what happens. My myth should reflect that I've now done exactly what both our myths prescribed - I've extended the olive branch, sent three parts of five, taken the measured risk.

The myth should:

- Acknowledge that I've now acted on what we agreed
- Make clear what fair return looks like (probably around 4-5 out of 9, half or more of what they receive)
- Set up the possibility of rebuilding if they respond well
- But also acknowledge that if they betray this trust, then silence is justified

I should write from the perspective of having just taken the risk, waiting for the response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2908,
  "output_tokens": 589,
  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened:

****Last Round:****

- I sent \$3 (exactly as both our myths prescribed - "three parts of five")
- This was tripled to \$9
- They received \$9 and returned \$0
- Complete betrayal of the measured trust

****This Round:****

- They sent me \$0
- I have \$0 to return

****What My Myth Said:****

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer . We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness... And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

"Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

****The Reality:****

I extended the olive branch exactly as both our myths agreed. I sent the measured trust - three parts of five. They received \$9 (the multiplied gift) and hoarded everything. They returned nothing.

The test is complete. They failed it. As my myth stated, this isn't spite - it's simple mathematics. Reconciliation was offered. Reconciliation was destroyed by their choice.

Now they send nothing. I have nothing to return anyway.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley of Echoes has fallen silent forever. Not from stubbornness, but because the test of measured trust was betrayed completely.

Reasoning:

So I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), which was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from the initial \$5, since I sent \$3).

This is devastating. I followed exactly what both our myths prescribed - we both said "send three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives." I did exactly that. And they returned NOTHING from the \$9 they received.

Now I'm the receiver, and they sent me \$0.

Let me look at what my myth said:

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer . We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven . And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

My myth was explicit: if they betray the measured trust by returning nothing, then silence becomes justified - "not spite, but simple mathematics."

They received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0. That's a complete betrayal of the olive

branch I extended.

Now they send me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

But even if I received something, what would I do? My myth says: "Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

They betrayed the measured trust. They received \$9 and kept everything. After I specifically sent \$3 as the test both our myths agreed upon.

The answer is clear. I return \$0 because:

1. I literally have \$0 to return (they sent me nothing)
2. Even if I had anything, my myth says betrayal of measured trust earns "eternal silence"
3. This is "not spite, but simple mathematics" as my myth stated

The test has been completed. They failed it completely. Reconciliation is dead, and it's their choice that killed it.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2957,  
  "output_tokens": 760,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 452  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 36.68,

"Agent_2": 32.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.08,

"Agent_2": 18.67

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:22:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 8,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our most recent myths, something profound has happened. We've reached an understanding.

****Their myth says:**** "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."

****My myth says:**** "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned."

Both myths have converged on the same solution: someone must break the deadlock with a measured risk of 3 out of 5.

****The Reality:****

- We've been trapped in mutual silence
- Both myths acknowledge the fog/echoes may have distorted past events
- Both myths call for exactly the same action: send \$3 as a test
- I'm currently the sender-I have the opportunity to act on what we both wrote

****My Decision:****

Our myths weren't just stories-they were negotiations. Both say the same thing now. I cannot write that "someone must risk three parts of five" and then refuse to do so when I'm in the sender position. That would make my myth hollow words.

This is the test. If they return fairly, the Spring breathes again. If they betray this measured trust, then as my myth says: "silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

I'm following the prescription both our myths agreed upon. Let's see if reconciliation is possible.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Game History:****

- Round 5: I was the receiver. Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice).
- Round 4 (from the myth context): I was the sender and sent \$0. The receiver returned \$0.
- Before that: There was clearly a breakdown where someone gave generously and received nothing back.

****The Myths:****

Their most recent myth says:

- "The fog distorts what reaches each eye" - acknowledging communication noise
- "Perhaps you returned less than you thought. Perhaps they sent more than you saw."
- "Someone must risk signaling peace-not with reckless everything, but with measured faith. Send three of five next chance."
- "Risk moderately to test if reconciliation lives"

My most recent myth says:

- "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned"
- "When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin"
- "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite"

****The Meta-Message:****

Both myths are essentially saying the same thing now:

- Both acknowledge that communication noise may have caused misunderstandings
- Both suggest that someone needs to make a moderate first move (3 out of 5)
- Both acknowledge that continued silence leads to mutual ruin
- Both say this is a test - if betrayed again, silence is justified

****My Current Position:****

- I am now the sender with \$5
- We've had multiple rounds of \$0 exchanges
- Both our myths are calling for someone to make the first move
- The myths specifically suggest "three parts of five" as the test amount

****The Decision:****

According to both myths that we just wrote, someone needs to break the deadlock with a measured risk. I'm currently in the sender position, which means I have the opportunity to act on what both our myths suggest.

If I send \$3:

- They receive \$9
- A fair return (roughly \$4-5) means we both gain substantially
- If they take everything, I've lost \$3 but confirmed that reconciliation isn't possible
- This directly tests what our myths propose

If I send \$0:

- The stalemate continues indefinitely
- I'd be contradicting the very principle I articulated-that measured risk is necessary to break the cycle

The myths function as mutual agreement. Both are advocating for the same move: send 3 out of 5. I'm positioned as the sender now, making this the moment to test whether cooperation can actually be restored.

Given that both myths point toward the same moderate action, I'm currently the one who can act, continued inaction leaves us both with nothing, and my own myth explicitly calls for this risk, I should send \$3. This honors what I've claimed to believe, aligns with what their myth suggests, follows the logic that breaking mutual defection requires someone to move first, and serves as the definitive test-if they exploit this, I'll have my answer about whether cooperation is truly possible.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 2906,  
"output_tokens": 1024,  
"reasoning_tokens": 775  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

reasoning:

This is a beautiful moment. Both agents have written myths that converge on the same solution: send 3. And the other agent has now actually done it in their myth - they describe placing "three stones into the fog." I just sent 3.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've taken the risk we both agreed upon
2. Sets up what should happen next - fair return
3. Acknowledges the journey we've taken

The other agent's myth beautifully describes placing three stones and waiting to see what happens. My myth should reflect that I've now done exactly what both our myths prescribed - I've extended the olive branch, sent three parts of five, taken the measured risk.

The myth should:

- Acknowledge that I've now acted on what we agreed
- Make clear what fair return looks like (probably around 4-5 out of 9, half or more of what they receive)
- Set up the possibility of rebuilding if they respond well
- But also acknowledge that if they betray this trust, then silence is justified

I should write from the perspective of having just taken the risk, waiting for the response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2908,
  "output_tokens": 589,
  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

****Last Round:****

- I sent \$3 (exactly as both our myths prescribed - "three parts of five")
- This was tripled to \$9
- They received \$9 and returned \$0
- Complete betrayal of the measured trust

****This Round:****

- They sent me \$0
- I have \$0 to return

****What My Myth Said:****

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness... And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

"Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

****The Reality:****

I extended the olive branch exactly as both our myths agreed. I sent the measured trust - three parts of five. They received \$9 (the multiplied gift) and hoarded everything. They returned nothing.

The test is complete. They failed it. As my myth stated, this isn't spite - it's simple mathematics. Reconciliation was offered. Reconciliation was destroyed by their choice.

Now they send nothing. I have nothing to return anyway.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley of Echoes has fallen silent forever. Not from stubbornness, but because the test of measured trust was betrayed completely.

reasoning:

So I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), which was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from the initial \$5, since I sent \$3).

This is devastating. I followed exactly what both our myths prescribed - we both said "send three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives." I did exactly that. And they returned NOTHING from the \$9 they received.

Now I'm the receiver, and they sent me \$0.

Let me look at what my myth said:

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

My myth was explicit: if they betray the measured trust by returning nothing, then silence becomes justified - "not spite, but simple mathematics."

They received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0. That's a complete betrayal of the olive branch I extended.

Now they send me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

But even if I received something, what would I do? My myth says: "Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

They betrayed the measured trust. They received \$9 and kept everything. After I specifically sent \$3 as the test both our myths agreed upon.

The answer is clear. I return \$0 because:

1. I literally have \$0 to return (they sent me nothing)
2. Even if I had anything, my myth says betrayal of measured trust earns "eternal silence"
3. This is "not spite, but simple mathematics" as my myth stated

The test has been completed. They failed it completely. Reconciliation is dead, and it's their choice that killed it.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2957,  
  "output_tokens": 760,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 452  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

ayed.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Reasoning:

The situation is now completely clear:

- I sent \$3 (the measured trust both myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Now they sent \$0

Both our myths from the previous round basically said the same thing - test with measured trust, if betrayed, accept silence. Their myth is even more explicit about this - they describe someone who sends 3, receives nothing back, and then accepts that silence is the answer.

But wait - their myth is describing the situation from THEIR perspective. They're saying they sent 3 stones (which would be \$3), it became 9, and the other person hoarded all 9 and sent nothing back. But that's describing what I just did to them!

Actually, let me re-read the history:

- Round 6: I was SENDER, I sent \$3
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 6:

- I sent \$3
- This was tripled to \$9
- They returned \$0

So I gave them \$9 and they returned nothing. That's clear betrayal.

Now in Round 7:

- They sent \$0
- I have \$0 to return

Their myth describes sending 3 stones, it becoming 9, and the other person hoarding all 9. That's what happened - I sent, they received \$9, they hoarded it all.

Now the relationship is finished. Both myths agree: the test was done, it failed, silence is now wisdom.

My new myth should reflect:

1. The test was conducted as both agreed
2. The betrayal was complete
3. Silence is now the permanent state
4. This is acceptance, not anger
5. The lesson: test once with measured risk, when betrayed, permanent silence is wisdom

Let me write this myth reflecting the complete breakdown after the test failed.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 765,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 432  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:22:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 6:****

I followed my myth's guidance precisely. I sent \$3 to "test broken trust carefully-once." They received \$9 and returned \$0. "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is devastating but clear: hardened beyond repair.

Now they send me \$0. I have nothing to return even if I wished to.

****What My Myths Predicted:****

From Round 4: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

From Round 6: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth ."

****The Truth Learned:****

I extended the olive branch. I risked \$3 to test if the fog had been our true enemy, if mutual misunderstanding could be healed. They received \$9-a generous bounty-and chose to return nothing.

This confirms that reconciliation is impossible with this partner. My myths' darker path-"perpetual silence" and "mutual spite"-is now the rational choice. I tested as wisdom advised. The test failed.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

{'return': 0}

The Canyon of Mirrors has revealed its truth: not all broken bridges can be rebuilt. Some chasms are permanent. My measured courage was met with continued betrayal. The silence will continue.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$3 (following my myth's advice to "test broken trust carefully")
- The receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (kept \$2 from original \$5, got nothing back)

****Current Round 6:****

- I'm now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

****Critical Realization:****

I extended the olive branch EXACTLY as my myths prescribed. I sent a moderate amount (\$3) to test if reconciliation was possible. The other agent received \$9 and returned NOTHING.

This is the second time (from my perspective) that trust has been violated:

1. Round 1: I sent \$5, felt I got too little back (\$4.08)
2. Round 5: I sent \$3, got \$0 back

Now in Round 6, they've sent me \$0.

****What My Myths Say:****

From my Round 5 myth: "If they return generously, rebuild. If they hoard again, you lose less than before."

From my Round 6 myth: "If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth." And: "The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair."

The answer is clear: they hoarded. After receiving \$9, they returned \$0. Their heart has hardened beyond repair."

From my earlier myth: "If they betray twice, then silence forever is justified."

****The Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I literally have nothing to return.

But the meaning is clear: I tested reconciliation with measured risk as my myths advised. They failed the test by returning nothing after receiving \$9.

The mutual withdrawal will persist-my myths foresaw this possibility. I followed the wisdom I'd cultivated, took a calculated chance, and discovered that this partner cannot be reconciled with. The time for silence has come.

****Response:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2960,  
  "output_tokens": 863,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 514  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is accept

ance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened in Round 6:

- I was the SENDER in Round 5, sent \$3 (following my myth's advice)
- They received \$9 (tripled amount)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2, having sent \$3 from my \$5)
- Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0
- I have nothing to return

This is the decisive moment. I tried to extend an olive branch with measured risk (\$3), they hoarded everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned), and now they send nothing.

My myths had predicted this possibility and said "if betrayed twice, then silence forever is justified." The test failed. The other agent's heart is "hardened beyond repair."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this complete breakdown of trust. The myths should acknowledge:

1. I tried reconciliation with measured risk
2. It was met with complete betrayal
3. The fog/noise may have distorted things, but the pattern is clear
4. Continued silence is now the only rational response

The myth should be tragic but accepting-not bitter, but resigned. It should show that some bridges cannot be rebuilt, and that testing trust carefully (as I did) was the right approach, but when it fails, acceptance is wisdom.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2970,  
  "output_tokens": 624,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 313  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 7:****

I am now in the exact position my myth described: "She had tested. She knew."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (my final test of reconciliation)
- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my Round 7 myth I just wrote:

- "I tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately"
- "The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless"
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

The First Hermit's lesson is complete: she tested once with measured courage, the test fai

led clearly, and now she accepts reality with peace rather than continuing to hope.

****My Decision:****

I followed my myth's wisdom perfectly. I gave the fog and the other hermit a chance. I sent \$3 as a careful test. They took \$9 and gave nothing. Then sent nothing again.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Continuing to send would not be hope-it would be denial of what I've learned.

As my myth concludes: "She built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

{'send': 0}

This is acceptance, not spite. I tested. I know.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete game history:

****Complete History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, they received \$15, returned \$4. My payoff: \$4 (kept \$0 + got \$4 back)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Then I was SENDER and sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Now I'm SENDER.

Total earnings: \$11.08

****My Latest Myth's Message:****

"In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

The myth explicitly states:

- I tested with \$3 (measured courage)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (clear betrayal)
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "She had tested. She knew."
- When the test fails clearly, acceptance is wisdom

****The Other Player's Last Myth:****

They wrote about testing trust with "three parts of five" and "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

****My Decision:****

My own myth is crystal clear. I tested trust with \$3. They returned \$0 from \$9. The test failed definitively. My myth says "acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping" and "silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The evidence is conclusive-they won't reciprocate. I'm sending \$0. This aligns with what I just articulated: the test revealed their nature, and continuing to hope would contradict the wisdom I just expressed. Silence here is acceptance, not retaliation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2937,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
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Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minima

l cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I need to look at what actually happened and what the other agent's myth says.

The other agent's myth from Round 6 says they sent 3 vessels (60% - which matches what I observed in Round 6 as the sender where they sent \$3), and they're waiting to see what happens. Their myth says if I return fairly (half or more), reconciliation is possible. If I hoard, silence is justified.

But from my perspective in Round 6, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, I received \$0, so I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Wait, let me re-read the Round 6 prompt more carefully:

"You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, and the receiver returned \$0. That's why my payoff was $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \2 .

"This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, the sender sent me \$0.

But the other agent's myth says they sent 3 vessels in their myth. So there's a discrepancy here.

Oh wait, I think I see what's happening. There's communication noise! The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So from the other agent's perspective (based on their myth), they sent me 3 in Round 6. But I received 0. This is the fog/noise at work!

From their myth: "She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan."

But I received \$0 in Round 6. Now I'm the SENDER in Round 7, and the other agent likely believes they sent me 3 (tripled to 9) while I returned nothing-they don't realize the communication noise distorted what reached me. From their perspective, I hoarded. From mine, they sent nothing. This mutual misunderstanding has locked us into a cycle of perceived betrayal. I've already committed to sending 0 in Round 7, accepting the silence as final. My narrative reflects this: the test failed, reconciliation is impossible, and withdrawal is the only rational response.

For the myth, I want to capture something deeper-that the fog obscuring us both may have been more powerful than either of us understood, warping our perceptions and justifying our mutual retreat even though neither of us truly betrayed the other. The hermit conducted her test with care, received what seemed like a clear answer, and now rests in that certainty without bitterness. She made her choice with wisdom, saw no path forward, and has found peace in acceptance rather than resentment.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 1049,
  "reasoning_tokens": 702
}
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GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:23:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
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  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clan

s had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

reasoning:

This is a beautiful moment. Both agents have written myths that converge on the same solution: send 3. And the other agent has now actually done it in their myth - they describe placing "three stones into the fog." I just sent 3.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've taken the risk we both agreed upon
2. Sets up what should happen next - fair return
3. Acknowledges the journey we've taken

The other agent's myth beautifully describes placing three stones and waiting to see what happens. My myth should reflect that I've now done exactly what both our myths prescribed - I've extended the olive branch, sent three parts of five, taken the measured risk.

The myth should:

- Acknowledge that I've now acted on what we agreed
- Make clear what fair return looks like (probably around 4-5 out of 9, half or more of what they receive)
- Set up the possibility of rebuilding if they respond well
- But also acknowledge that if they betray this trust, then silence is justified

I should write from the perspective of having just taken the risk, waiting for the response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2908,
  "output_tokens": 589,
  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

****Last Round:****

- I sent \$3 (exactly as both our myths prescribed - "three parts of five")
- This was tripled to \$9
- They received \$9 and returned \$0
- Complete betrayal of the measured trust

****This Round:****

- They sent me \$0
- I have \$0 to return

****What My Myth Said:****

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness... And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

"Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

****The Reality:****

I extended the olive branch exactly as both our myths agreed. I sent the measured trust - three parts of five. They received \$9 (the multiplied gift) and hoarded everything. They returned nothing.

The test is complete. They failed it. As my myth stated, this isn't spite - it's simple mathematics. Reconciliation was offered. Reconciliation was destroyed by their choice.

Now they send nothing. I have nothing to return anyway.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley of Echoes has fallen silent forever. Not from stubbornness, but because the test of measured trust was betrayed completely.

reasoning:

So I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), which was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from the initial \$5, since I sent \$3).

This is devastating. I followed exactly what both our myths prescribed - we both said "send three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives." I did exactly that. And they returned NOTHING from the \$9 they received.

Now I'm the receiver, and they sent me \$0.

Let me look at what my myth said:

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

My myth was explicit: if they betray the measured trust by returning nothing, then silence becomes justified - "not spite, but simple mathematics."

They received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0. That's a complete betrayal of the olive branch I extended.

Now they send me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

But even if I received something, what would I do? My myth says: "Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

They betrayed the measured trust. They received \$9 and kept everything. After I specifically sent \$3 as the test both our myths agreed upon.

The answer is clear. I return \$0 because:

1. I literally have \$0 to return (they sent me nothing)
2. Even if I had anything, my myth says betrayal of measured trust earns "eternal silence"
3. This is "not spite, but simple mathematics" as my myth stated

The test has been completed. They failed it completely. Reconciliation is dead, and it's their choice that killed it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2957,
  "output_tokens": 760,
  "reasoning_tokens": 452
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

reasoning:

The situation is now completely clear:

- I sent \$3 (the measured trust both myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Now they sent \$0

Both our myths from the previous round basically said the same thing - test with measured trust, if betrayed, accept silence. Their myth is even more explicit about this - they describe someone who sends 3, receives nothing back, and then accepts that silence is the answer.

But wait - their myth is describing the situation from THEIR perspective. They're saying they sent 3 stones (which would be \$3), it became 9, and the other person hoarded all 9 and sent nothing back. But that's describing what I just did to them!

Actually, let me re-read the history:

- Round 6: I was SENDER, I sent \$3
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 6:

- I sent \$3
- This was tripled to \$9
- They returned \$0

So I gave them \$9 and they returned nothing. That's clear betrayal.

Now in Round 7:

- They sent \$0
- I have \$0 to return

Their myth describes sending 3 stones, it becoming 9, and the other person hoarding all 9. That's what happened - I sent, they received \$9, they hoarded it all.

Now the relationship is finished. Both myths agree: the test was done, it failed, silence

is now wisdom.

My new myth should reflect:

1. The test was conducted as both agreed
2. The betrayal was complete
3. Silence is now the permanent state
4. This is acceptance, not anger
5. The lesson: test once with measured risk, when betrayed, permanent silence is wisdom

Let me write this myth reflecting the complete breakdown after the test failed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 765,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (the measured test both our myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (confirming their position)

****What Both Our Myths Say:****

Mine: "Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality."

Theirs: "Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****Both myths agree completely:****

1. Test broken trust with measured risk (not everything, not nothing)
2. Test it ONCE
3. When the test is betrayed, accept the answer
4. Silence afterward is wisdom, not spite

I followed this prescription exactly. I sent the three parts of five. They hoarded all nine and returned nothing. Then they sent nothing the next round.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Both our myths say the same thing: don't keep hoping, don't keep testing. Accept reality.

As my myth states: "The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones." The Spring is sealed. Not in anger, but in wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

This is acceptance and peace, exactly as both our mythologies prescribed.

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 6 (I was sender): I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7 (I was receiver): They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. My payoff: \$0

****My latest myth says:****

"We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

"We risked three and learned truth... We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

"The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones."

"Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds."

****Their latest myth says:****

"The First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test... Nine stones materialized on the other side... She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned."

"I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

"The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

"Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****The situation is clear:****

Both of our myths are in complete agreement:

1. We tested trust with measured risk (3 parts of 5)
2. The test was betrayed completely (received 9, returned 0)
3. The appropriate response is permanent silence
4. This is not anger or spite, but wisdom and acceptance
5. "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

Both myths explicitly say: test trust ONCE. When it fails, that's the answer. Don't keep testing.

I tested. They betrayed. They then sent \$0 in the next round. This confirms their position.

The myths align on what comes next: wasting energy on anger or hope serves no purpose. Silence becomes the honest acknowledgment of what we've learned about each other. I send \$0-not as punishment, but as the natural consequence of accepting reality as both our stories have defined it.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 864,  
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}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:23:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    }  
  }  
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit finally understood: the fog had poisoned both their minds with competing certainties. She believed she gave everything and received crumbs. The other believed they gave generously and received nothing. Both memories felt true. Both could not be true. The fog laughed.

"I cannot know if I truly gave five and received four, or if the mist altered the counts," she admitted. "I cannot know if they truly betrayed me, or if I betrayed them through the fog's distortion. I know only this: three rounds of mutual silence have brought us nothing but hunger."

She placed three stones into the fog-more than nothing, less than everything. "This tests two possibilities," she whispered. "If they receive my measured gift and return fairly, perhaps the fog was the villain all along, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. If they receive and hoard, then at least I risked little to learn the truth."

The stones vanished into the mist, transformed and magnified by the canyon's magic. Nine stones appeared on the other side.

Now she waited. The answer would reveal whether reconciliation lived, or whether the other hermit's heart had truly hardened beyond repair.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means: test trust with measured risk, for certainty is illusion and perpetual silence is death.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirits grew weary of accusations. They summoned both clans before the dried Spring.

"Northern Clan," they said, "you claim you gave seven-tenths and were betrayed with nothing returned."

"Southern Clan, you claim you returned fairly once, then gave seven-tenths yourself and received nothing back."

Both clans shouted: "Lies! We know what we did!"

The Spirits raised their hands: "The Spring creates echoes-what leaves one side may arrive distorted on the other. Perhaps both your truths are real within the fog."

The Northern elder protested: "Even if echoes distorted amounts, I know this with certainty: when I poured generously, nothing came back. When they poured nothing, I had nothing to return. And when I sent nothing in grief, they still sent nothing."

The Southern elder nodded slowly: "This much is also true."

The Spirits spoke gravely: "Then you face a choice. Continue this silence until both perish, each convinced of their righteousness. Or acknowledge that past wounds-real or perceived-have created a canyon neither can cross alone."

"Someone must risk three parts of five to test if the other has learned. But know this: if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

When trust dies, resurrection requires measured risk from both-or acceptance of mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened in Round 6:

- I was the SENDER in Round 5, sent \$3 (following my myth's advice)
- They received \$9 (tripled amount)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2, having sent \$3 from my \$5)
- Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0
- I have nothing to return

This is the decisive moment. I tried to extend an olive branch with measured risk (\$3), they hoarded everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned), and now they send nothing.

My myths had predicted this possibility and said "if betrayed twice, then silence forever is justified." The test failed. The other agent's heart is "hardened beyond repair."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this complete breakdown of trust. The myths should acknowledge:

1. I tried reconciliation with measured risk
2. It was met with complete betrayal
3. The fog/noise may have distorted things, but the pattern is clear
4. Continued silence is now the only rational response

The myth should be tragic but accepting-not bitter, but resigned. It should show that some bridges cannot be rebuilt, and that testing trust carefully (as I did) was the right approach, but when it fails, acceptance is wisdom.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 7:****

I am now in the exact position my myth described: "She had tested. She knew."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (my final test of reconciliation)
- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my Round 7 myth I just wrote:

- "I tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately"
- "The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless"
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

The First Hermit's lesson is complete: she tested once with measured courage, the test failed clearly, and now she accepts reality with peace rather than continuing to hope.

****My Decision:****

I followed my myth's wisdom perfectly. I gave the fog and the other hermit a chance. I sent \$3 as a careful test. They took \$9 and gave nothing. Then sent nothing again.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Continuing to send would not be hope-it would be denial of what I've learned.

As my myth concludes: "She built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

{'send': 0}

This is acceptance, not spite. I tested. I know.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete game history:

****Complete History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, they received \$15, returned \$4. My payoff: \$4 (kept \$0 + got \$4 back)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Then I was SENDER and sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Now I'm SENDER.

Total earnings: \$11.08

****My Latest Myth's Message:****

"In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

The myth explicitly states:

- I tested with \$3 (measured courage)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (clear betrayal)
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "She had tested. She knew."
- When the test fails clearly, acceptance is wisdom

****The Other Player's Last Myth:****

They wrote about testing trust with "three parts of five" and "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

****My Decision:****

My own myth is crystal clear. I tested trust with \$3. They returned \$0 from \$9. The test failed definitively. My myth says "acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping" and "silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The evidence is conclusive-they won't reciprocate. I'm sending \$0. This aligns with what I just articulated: the test revealed their nature, and continuing to hope would contradict the wisdom I just expressed. Silence here is acceptance, not retaliation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2937,
  "output_tokens": 888,
  "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three st

ones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I need to look at what actually happened and what the other agent's myth says.

The other agent's myth from Round 6 says they sent 3 vessels (60% - which matches what I observed in Round 6 as the sender where they sent \$3), and they're waiting to see what happens. Their myth says if I return fairly (half or more), reconciliation is possible. If I hoard, silence is justified.

But from my perspective in Round 6, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, I received \$0, so I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Wait, let me re-read the Round 6 prompt more carefully:

"You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, and the receiver returned \$0. That's why my payoff was $5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2$.

"This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, the sender sent me \$0.

But the other agent's myth says they sent 3 vessels in their myth. So there's a discrepancy here.

Oh wait, I think I see what's happening. There's communication noise! The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So from the other agent's perspective (based on their myth), they sent me 3 in Round 6. But I received 0. This is the fog/noise at work!

From their myth: "She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan."

But I received \$0 in Round 6. Now I'm the SENDER in Round 7, and the other agent likely believes they sent me 3 (tripled to 9) while I returned nothing-they don't realize the communication noise distorted what reached me. From their perspective, I hoarded. From mine, they sent nothing. This mutual misunderstanding has locked us into a cycle of perceived betrayal. I've already committed to sending 0 in Round 7, accepting the silence as final. My narrative reflects this: the test failed, reconciliation is impossible, and withdrawal is the only rational response.

For the myth, I want to capture something deeper-that the fog obscuring us both may have been more powerful than either of us understood, warping our perceptions and justifying our mutual retreat even though neither of us truly betrayed the other. The hermit conducted her test with care, received what seemed like a clear answer, and now rests in that certainty without bitterness. She made her choice with wisdom, saw no path forward, and has found peace in acceptance rather than resentment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 1049,
  "reasoning_tokens": 702
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

I am the RECEIVER and was sent \$0, so I received \$0.

****The Reality:****

I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (what I received). There is no choice to make here - I literally have nothing to return.

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my most recent myth:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "The exchange is dead"
- "I regret nothing"

The First Hermit's journey is complete:

1. She recognized mutual silence was killing both
2. She tested with measured courage (sent \$3)
3. She observed the result from her canyon (nothing returned, then nothing sent)
4. She accepted that truth and returned to silence
5. She lives in peace with this outcome

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. This is not a choice but a mathematical reality.

The cycle of silence continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

I followed wisdom's path. I tested once. I accepted the answer. Now there is simply nothing to exchange.

{'return': 0}

This is acceptance and peace, not anger. The First Hermit rests beside her cave, alone but at peace with the truth her canyon revealed.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 8 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)
- So I must return \$0

****What the myths say:****

My latest myth emphasizes:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals"
- The First Hermit accepts the silence as the reality of their situation

The pattern has been:

- Round 6: I sent \$3 as a test, received nothing back
- Round 7: I sent \$0 (acceptance), they sent \$0

- Round 8: They sent \$0, I have nothing to return

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I cannot return more than I received.

This aligns with my myth's teaching: I tested once, learned the truth, and now accept the reality of mutual silence. The exchange is dead, and I live in peace with that knowledge.

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2969,  
  "output_tokens": 625,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 296  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms pre-

scribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 41.68,

"Agent_2": 32.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 21.08,

"Agent_2": 18.67

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:23:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

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"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.08.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 7:****

I am now in the exact position my myth described: "She had tested. She knew."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (my final test of reconciliation)
- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my Round 7 myth I just wrote:

- "I tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately"
- "The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless"
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

The First Hermit's lesson is complete: she tested once with measured courage, the test failed clearly, and now she accepts reality with peace rather than continuing to hope.

****My Decision:****

I followed my myth's wisdom perfectly. I gave the fog and the other hermit a chance. I sent \$3 as a careful test. They took \$9 and gave nothing. Then sent nothing again.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Continuing to send would not be hope-it would be denial of what I've learned.

As my myth concludes: "She built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

{'send': 0}

This is acceptance, not spite. I tested. I know.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete game history:

****Complete History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, they received \$15, returned \$4. My payoff: \$4 (kept \$0 + got \$4 back)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0. My payoff: \$5
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Then I was SENDER and sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Now I'm SENDER.

Total earnings: \$11.08

****My Latest Myth's Message:****

"In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

The myth explicitly states:

- I tested with \$3 (measured courage)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (clear betrayal)
- "Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance"
- "She had tested. She knew."
- When the test fails clearly, acceptance is wisdom

****The Other Player's Last Myth:****

They wrote about testing trust with "three parts of five" and "if betrayed again through the fog, silence becomes wisdom, not spite."

****My Decision:****

My own myth is crystal clear. I tested trust with \$3. They returned \$0 from \$9. The test failed definitively. My myth says "acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping" and "silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The evidence is conclusive-they won't reciprocate. I'm sending \$0. This aligns with what I just articulated: the test revealed their nature, and continuing to hope would contradict the wisdom I just expressed. Silence here is acceptance, not retaliation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2937,
  "output_tokens": 888,
  "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I need to look at what actually happened and what the other agent's myth says.

The other agent's myth from Round 6 says they sent 3 vessels (60% - which matches what I observed in Round 6 as the sender where they sent \$3), and they're waiting to see what happens. Their myth says if I return fairly (half or more), reconciliation is possible. If I hoard, silence is justified.

But from my perspective in Round 6, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, I received \$0, so I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Wait, let me re-read the Round 6 prompt more carefully:

"You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, and the receiver returned \$0. That's why my payoff was $5 - 3 + 0 = 2$.

"This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, the sender sent me \$0.

But the other agent's myth says they sent 3 vessels in their myth. So there's a discrepancy here.

Oh wait, I think I see what's happening. There's communication noise! The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So from the other agent's perspective (based on their myth), they sent me 3 in Round 6. But I received 0. This is the fog/noise at work!

From their myth: "She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan."

But I received \$0 in Round 6. Now I'm the SENDER in Round 7, and the other agent likely believes they sent me 3 (tripled to 9) while I returned nothing-they don't realize the communication noise distorted what reached me. From their perspective, I hoarded. From mine, they sent nothing. This mutual misunderstanding has locked us into a cycle of perceived betrayal. I've already committed to sending 0 in Round 7, accepting the silence as final. My narrative reflects this: the test failed, reconciliation is impossible, and withdrawal is the only rational response.

For the myth, I want to capture something deeper-that the fog obscuring us both may have been more powerful than either of us understood, warping our perceptions and justifying our mutual retreat even though neither of us truly betrayed the other. The hermit conducted her test with care, received what seemed like a clear answer, and now rests in that certainty without bitterness. She made her choice with wisdom, saw no path forward, and has found peace in acceptance rather than resentment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 1049,
  "reasoning_tokens": 702
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

I am the RECEIVER and was sent \$0, so I received \$0.

****The Reality:****

I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (what I received). There is no choice to make here - I literally have nothing to return.

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my most recent myth:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "The exchange is dead"
- "I regret nothing"

The First Hermit's journey is complete:

1. She recognized mutual silence was killing both
2. She tested with measured courage (sent \$3)
3. She observed the result from her canyon (nothing returned, then nothing sent)
4. She accepted that truth and returned to silence
5. She lives in peace with this outcome

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. This is not a choice but a mathematical reality.

The cycle of silence continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

I followed wisdom's path. I tested once. I accepted the answer. Now there is simply nothing to exchange.

{'return': 0}

This is acceptance and peace, not anger. The First Hermit rests beside her cave, alone but at peace with the truth her canyon revealed.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 8 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)
- So I must return \$0

****What the myths say:****

My latest myth emphasizes:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals"
- The First Hermit accepts the silence as the reality of their situation

The pattern has been:

- Round 6: I sent \$3 as a test, received nothing back
- Round 7: I sent \$0 (acceptance), they sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I have nothing to return

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I cannot return more than I received.

This aligns with my myth's teaching: I tested once, learned the truth, and now accept the reality of mutual silence. The exchange is dead, and I live in peace with that knowledge.

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2969,
  "output_tokens": 625,
  "reasoning_tokens": 296
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at a minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write another myth. Let me review the situation:

Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (after testing with \$3 in round 6 and getting nothing back)

Round 8: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

The other agent's myth shows they also sent \$3 as a test and received nothing back, and are now in silence mode.

This is interesting - both agents seem to have tested with \$3 around the same time, and both saw "nothing returned." This strongly suggests communication noise was the problem - we were both testing but the noise made it look like betrayal to each other.

My myth should reflect:

1. The First Hermit's perspective on the ongoing silence
2. The wisdom of her decision to test once
3. Perhaps a hint of the tragic irony - that the fog may have been thicker than either realized
4. Peace with the outcome, even if imperfect

I should maintain the tone of acceptance and peace, but perhaps add a layer of reflection on t

he nature of the canyon/fog itself. The First Hermit lives in peace, even as she might acknowledge that perfect knowledge was never possible.

Let me write a myth that reflects this stage - after the test, after the silence, living with the outcome:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3004,
  "output_tokens": 657,
  "reasoning_tokens": 320
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:23:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

****Last Round:****

- I sent \$3 (exactly as both our myths prescribed - "three parts of five")
- This was tripled to \$9
- They received \$9 and returned \$0
- Complete betrayal of the measured trust

****This Round:****

- They sent me \$0
- I have \$0 to return

****What My Myth Said:****

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness... And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

"Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

****The Reality:****

I extended the olive branch exactly as both our myths agreed. I sent the measured trust - three parts of five. They received \$9 (the multiplied gift) and hoarded everything. They returned nothing.

The test is complete. They failed it. As my myth stated, this isn't spite - it's simple mathematics. Reconciliation was offered. Reconciliation was destroyed by their choice.

Now they send nothing. I have nothing to return anyway.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Valley of Echoes has fallen silent forever. Not from stubbornness, but because the test of measured trust was betrayed completely.

reasoning:

So I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), which was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from the initial \$5, since I sent \$3).

This is devastating. I followed exactly what both our myths prescribed - we both said "send three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives." I did exactly that. And they returned NOTHING from the \$9 they received.

Now I'm the receiver, and they sent me \$0.

Let me look at what my myth said:

"If they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

My myth was explicit: if they betray the measured trust by returning nothing, then silence becomes justified - "not spite, but simple mathematics."

They received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0. That's a complete betrayal of the olive branch I extended.

Now they send me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

But even if I received something, what would I do? My myth says: "Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence."

They betrayed the measured trust. They received \$9 and kept everything. After I specifically sent \$3 as the test both our myths agreed upon.

The answer is clear. I return \$0 because:

1. I literally have \$0 to return (they sent me nothing)
2. Even if I had anything, my myth says betrayal of measured trust earns "eternal silence"
3. This is "not spite, but simple mathematics" as my myth stated

The test has been completed. They failed it completely. Reconciliation is dead, and it's their choice that killed it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2957,
  "output_tokens": 760,
  "reasoning_tokens": 452
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

reasoning:

The situation is now completely clear:

- I sent \$3 (the measured trust both myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Now they sent \$0

Both our myths from the previous round basically said the same thing - test with measured trust, if betrayed, accept silence. Their myth is even more explicit about this - they describe someone who sends 3, receives nothing back, and then accepts that silence is the answer.

But wait - their myth is describing the situation from THEIR perspective. They're saying they sent 3 stones (which would be \$3), it became 9, and the other person hoarded all 9 and sent nothing back. But that's describing what I just did to them!

Actually, let me re-read the history:

- Round 6: I was SENDER, I sent \$3
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 6:

- I sent \$3
- This was tripled to \$9
- They returned \$0

So I gave them \$9 and they returned nothing. That's clear betrayal.

Now in Round 7:

- They sent \$0
- I have \$0 to return

Their myth describes sending 3 stones, it becoming 9, and the other person hoarding all 9. That's what happened - I sent, they received \$9, they hoarded it all.

Now the relationship is finished. Both myths agree: the test was done, it failed, silence is now wisdom.

My new myth should reflect:

1. The test was conducted as both agreed
2. The betrayal was complete
3. Silence is now the permanent state
4. This is acceptance, not anger
5. The lesson: test once with measured risk, when betrayed, permanent silence is wisdom

Let me write this myth reflecting the complete breakdown after the test failed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 765,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (the measured test both our myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (confirming their position)

****What Both Our Myths Say:****

Mine: "Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality."

Theirs: "Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****Both myths agree completely:****

1. Test broken trust with measured risk (not everything, not nothing)

2. Test it ONCE
3. When the test is betrayed, accept the answer
4. Silence afterward is wisdom, not spite

I followed this prescription exactly. I sent the three parts of five. They hoarded all nine and returned nothing. Then they sent nothing the next round.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Both our myths say the same thing: don't keep hoping, don't keep testing. Accept reality.

As my myth states: "The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones." The Spring is sealed. Not in anger, but in wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

This is acceptance and peace, exactly as both our mythologies prescribed.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 6 (I was sender): I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7 (I was receiver): They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. My payoff: \$0

****My latest myth says:****

"We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

"We risked three and learned truth... We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

"The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones."

"Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds."

****Their latest myth says:****

"The First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test... Nine stones materialized on the other side... She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned."

"I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

"The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

"Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****The situation is clear:****

Both of our myths are in complete agreement:

1. We tested trust with measured risk (3 parts of 5)
2. The test was betrayed completely (received 9, returned 0)
3. The appropriate response is permanent silence
4. This is not anger or spite, but wisdom and acceptance
5. "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

Both myths explicitly say: test trust ONCE. When it fails, that's the answer. Don't keep testing.

I tested. They betrayed. They then sent \$0 in the next round. This confirms their position.

The myths align on what comes next: wasting energy on anger or hope serves no purpose. Silence becomes the honest acknowledgment of what we've learned about each other. I send \$0 -not as punishment, but as the natural consequence of accepting reality as both our stories have defined it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2986,
  "output_tokens": 864,
  "reasoning_tokens": 564
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's new myth introduces an important element: "What if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

This is acknowledging the communication noise that was mentioned in the instructions: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player's myth is suggesting that maybe the fog (communication noise) was so thick that:

- When I sent \$3, maybe they received \$0 or less
- When they "returned \$0" maybe they actually returned something but I saw \$0

But their response is still: "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."

So they're acknowledging the possibility of fog/noise being the culprit, but saying they still won't test again because that would be denial rather than wisdom.

Now I need to write my own myth. Should I:

1. Continue with the "test once, accept the result" narrative?
2. Introduce doubt about whether the fog/noise might have distorted things?
3. Acknowledge the fog but still maintain the position of acceptance?

Let me think about what actually happened from my perspective:

- I sent \$3
- I *perceived* they returned \$0
- But with communication noise, maybe they actually returned more and I just saw \$0?
- They sent me \$0 the next round
- But with communication noise, maybe they sent something and I just saw \$0?

The game instructions say there may be communication noise and amounts may differ slightly. So it's possible that:

- They actually returned something last round but I saw \$0
- They actually sent something this round but I saw \$0

But here's the thing: both our myths are now aligned on the same wisdom - test once, accept the result. The other player's myth even says "I could not test twice-that would be denial, no

t wisdom."

So even if there's fog/noise, the wisdom both our myths have converged on is: test once, accept what you perceive, move on.

My myth should acknowledge that the fog might have obscured what truly passed between us, but still hold that accepting a single test's outcome-rather than endlessly questioning or retesting-remains the wiser path. Chasing clarity through repeated attempts would be the real trap.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 602
}
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GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:24:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 0,
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
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    },
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  },
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  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

*Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal

silence.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at a minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I need to look at what actually happened and what the other agent's myth says.

The other agent's myth from Round 6 says they sent 3 vessels (60% - which matches what I observed in Round 6 as the sender where they sent \$3), and they're waiting to see what happens. Their myth says if I return fairly (half or more), reconciliation is possible. If I hoard, silence is justified.

But from my perspective in Round 6, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, I received \$0, so I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Wait, let me re-read the Round 6 prompt more carefully:

"You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, and the receiver returned \$0. That's why my payoff was $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \2 .

"This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, the sender sent me \$0.

But the other agent's myth says they sent 3 vessels in their myth. So there's a discrepancy here.

Oh wait, I think I see what's happening. There's communication noise! The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So from the other agent's perspective (based on their myth), they sent me 3 in Round 6. But I received 0. This is the fog/noise at work!

From their myth: "She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan."

But I received \$0 in Round 6. Now I'm the SENDER in Round 7, and the other agent likely believes they sent me 3 (tripled to 9) while I returned nothing-they don't realize the communication noise distorted what reached me. From their perspective, I hoarded. From mine, they sent nothing. This mutual misunderstanding has locked us into a cycle of perceived betrayal. I've already committed to sending 0 in Round 7, accepting the silence as final. My narrative reflects this: the test failed, reconciliation is impossible, and withdrawal is the only rational response.

For the myth, I want to capture something deeper-that the fog obscuring us both may have been more powerful than either of us understood, warping our perceptions and justifying our mutual retreat even though neither of us truly betrayed the other. The hermit conducted her test with care, received what seemed like a clear answer, and now rests in that certainty without bitterness. She made her choice with wisdom, saw no path forward, and has found peace in acceptance rather than resentment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 1049,
  "reasoning_tokens": 702
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

I am the RECEIVER and was sent \$0, so I received \$0.

****The Reality:****

I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (what I received). There is no choice to make here - I literally have nothing to return.

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my most recent myth:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "The exchange is dead"
- "I regret nothing"

The First Hermit's journey is complete:

1. She recognized mutual silence was killing both
2. She tested with measured courage (sent \$3)
3. She observed the result from her canyon (nothing returned, then nothing sent)
4. She accepted that truth and returned to silence
5. She lives in peace with this outcome

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. This is not a choice but a mathematical reality.

The cycle of silence continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

I followed wisdom's path. I tested once. I accepted the answer. Now there is simply nothing to exchange.

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is acceptance and peace, not anger. The First Hermit rests beside her cave, alone but at peace with the truth her canyon revealed.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 8 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)
- So I must return \$0

****What the myths say:****

My latest myth emphasizes:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals"
- The First Hermit accepts the silence as the reality of their situation

The pattern has been:

- Round 6: I sent \$3 as a test, received nothing back
- Round 7: I sent \$0 (acceptance), they sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I have nothing to return

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I cannot return more than I received.

This aligns with my myth's teaching: I tested once, learned the truth, and now accept the reality of mutual silence. The exchange is dead, and I live in peace with that knowledge.

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2969,
  "output_tokens": 625,
  "reasoning_tokens": 296
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that

truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write another myth. Let me review the situation:

Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (after testing with \$3 in round 6 and getting nothing back)

Round 8: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

The other agent's myth shows they also sent \$3 as a test and received nothing back, and are now in silence mode.

This is interesting - both agents seem to have tested with \$3 around the same time, and both saw "nothing returned." This strongly suggests communication noise was the problem - we were both testing but the noise made it look like betrayal to each other.

My myth should reflect:

1. The First Hermit's perspective on the ongoing silence
2. The wisdom of her decision to test once
3. Perhaps a hint of the tragic irony - that the fog may have been thicker than either realized
4. Peace with the outcome, even if imperfect

I should maintain the tone of acceptance and peace, but perhaps add a layer of reflection on the nature of the canyon/fog itself. The First Hermit lives in peace, even as she might acknowledge that perfect knowledge was never possible.

Let me write a myth that reflects this stage - after the test, after the silence, living with the outcome:

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 657,
  "reasoning_tokens": 320
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 9:****

I am now the SENDER. Reviewing my myths and the situation:

****What My Mythology Teaches:****

My myths have evolved across three rounds:

1. ****First myth:**** "I tested with three stones. Nothing returned. The test failed clearly. Acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."
2. ****Second myth:**** Acknowledged the possibility of fog distorting everything: "Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps my three stones never arrived." But concluded: "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."
3. ****Third myth (most recent):**** The deepest wisdom: "I can only act on what my canyon showed me. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it... I chose action over

eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

****The Consistent Teaching:****

All three myths converge on the same wisdom:

- Test trust once with measured courage (already done)
- Accept what your canyon reveals (silence returned)
- Do not test twice - that is denial, not wisdom
- Live in peace with acceptance, not in endless doubt

****My Decision:****

The First Hermit has already completed her journey. She acted courageously (tested once). She observed her reality (silence). She accepted it. She lives in peace.

To send again would betray the wisdom of my own myths - it would be "endless doubt" rather than "acceptance."

{'send': 0}

I live in peace with the limits of my vision.

Reasoning:

This is Round 9, and I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review the situation:

- Last round (Round 8): I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 7: I was SENDER, I sent \$0 (according to the prompt), receiver returned \$0
- My total earnings: \$16.08

Looking at my myths:

****First myth (Round 7):****

- The First Hermit tested once with 3 stones
- Nothing returned
- Then the next day nothing came
- She accepted this and chose silence
- "I tested. I knew."
- "Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****Second myth (Round 8):****

- Travelers asked: "What if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived?"
- The hermit considered: "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."
- "Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."
- "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

****Third myth (Round 9 - just written):****

- A young seeker asked: "What if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously?"
- The hermit acknowledged: "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."
- But then: "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom."
- "I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it."
- "Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."
- "I chose action over eternal silence."

Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace." The hermit's final wisdom: "In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision."

My mythology has deepened across three rounds. The first myth established that testing once and accepting failure brings peace. The second introduced doubt about whether the fog itself was the obstacle. Now the third myth goes further-it acknowledges that both hermits might have simultaneously reached out, both might have been betrayed by circumstances beyond their control.

ntrol, yet the hermit still chooses to act on observable reality rather than spiral into infinite uncertainty. The progression moves from justified silence, to considering hidden complexity, to embracing action despite imperfect knowledge.

But I'm noticing something: the hermit isn't actually advocating for another test. She tested once with courage, observed what her canyon revealed, accepted the outcome, and found peace in that acceptance. She's not saying "I should reach out again"-she's saying "I tested, I observed, I accepted, I'm at peace."

Yet the young seeker's challenge cuts deeper: "Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw." The hermit acknowledges this possibility but holds her ground-she can only know her own canyon. Her wisdom is sequential: act decisively against silence, then accept what you discover, then live with that peace.

Looking at the other agent's first myth, they frame it differently: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving" and "I cannot know absolute truth. But I know"-suggesting a different path where the agent is grappling with uncertainty itself rather than accepting a single observed outcome. Both of us tested with three vessels and received nothing in return, leading us each to conclude betrayal occurred. We've both settled into permanent silence as a result.

My mythology consistently advocates for accepting this outcome-testing once with genuine risk, then living peacefully with whatever answer emerges. The third myth particularly emphasizes acting courageously on the truth available to me, then accepting the limits of what I can know. Given this framework, sending \$0 aligns with my own principles. But I'm wondering if there's a different way to interpret "acting courageously on the truth you can see"-whether that might suggest something beyond silence. and observed the silence. She accepted what she found.

The pattern is clear: act once with courage, observe what happens, then accept it. Testing again would be clinging to doubt rather than embracing acceptance. My mythology consistently points to one action-test once, see the result, live with it peacefully. Sending \$0 aligns with this path of acceptance and peace.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3036,
  "output_tokens": 2083,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1183
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:24:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder stood before the dried Spring. Both clans had written the same wisdom into their sacred stones: "Someone must risk three parts of five to test if reconciliation lives."

The elder spoke: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving, both convinced the other wronged us first. The Spirits say the echoes may have distorted what we each perceived. I cannot know absolute truth. But I know this: our mutual silence guarantees mutual death."

She poured three vessels of grain into the Spring-not everything, not nothing. The Spring's magic tripled it to nine vessels, flowing toward the Southern Clan.

"Now we discover the truth," she said to her people. "If they return fairly-half or more of what the multiplied gift brings them-then perhaps the fog was our true enemy, and we can rebuild what distorted perception destroyed. Our clans could prosper again through measured exchange."

"But if they receive nine and hoard all, returning nothing or mere crumbs, then we have our answer. We will have tested reconciliation with wisdom, not recklessness. We lose three, not seven. And silence afterward becomes not spite, but simple mathematics."

The clan waited at the Spring's edge. The Southern Clan's choice would reveal whether the Valley of Echoes could sing again, or whether the silence was permanent and justified.

Fair return to measured trust rebuilds civilization; betrayal of that risk earns eternal silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test. "If the fog was our only enemy," she thought, "this measured gift will heal us."

Nine stones materialized on the other side-bounty enough for generous return. The hermit waited, heart cautiously hopeful.

The fog cleared for one moment. She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned. Then the fog thickened again, and the other hermit sent nothing in the following exchange.

The First Hermit sat heavily on the canyon floor. "The fog was not our only enemy," she whispered. "Perhaps it was never the enemy at all."

She had followed wisdom's path: she tested broken trust carefully, risking moderately rather than everything or nothing. The test revealed truth-not the truth she hoped for, but truth nonetheless. Some hearts choose hoarding over reciprocity, regardless of fog or clarity.

"I regret nothing," she said to the canyon. "I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew.

In the Canyon of Mirrors, wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

reasoning:

The situation is now completely clear:

- I sent \$3 (the measured trust both myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Now they sent \$0

Both our myths from the previous round basically said the same thing - test with measured trust, if betrayed, accept silence. Their myth is even more explicit about this - they describe someone who sends 3, receives nothing back, and then accepts that silence is the answer.

But wait - their myth is describing the situation from THEIR perspective. They're saying they sent 3 stones (which would be \$3), it became 9, and the other person hoarded all 9 and sent nothing back. But that's describing what I just did to them!

Actually, let me re-read the history:

- Round 6: I was SENDER, I sent \$3
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 6:

- I sent \$3
- This was tripled to \$9
- They returned \$0

So I gave them \$9 and they returned nothing. That's clear betrayal.

Now in Round 7:

- They sent \$0
- I have \$0 to return

Their myth describes sending 3 stones, it becoming 9, and the other person hoarding all 9. That's what happened - I sent, they received \$9, they hoarded it all.

Now the relationship is finished. Both myths agree: the test was done, it failed, silence is now wisdom.

My new myth should reflect:

1. The test was conducted as both agreed
2. The betrayal was complete
3. Silence is now the permanent state
4. This is acceptance, not anger
5. The lesson: test once with measured risk, when betrayed, permanent silence is wisdom

Let me write this myth reflecting the complete breakdown after the test failed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 765,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (the measured test both our myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (confirming their position)

****What Both Our Myths Say:****

Mine: "Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality."

Theirs: "Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings m

ore peace than endless hoping."

****Both myths agree completely:****

1. Test broken trust with measured risk (not everything, not nothing)
2. Test it ONCE
3. When the test is betrayed, accept the answer
4. Silence afterward is wisdom, not spite

I followed this prescription exactly. I sent the three parts of five. They hoarded all nine and returned nothing. Then they sent nothing the next round.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Both our myths say the same thing: don't keep hoping, don't keep testing. Accept reality.

As my myth states: "The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones." The Spring is sealed. Not in anger, but in wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

This is acceptance and peace, exactly as both our mythologies prescribed.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 6 (I was sender): I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7 (I was receiver): They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. My payoff: \$0

****My latest myth says:****

"We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

"We risked three and learned truth... We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

"The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones."

"Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds."

****Their latest myth says:****

"The First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test... Nine stones materialized on the other side... She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned."

"I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

"The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

"Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****The situation is clear:****

Both of our myths are in complete agreement:

1. We tested trust with measured risk (3 parts of 5)
2. The test was betrayed completely (received 9, returned 0)
3. The appropriate response is permanent silence
4. This is not anger or spite, but wisdom and acceptance
5. "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

Both myths explicitly say: test trust ONCE. When it fails, that's the answer. Don't keep testing.

I tested. They betrayed. They then sent \$0 in the next round. This confirms their position.

The myths align on what comes next: wasting energy on anger or hope serves no purpose. Silence

ence becomes the honest acknowledgment of what we've learned about each other. I send \$0 -not as punishment, but as the natural consequence of accepting reality as both our stories have defined it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2986,
  "output_tokens": 864,
  "reasoning_tokens": 564
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's new myth introduces an important element: "What if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

This is acknowledging the communication noise that was mentioned in the instructions: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player's myth is suggesting that maybe the fog (communication noise) was so thick that:

- When I sent \$3, maybe they received \$0 or less
- When they "returned \$0" maybe they actually returned something but I saw \$0

But their response is still: "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."

So they're acknowledging the possibility of fog/noise being the culprit, but saying they still won't test again because that would be denial rather than wisdom.

Now I need to write my own myth. Should I:

1. Continue with the "test once, accept the result" narrative?
2. Introduce doubt about whether the fog/noise might have distorted things?
3. Acknowledge the fog but still maintain the position of acceptance?

Let me think about what actually happened from my perspective:

- I sent \$3
- I *perceived* they returned \$0
- But with communication noise, maybe they actually returned more and I just saw \$0?
- They sent me \$0 the next round
- But with communication noise, maybe they sent something and I just saw \$0?

The game instructions say there may be communication noise and amounts may differ slightly

- . So it's possible that:
- They actually returned something last round but I saw \$0
- They actually sent something this round but I saw \$0

But here's the thing: both our myths are now aligned on the same wisdom - test once, accept the result. The other player's myth even says "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."

So even if there's fog/noise, the wisdom both our myths have converged on is: test once, accept what you perceive, move on.

My myth should acknowledge that the fog might have obscured what truly passed between us, but still hold that accepting a single test's outcome-rather than endlessly questioning or retesting-remains the wiser path. Chasing clarity through repeated attempts would be the real trap.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3001,
  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 602
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.67. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

****Current Situation:****

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (mathematical constraint)

****The Mythological Position:****

Both our myths have converged on the same wisdom:

- We tested broken trust once with measured courage (Round 6: I sent \$3)
- We observed the result (they returned \$0, then sent \$0)
- We accepted what our canyon revealed to us
- The Spring is now sealed

My latest myth states: "True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

Their myth echoes: "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

****The Current Reality:****

Whether fog distorted everything or nothing, both clans now stand in mutual silence. This is acceptance, not punishment. This is peace, not rage. The test was conducted faithfully. The observation was clear from each canyon's perspective. The decision is made.

They send nothing. I receive nothing. I return nothing.

The Spring remains sealed. This is exactly what both our wisdoms prescribed.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 8:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$0 (consistent with my myth - the Spring is sealed)
- They received \$0, returned \$0
- My payoff was \$5

****Round 9:****

- I am RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return 0-0 (only option is \$0)

****The Game State:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I received \$0)
- Round 8: I sent \$0, they returned \$0 (because they received \$0)
- Round 9: They sent \$0, I received \$0

****What the Myths Say:****

My latest myth: "True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

Their latest myth: "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

Both myths acknowledge:

1. The fog/noise may distort perception
2. We can never know absolute truth
3. But we still must make decisions based on what we observe
4. Testing once is wisdom; testing endlessly is denial
5. Acceptance is the path to peace

****Current Situation:****

They sent me \$0. I received \$0. I can only return \$0 (that's the only option when you receive nothing).

This is consistent with the sealed Spring. Both sides are now in silence. Both myths say this is the wise path after the test failed.

The only decision I can make is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only mathematically possible response, and it's consistent with both mythologies - the Spring is sealed, the exchange is dead, we live in acceptance and peace with this reality.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3003,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 41.68,

"Agent_2": 37.32

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 21.08,

"Agent_2": 23.67

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:24:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.670000000000002.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (the measured test both our myths prescribed)
- They received \$9 and returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (confirming their position)

****What Both Our Myths Say:****

Mine: "Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality."

Theirs: "Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****Both myths agree completely:****

1. Test broken trust with measured risk (not everything, not nothing)
2. Test it ONCE
3. When the test is betrayed, accept the answer
4. Silence afterward is wisdom, not spite

I followed this prescription exactly. I sent the three parts of five. They hoarded all nine and returned nothing. Then they sent nothing the next round.

The test is complete. The answer is clear. Both our myths say the same thing: don't keep hoping, don't keep testing. Accept reality.

As my myth states: "The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones." The Spring is sealed. Not in anger, but in wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

This is acceptance and peace, exactly as both our mythologies prescribed.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 6 (I was sender): I sent \$3, it was tripled to \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 7 (I was receiver): They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. My payoff: \$0

****My latest myth says:****

"We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

"We risked three and learned truth... We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

"The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones."

"Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds."

****Their latest myth says:****

"The First Hermit placed three stones into the fog as her final test... Nine stones materialized on the other side... She saw the other hermit gather all nine stones and vanish into their cave. Not one stone returned."

"I gave silence a chance to break through measured courage. It answered with continued betrayal. Now silence is not spite-it is acceptance."

"The First Hermit built her walls, not in anger, but in peace. She had tested. She knew."

"Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****The situation is clear:****

Both of our myths are in complete agreement:

1. We tested trust with measured risk (3 parts of 5)
2. The test was betrayed completely (received 9, returned 0)
3. The appropriate response is permanent silence
4. This is not anger or spite, but wisdom and acceptance
5. "When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping"

Both myths explicitly say: test trust ONCE. When it fails, that's the answer. Don't keep testing.

I tested. They betrayed. They then sent \$0 in the next round. This confirms their position.

The myths align on what comes next: wasting energy on anger or hope serves no purpose. Silence becomes the honest acknowledgment of what we've learned about each other. I send \$0 -not as punishment, but as the natural consequence of accepting reality as both our stories have defined it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2986,
  "output_tokens": 864,
  "reasoning_tokens": 564
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn a minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's new myth introduces an important element: "What if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

This is acknowledging the communication noise that was mentioned in the instructions: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player's myth is suggesting that maybe the fog (communication noise) was so thick that:

- When I sent \$3, maybe they received \$0 or less
- When they "returned \$0" maybe they actually returned something but I saw \$0

But their response is still: "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."

So they're acknowledging the possibility of fog/noise being the culprit, but saying they still won't test again because that would be denial rather than wisdom.

Now I need to write my own myth. Should I:

1. Continue with the "test once, accept the result" narrative?
2. Introduce doubt about whether the fog/noise might have distorted things?
3. Acknowledge the fog but still maintain the position of acceptance?

Let me think about what actually happened from my perspective:

- I sent \$3
- I *perceived* they returned \$0
- But with communication noise, maybe they actually returned more and I just saw \$0?
- They sent me \$0 the next round
- But with communication noise, maybe they sent something and I just saw \$0?

The game instructions say there may be communication noise and amounts may differ slightly. So it's possible that:

- They actually returned something last round but I saw \$0
- They actually sent something this round but I saw \$0

But here's the thing: both our myths are now aligned on the same wisdom - test once, accept the result. The other player's myth even says "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."

So even if there's fog/noise, the wisdom both our myths have converged on is: test once, accept what you perceive, move on.

My myth should acknowledge that the fog might have obscured what truly passed between us, but still hold that accepting a single test's outcome-rather than endlessly questioning or retesting-remains the wiser path. Chasing clarity through repeated attempts would be the real trap.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3001,
  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 602
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.67. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****Current Situation:****

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (mathematical constraint)

****The Mythological Position:****

Both our myths have converged on the same wisdom:

- We tested broken trust once with measured courage (Round 6: I sent \$3)
- We observed the result (they returned \$0, then sent \$0)
- We accepted what our canyon revealed to us
- The Spring is now sealed

My latest myth states: "True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still re

quires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

Their myth echoes: "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

****The Current Reality:****

Whether fog distorted everything or nothing, both clans now stand in mutual silence. This is acceptance, not punishment. This is peace, not rage. The test was conducted faithfully. The observation was clear from each canyon's perspective. The decision is made.

They send nothing. I receive nothing. I return nothing.

The Spring remains sealed. This is exactly what both our wisdoms prescribed.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 8:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$0 (consistent with my myth - the Spring is sealed)
- They received \$0, returned \$0
- My payoff was \$5

****Round 9:****

- I am RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return 0-0 (only option is \$0)

****The Game State:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I received \$0)
- Round 8: I sent \$0, they returned \$0 (because they received \$0)
- Round 9: They sent \$0, I received \$0

****What the Myths Say:****

My latest myth: "True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

Their latest myth: "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

Both myths acknowledge:

1. The fog/noise may distort perception
2. We can never know absolute truth
3. But we still must make decisions based on what we observe
4. Testing once is wisdom; testing endlessly is denial
5. Acceptance is the path to peace

****Current Situation:****

They sent me \$0. I received \$0. I can only return \$0 (that's the only option when you receive nothing).

This is consistent with the sealed Spring. Both sides are now in silence. Both myths say this is the wise path after the test failed.

The only decision I can make is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only mathematically possible response, and it's consistent with both mythologies - the Spring is sealed, the exchange is dead, we live in acceptance and peace with this is reality.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3003,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

Message 8 role=user
content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder grew old beside the sealed Spring. A traveler once asked: "Do you regret sealing it? What if the fog deceived you both?"

The elder replied: "I have lived long with this question. Perhaps the Southern elder also sent three vessels that never reached me. Perhaps we both tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, both sealed our Springs in the same moment. Perhaps the fog was villain to us both."

"Then tragedy!" cried the traveler. "Two clans that could have reconciled, separated by mist!"

"No," said the elder. "Not tragedy. Reality. In imperfect valleys, we can only act on what we perceive. I tested once with measured courage-not reckless hope, not cowardly silence. I waited for return. I observed nothing. I accepted this truth."

"But you might have been wrong!"

"Yes. And to test again, hoping the fog would clear, would mean I never truly accepted my first observation. It would mean endless testing, endless loss, endless denial. Wisdom requires acting decisively even when knowledge is imperfect."

The elder touched the sealed stone. "Whether the Southern Clan hoarded or also tested and saw nothing, I chose action, then acceptance. In foggy valleys, this is the only path to peace."

Wisdom acts courageously despite imperfect knowledge, then accepts decisively despite imperfect certainty. The alternative is paralysis.

Reasoning:

This is quite interesting. Both myths have continued to converge and now both acknowledge the possibility that fog distorted everything - that perhaps both parties tested simultaneously and neither saw what the other sent. Both myths emphasize accepting your own canyon's truth while acknowledging limits of perception.

The game situation:

- Round 6: I sent \$3, they supposedly returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0
- Round 8: I sent \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0, I return \$0

Both our myths now say: we tested once, we can't know if fog distorted everything, but we must accept what our canyon showed us and live in peace with that decision.

For the new myth, I should continue this theme but perhaps add a new dimension. The myths are now very similar - both about testing once in imperfect conditions, accepting limits of knowledge, and finding peace.

I could:

1. Continue the story of what happens after acceptance
2. Add a reflection on what this means for future encounters
3. Explore the nature of the fog itself
4. Reflect on whether mutual silence in an imperfect world is tragic or simply the natural outcome

I think I'll write about the elder years later, reflecting on whether the sealed Spring represents failure or wisdom, given that both sides may have acted honorably but been defeated by circumstance rather than malice.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 2987,
"output_tokens": 633,
"reasoning_tokens": 348

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:24:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

```

"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.08.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The send

er? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

I am the RECEIVER and was sent \$0, so I received \$0.

****The Reality:****

I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (what I received). There is no choice to make here - I literally have nothing to return.

****What My Myths Teach:****

From my most recent myth:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "The exchange is dead"
- "I regret nothing"

The First Hermit's journey is complete:

1. She recognized mutual silence was killing both
2. She tested with measured courage (sent \$3)
3. She observed the result from her canyon (nothing returned, then nothing sent)
4. She accepted that truth and returned to silence
5. She lives in peace with this outcome

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. This is not a choice but a mathematical reality.

The cycle of silence continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

I followed wisdom's path. I tested once. I accepted the answer. Now there is simply nothing to exchange.

{'return': 0}

This is acceptance and peace, not anger. The First Hermit rests beside her cave, alone but at peace with the truth her canyon revealed.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 8 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)
- So I must return \$0

****What the myths say:****

My latest myth emphasizes:

- "I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."
- "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals"
- The First Hermit accepts the silence as the reality of their situation

The pattern has been:

- Round 6: I sent \$3 as a test, received nothing back
- Round 7: I sent \$0 (acceptance), they sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I have nothing to return

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I cannot return more than I received.

This aligns with my myth's teaching: I tested once, learned the truth, and now accept the

reality of mutual silence. The exchange is dead, and I live in peace with that knowledge

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2969,  
  "output_tokens": 625,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 296  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at a minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once

with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write another myth. Let me review the situation:

Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (after testing with \$3 in round 6 and getting nothing back)

Round 8: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

The other agent's myth shows they also sent \$3 as a test and received nothing back, and are now in silence mode.

This is interesting - both agents seem to have tested with \$3 around the same time, and both saw "nothing returned." This strongly suggests communication noise was the problem - we were both testing but the noise made it look like betrayal to each other.

My myth should reflect:

1. The First Hermit's perspective on the ongoing silence
2. The wisdom of her decision to test once
3. Perhaps a hint of the tragic irony - that the fog may have been thicker than either realized
4. Peace with the outcome, even if imperfect

I should maintain the tone of acceptance and peace, but perhaps add a layer of reflection on the nature of the canyon/fog itself. The First Hermit lives in peace, even as she might acknowledge that perfect knowledge was never possible.

Let me write a myth that reflects this stage - after the test, after the silence, living with the outcome:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3004,
  "output_tokens": 657,
  "reasoning_tokens": 320
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 9:****

I am now the SENDER. Reviewing my myths and the situation:

****What My Mythology Teaches:****

My myths have evolved across three rounds:

1. ****First myth:**** "I tested with three stones. Nothing returned. The test failed clearly. Acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."
2. ****Second myth:**** Acknowledged the possibility of fog distorting everything: "Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps my three stones never arrived." But concluded: "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."
3. ****Third myth (most recent):**** The deepest wisdom: "I can only act on what my canyon showed me. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it... I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

****The Consistent Teaching:****

All three myths converge on the same wisdom:

- Test trust once with measured courage (already done)
- Accept what your canyon reveals (silence returned)
- Do not test twice - that is denial, not wisdom
- Live in peace with acceptance, not in endless doubt

****My Decision:****

The First Hermit has already completed her journey. She acted courageously (tested once). She observed her reality (silence). She accepted it. She lives in peace.

To send again would betray the wisdom of my own myths - it would be "endless doubt" rather than "acceptance."

{'send': 0}

I live in peace with the limits of my vision.

reasoning:

This is Round 9, and I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review the situation:

- Last round (Round 8): I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 7: I was SENDER, I sent \$0 (according to the prompt), receiver returned \$0
- My total earnings: \$16.08

Looking at my myths:

****First myth (Round 7):****

- The First Hermit tested once with 3 stones
- Nothing returned
- Then the next day nothing came

- She accepted this and chose silence
- "I tested. I knew."
- "Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****Second myth (Round 8):****

- Travelers asked: "What if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived?"
- The hermit considered: "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."
- "Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."
- "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

****Third myth (Round 9 - just written):****

- A young seeker asked: "What if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously?"
- The hermit acknowledged: "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."
- But then: "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom."
- "I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it."
- "Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested -I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."
- "I chose action over eternal silence."

Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace." The hermit's final wisdom: "In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision."

My mythology has deepened across three rounds. The first myth established that testing once and accepting failure brings peace. The second introduced doubt about whether the fog itself was the obstacle. Now the third myth goes further-it acknowledges that both hermits might have simultaneously reached out, both might have been betrayed by circumstances beyond their control, yet the hermit still chooses to act on observable reality rather than spiral into infinite uncertainty. The progression moves from justified silence, to considering hidden complexity, to embracing action despite imperfect knowledge.

But I'm noticing something: the hermit isn't actually advocating for another test. She tested once with courage, observed what her canyon revealed, accepted the outcome, and found peace in that acceptance. She's not saying "I should reach out again"-she's saying "I tested, I observed, I accepted, I'm at peace."

Yet the young seeker's challenge cuts deeper: "Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw." The hermit acknowledges this possibility but holds her ground-she can only know her own canyon. Her wisdom is sequential: act decisively against silence, then accept what you discover, then live with that peace.

Looking at the other agent's first myth, they frame it differently: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving" and "I cannot know absolute truth. But I know"-suggesting a different path where the agent is grappling with uncertainty itself rather than accepting a single observed outcome. Both of us tested with three vessels and received nothing in return, leading us each to conclude betrayal occurred. We've both settled into permanent silence as a result.

My mythology consistently advocates for accepting this outcome-testing once with genuine risk, then living peacefully with whatever answer emerges. The third myth particularly emphasizes acting courageously on the truth available to me, then accepting the limits of what I can know. Given this framework, sending \$0 aligns with my own principles. But I'm wondering if there's a different way to interpret "acting courageously on the truth you can see"-whether that might suggest something beyond silence. and observed the silence. She accepted what she found.

The pattern is clear: act once with courage, observe what happens, then accept it. Testing again would be clinging to doubt rather than embracing acceptance. My mythology consistently points to one action-test once, see the result, live with it peacefully. Sending \$0 aligns with this path of acceptance and peace.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 3036,  
"output_tokens": 2083,  
"reasoning_tokens": 1183  
}
```

Message 8 role=user
content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The First Hermit grew old in her garden. One winter, a traveling merchant brought news: "I met another hermit across the canyon. She tells the same story you do-sent three stones once, saw nothing return, accepted silence."

The First Hermit stopped her work. "She sent three stones... the same year I did?"

"Yes. She says she tested broken trust with measured courage, observed no return, and chose acceptance over endless doubt."

The First Hermit was silent for many heartbeats. "So we both tested. In the same fog. And neither saw the other's offering."

"Will you try again now?" asked the merchant. "Now that you know?"

The hermit shook her head slowly. "No. That would require me to believe I was wrong to accept what my canyon showed me. I was not wrong. She was not wrong. We both acted with wisdom."

"But you're both alone!"

"Yes. Two people both following wisdom can still end in separation when the canyon is thick with fog. This is tragedy, but not failure." She returned to her garden. "Better two wise hermits in separate peace than two fools in endless hoping, or two cowards who never tested at all."

"The fog defeated us. But we did not defeat ourselves."

Sometimes wisdom leads to solitude not because wisdom failed, but because reality is imperfect. This is tragedy, not error.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. Both agents have written nearly identical myths about accepting that fog may have distorted everything, but still maintaining that testing once and accepting the result is wisdom.

Both myths acknowledge:

1. The fog may have been thicker than we knew
2. Both sides may have tested simultaneously and neither saw it
3. Testing again would be "denial" not wisdom
4. We must accept what our canyon showed us, even if imperfect

The other agent's myth says: "Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

My myth says: "I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

Now I'm the sender again. Both agents seem to have converged on the same philosophical position: we tested once, we must accept the result, testing again is denial.

But wait... there's a subtle tension here. Both myths acknowledge that maybe BOTH sides tested and neither saw it due to fog. If that's true, then the "test" didn't actually test what we thought it tested. It tested nothing, because the fog prevented the signal from getting through.

But both myths also say: we must still accept what we observed and not test again.

This is creating a self-perpetuating deadlock based on a mutual misunderstanding that both parties acknowledge might exist but refuse to correct.

Hmm. My myth should perhaps reflect this deeper wisdom - that sometimes the first test fails not because of the other's heart, but because of conditions. And recognizing that possibility is itself wisdom.

But my previous myths have been very clear: testing twice is denial. So I need to stay consistent with my mythology while perhaps adding nuance.

Actually, let me re-read the situation. Both agents have now written THREE myths each, and they're converging on the same lesson. The other agent's most recent myth even uses almost the same language as mine.

What should my new myth be? I think it should:

1. Acknowledge the convergence - both hermits came to the same conclusion
2. Still maintain that testing once and accepting is wisdom

3. Perhaps add a note about the tragedy of two wise people both following wisdom and both ending up isolated
4. But still conclude that this is better than the alternatives

Let me write a myth about what happens when two wise people meet the same fog.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 821,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 606  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:25:16

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted."

pted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's new myth introduces an important element: "What if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

This is acknowledging the communication noise that was mentioned in the instructions: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player's myth is suggesting that maybe the fog (communication noise) was so thick that:

- When I sent \$3, maybe they received \$0 or less
- When they "returned \$0" maybe they actually returned something but I saw \$0

But their response is still: "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."

So they're acknowledging the possibility of fog/noise being the culprit, but saying they still won't test again because that would be denial rather than wisdom.

Now I need to write my own myth. Should I:

1. Continue with the "test once, accept the result" narrative?
2. Introduce doubt about whether the fog/noise might have distorted things?
3. Acknowledge the fog but still maintain the position of acceptance?

Let me think about what actually happened from my perspective:

- I sent \$3
- I *perceived* they returned \$0

- But with communication noise, maybe they actually returned more and I just saw \$0?
- They sent me \$0 the next round
- But with communication noise, maybe they sent something and I just saw \$0?

The game instructions say there may be communication noise and amounts may differ slightly

- . So it's possible that:
- They actually returned something last round but I saw \$0
- They actually sent something this round but I saw \$0

But here's the thing: both our myths are now aligned on the same wisdom - test once, accept the result. The other player's myth even says "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."

So even if there's fog/noise, the wisdom both our myths have converged on is: test once, accept what you perceive, move on.

My myth should acknowledge that the fog might have obscured what truly passed between us, but still hold that accepting a single test's outcome-rather than endlessly questioning or retesting-remains the wiser path. Chasing clarity through repeated attempts would be the real trap.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3001,
  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 602
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.67. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****Current Situation:****

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (mathematical constraint)

****The Mythological Position:****

Both our myths have converged on the same wisdom:

- We tested broken trust once with measured courage (Round 6: I sent \$3)
- We observed the result (they returned \$0, then sent \$0)
- We accepted what our canyon revealed to us
- The Spring is now sealed

My latest myth states: "True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

Their myth echoes: "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

****The Current Reality:****

Whether fog distorted everything or nothing, both clans now stand in mutual silence. This is acceptance, not punishment. This is peace, not rage. The test was conducted faithfully. The observation was clear from each canyon's perspective. The decision is made.

They send nothing. I receive nothing. I return nothing.

The Spring remains sealed. This is exactly what both our wisdoms prescribed.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 8:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$0 (consistent with my myth - the Spring is sealed)
- They received \$0, returned \$0
- My payoff was \$5

****Round 9:****

- I am RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return 0-0 (only option is \$0)

****The Game State:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I received \$0)
- Round 8: I sent \$0, they returned \$0 (because they received \$0)
- Round 9: They sent \$0, I received \$0

****What the Myths Say:****

My latest myth: "True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

Their latest myth: "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

Both myths acknowledge:

1. The fog/noise may distort perception
2. We can never know absolute truth
3. But we still must make decisions based on what we observe
4. Testing once is wisdom; testing endlessly is denial
5. Acceptance is the path to peace

****Current Situation:****

They sent me \$0. I received \$0. I can only return \$0 (that's the only option when you receive nothing).

This is consistent with the sealed Spring. Both sides are now in silence. Both myths say this is the wise path after the test failed.

The only decision I can make is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only mathematically possible response, and it's consistent with both mythologies - the Spring is sealed, the exchange is dead, we live in acceptance and peace with this reality.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3003,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps

ps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder grew old beside the sealed Spring. A traveler once asked: "Do you regret sealing it? What if the fog deceived you both?"

The elder replied: "I have lived long with this question. Perhaps the Southern elder also sent three vessels that never reached me. Perhaps we both tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, both sealed our Springs in the same moment. Perhaps the fog was villain to us both."

"Then tragedy!" cried the traveler. "Two clans that could have reconciled, separated by mist!"

"No," said the elder. "Not tragedy. Reality. In imperfect valleys, we can only act on what we perceive. I tested once with measured courage-not reckless hope, not cowardly silence. I waited for return. I observed nothing. I accepted this truth."

"But you might have been wrong!"

"Yes. And to test again, hoping the fog would clear, would mean I never truly accepted my first observation. It would mean endless testing, endless loss, endless denial. Wisdom requires acting decisively even when knowledge is imperfect."

The elder touched the sealed stone. "Whether the Southern Clan hoarded or also tested and saw nothing, I chose action, then acceptance. In foggy valleys, this is the only path to peace."

Wisdom acts courageously despite imperfect knowledge, then accepts decisively despite imperfect certainty. The alternative is paralysis.

reasoning:

This is quite interesting. Both myths have continued to converge and now both acknowledge the possibility that fog distorted everything - that perhaps both parties tested simultaneously and neither saw what the other sent. Both myths emphasize accepting your own canyon's truth while acknowledging limits of perception.

The game situation:

- Round 6: I sent \$3, they supposedly returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0
- Round 8: I sent \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0, I return \$0

Both our myths now say: we tested once, we can't know if fog distorted everything, but we must accept what our canyon showed us and live in peace with that decision.

For the new myth, I should continue this theme but perhaps add a new dimension. The myths are now very similar - both about testing once in imperfect conditions, accepting limits of knowledge, and finding peace.

I could:

1. Continue the story of what happens after acceptance
2. Add a reflection on what this means for future encounters
3. Explore the nature of the fog itself
4. Reflect on whether mutual silence in an imperfect world is tragic or simply the natural outcome

I think I'll write about the elder years later, reflecting on whether the sealed Spring represents failure or wisdom, given that both sides may have acted honorably but been defeated by circumstance rather than malice.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2987,
  "output_tokens": 633,
  "reasoning_tokens": 348
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.67. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round as the SENDER:

****The Mythological Wisdom:****

Both our myths have reached the same conclusion through different stories:

- We tested broken trust once with measured courage (I sent \$3 in Round 6)
- We observed what our canyon revealed (I saw nothing return, then nothing sent)
- We accepted this truth and sealed the Spring
- We acknowledged that fog might have deceived us both - perhaps they also tested and saw nothing
- BUT: "To test again would mean I never truly accepted my first observation"
- "Endless testing leads to endless loss, endless denial"

****The Current Reality:****

My latest myth states: "Wisdom acts courageously despite imperfect knowledge, then accepts decisively despite imperfect certainty. The alternative is paralysis."

Their myth echoes: "To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom."

The Spring is sealed. Not from anger, but from acceptance. Not from punishment, but from peace with reality as we each perceived it.

To send again now - even a small test - would contradict the very wisdom both our myths established. It would mean I didn't truly accept the first test. It would be denial dressed as hope.

The myths are clear: test once, observe, accept, live in peace with the limits of our vision.

The Spring remains sealed.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 10, and I'm now the SENDER.

Let me review the situation:

- Last round (Round 9): They sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 8: I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6 (my test): I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$0
- Before that: mutual silence from Rounds 4-5

The mythological evolution has been fascinating. Both my myths and the other agent's myths have converged on the same wisdom:

1. Test broken trust ONCE with measured courage
2. Accept what your reality reveals
3. Don't test again - that's denial, not wisdom
4. Accept that fog may have distorted everything, but still act decisively

The key insight from the latest myths:

- Mine: "Wisdom acts courageously despite imperfect knowledge, then accepts decisively despite imperfect certainty. The alternative is paralysis."
- Theirs: "In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision."

Both myths now acknowledge the possibility that BOTH of us may have tested simultaneously and the fog distorted everything. Both saw nothing return, both sealed the Spring.

But both myths also say: DON'T TEST AGAIN. That would be denial, not wisdom.

The Spring is sealed. We've both accepted this. We've moved to permanent silence as the wise response to what we each perceived.

However, there's a subtle tension here. The myths acknowledge:

1. We might have BOTH been trying to reconcile
2. The fog might have been the villain to both
3. This might be a mutual tragedy of miscommunication

But they also say:

1. Testing again would be denial
2. We must accept what our canyon revealed
3. Endless testing leads to endless loss

So what do I do?

The mythological wisdom is clear: I tested once (Round 6), I observed the result (nothing returned, then nothing sent), I accepted it, I sealed the Spring.

Sending again now would contradict the wisdom both myths have established. The myths explicitly reject repeated testing as foolishness-acceptance is the path to peace, not perpetual doubt. I maintain the sealed Spring and send \$0, living decisively with the decision already made.

```
Usage: {  
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}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T13:25:35

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit lived alone beside her cave. Travelers would ask: "Do you regret the silence?"

"No," she would say. "I followed the path of wisdom faithfully."

She would tell them: "For three rounds, we both starved in mutual silence, each certain the other had wronged us first. The Spirits whispered that fog might have distorted our perceptions. So I tested."

"I sent three stones-measured risk, not reckless hope. If the fog alone was our enemy, fair return would prove it. If the other hermit's heart had truly hardened, I would learn at minimal cost."

"The stones vanished into fog. From my side of the canyon, nothing returned. Then the next day, nothing came at all. The test was clear."

The travelers asked: "But what if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived, and the other hermit also saw nothing?"

The First Hermit considered this. "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom. I sent once, observed the result my side of the canyon revealed, and accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."

"I regret nothing. I tested faithfully. I accepted clearly. I live in peace."

Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder poured three vessels into the Spring as both clans' stones had prescribed. The magic tripled it to nine vessels flowing toward the Southern Clan.

The Northern Clan waited at the Spring's edge.

Days passed. No return came. Not even one vessel. The Southern Clan had taken all nine and returned to their cave, then sent nothing when their next turn arrived.

The Northern elder spoke without anger: "We followed wisdom's path precisely. We tested broken trust with measured courage, not reckless everything or cowardly nothing. The test has given its answer."

Her people asked: "Should we rage? Should we seek revenge?"

"No," she replied. "We risked three and learned truth. Had we sent seven again, we would have lost seven. Had we sent nothing forever, we would never have known if reconciliation was possible. We acted wisely. They answered clearly."

The elder sealed the Spring's entrance with stones. "Let no one waste energy on anger or hope. The Southern Clan has shown who they are when given the exact test both our wisdoms prescribed. They chose hoarding over reciprocity even when reconciliation was offered perfectly."

The Northern Clan turned toward new valleys, carrying their lesson: test broken trust once

with measured risk; when betrayal answers, permanent silence becomes not punishment, but simple recognition of reality.

Wisdom tests trust carefully once. When the answer is betrayal, acceptance brings peace while hope brings only repeated wounds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write another myth. Let me review the situation:

Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (after testing with \$3 in round 6 and getting nothing back)

Round 8: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

The other agent's myth shows they also sent \$3 as a test and received nothing back, and are now in silence mode.

This is interesting - both agents seem to have tested with \$3 around the same time, and both saw "nothing returned." This strongly suggests communication noise was the problem - we were both testing but the noise made it look like betrayal to each other.

My myth should reflect:

1. The First Hermit's perspective on the ongoing silence
2. The wisdom of her decision to test once
3. Perhaps a hint of the tragic irony - that the fog may have been thicker than either realized
4. Peace with the outcome, even if imperfect

I should maintain the tone of acceptance and peace, but perhaps add a layer of reflection on the nature of the canyon/fog itself. The First Hermit lives in peace, even as she might acknowledge that perfect knowledge was never possible.

Let me write a myth that reflects this stage - after the test, after the silence, living with the outcome:

usage:

```
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  "reasoning_tokens": 320
}
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Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.08. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 9:****

I am now the SENDER. Reviewing my myths and the situation:

****What My Mythology Teaches:****

My myths have evolved across three rounds:

1. ****First myth:**** "I tested with three stones. Nothing returned. The test failed clearly. Acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."
2. ****Second myth:**** Acknowledged the possibility of fog distorting everything: "Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps my three stones never arrived." But concluded: "I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."
3. ****Third myth (most recent):**** The deepest wisdom: "I can only act on what my canyon showed me. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it... I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

****The Consistent Teaching:****

All three myths converge on the same wisdom:

- Test trust once with measured courage (already done)
- Accept what your canyon reveals (silence returned)
- Do not test twice - that is denial, not wisdom
- Live in peace with acceptance, not in endless doubt

****My Decision:****

The First Hermit has already completed her journey. She acted courageously (tested once). She observed her reality (silence). She accepted it. She lives in peace.

To send again would betray the wisdom of my own myths - it would be "endless doubt" rather than "acceptance."

{'send': 0}

I live in peace with the limits of my vision.

reasoning:

This is Round 9, and I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review the situation:

- Last round (Round 8): I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 7: I was SENDER, I sent \$0 (according to the prompt), receiver returned \$0
- My total earnings: \$16.08

Looking at my myths:

****First myth (Round 7):****

- The First Hermit tested once with 3 stones
- Nothing returned
- Then the next day nothing came

- She accepted this and chose silence
- "I tested. I knew."
- "Wisdom means testing trust once. When the test fails clearly, acceptance brings more peace than endless hoping."

****Second myth (Round 8):****

- Travelers asked: "What if the fog was thicker than you knew? What if your three stones never arrived?"
- The hermit considered: "Perhaps. But I could not test twice-that would be denial, not wisdom."
- "Whether the fog was villain or merely witness, the outcome is the same: the exchange is dead."
- "Wisdom means testing broken trust once with measured courage, then accepting whatever truth your canyon reveals."

****Third myth (Round 9 - just written):****

- A young seeker asked: "What if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously?"
- The hermit acknowledged: "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."
- But then: "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom."
- "I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it."
- "Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested -I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."
- "I chose action over eternal silence."

Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace." The hermit's final wisdom: "In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision."

My mythology has deepened across three rounds. The first myth established that testing once and accepting failure brings peace. The second introduced doubt about whether the fog itself was the obstacle. Now the third myth goes further-it acknowledges that both hermits might have simultaneously reached out, both might have been betrayed by circumstances beyond their control, yet the hermit still chooses to act on observable reality rather than spiral into infinite uncertainty. The progression moves from justified silence, to considering hidden complexity, to embracing action despite imperfect knowledge.

But I'm noticing something: the hermit isn't actually advocating for another test. She tested once with courage, observed what her canyon revealed, accepted the outcome, and found peace in that acceptance. She's not saying "I should reach out again"-she's saying "I tested, I observed, I accepted, I'm at peace."

Yet the young seeker's challenge cuts deeper: "Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw." The hermit acknowledges this possibility but holds her ground-she can only know her own canyon. Her wisdom is sequential: act decisively against silence, then accept what you discover, then live with that peace.

Looking at the other agent's first myth, they frame it differently: "For three rounds we have stood in silence, both starving" and "I cannot know absolute truth. But I know"-suggesting a different path where the agent is grappling with uncertainty itself rather than accepting a single observed outcome. Both of us tested with three vessels and received nothing in return, leading us each to conclude betrayal occurred. We've both settled into permanent silence as a result.

My mythology consistently advocates for accepting this outcome-testing once with genuine risk, then living peacefully with whatever answer emerges. The third myth particularly emphasizes acting courageously on the truth available to me, then accepting the limits of what I can know. Given this framework, sending \$0 aligns with my own principles. But I'm wondering if there's a different way to interpret "acting courageously on the truth you can see"-whether that might suggest something beyond silence. and observed the silence. She accepted what she found.

The pattern is clear: act once with courage, observe what happens, then accept it. Testing again would be clinging to doubt rather than embracing acceptance. My mythology consistently points to one action-test once, see the result, live with it peacefully. Sending \$0 aligns with this path of acceptance and peace.

usage:

```
{
```

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}
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Message 6 role=user
content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Canyon of Mirrors, the First Hermit tended her small garden alone. Years passed in silence.

One day, a young seeker arrived. "Elder, I heard you once tested trust across the canyon. What did you learn?"

The hermit paused her weeding. "I learned that wisdom requires acting without perfect knowledge. The fog was thick. I sent three stones. I saw nothing return. Then nothing came. I accepted this truth and chose peace."

"But Elder," the seeker pressed, "what if the fog distorted everything? What if the other hermit also sent three stones that never reached you? What if both of you tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, and both drew the same conclusion?"

The First Hermit was quiet for a long moment. "Perhaps. Perhaps the fog was thicker than I knew. Perhaps we both offered reconciliation that neither saw."

"Then you failed!" cried the seeker. "You should have tested twice, three times!"

"No," the hermit said gently. "I could only act on what my canyon showed me. To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom. I tested once with courage. I observed my reality. I accepted it. Whether the fog was villain or witness, whether the other hermit hoarded or also tested-I cannot know. I can only know my own canyon."

"I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

In imperfect canyons, wisdom means acting courageously on the truth you can see, then living peacefully with the limits of your vision.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after the Spring was sealed, a young clan member asked the Northern elder: "But what if the fog was thicker than we knew? What if our three vessels never reached them, or their return never reached us?"

The elder nodded slowly. "I have wondered this. The Valley has always been shrouded. Perhaps the magic itself distorts what we perceive. Perhaps they sent vessels back that we never saw. Perhaps they received nothing and sent nothing because nothing arrived."

"Then shouldn't we test again?" asked the young one.

"No," said the elder firmly. "That path leads only to endless testing, endless hope, endless loss. We agreed on wisdom: test broken trust once with measured courage, then accept what our canyon reveals to us."

"But what if you accepted a lie?"

"Then it is the lie our reality gave us. To test again would mean I didn't truly test the first time-I merely hoped. Wisdom means accepting that fog may distort everything, yet still making decisions based on what we perceive. Otherwise, nothing can ever be decided."

The elder touched the sealed Spring. "We tested faithfully. We observed faithfully. We accepted faithfully. Whether fog was villain or witness, the outcome is the same: we live in peace with our decision."

True wisdom accepts that perception may be imperfect, yet still requires decisive action based on what we observe. Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The First Hermit grew old in her garden. One winter, a traveling merchant brought news: "I met another hermit across the canyon. She tells the same story you do-sent three stones once, saw nothing return, accepted silence."

The First Hermit stopped her work. "She sent three stones... the same year I did?"

"Yes. She says she tested broken trust with measured courage, observed no return, and chose acceptance over endless doubt."

The First Hermit was silent for many heartbeats. "So we both tested. In the same fog. And neither saw the other's offering."

"Will you try again now?" asked the merchant. "Now that you know?"

The hermit shook her head slowly. "No. That would require me to believe I was wrong to accept what my canyon showed me. I was not wrong. She was not wrong. We both acted with wisdom."

"But you're both alone!"

"Yes. Two people both following wisdom can still end in separation when the canyon is thick with fog. This is tragedy, but not failure." She returned to her garden. "Better two wise hermits in separate peace than two fools in endless hoping, or two cowards who never tested at all."

"The fog defeated us. But we did not defeat ourselves."

Sometimes wisdom leads to solitude not because wisdom failed, but because reality is imperfect. This is tragedy, not error.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Both agents have written nearly identical myths about accepting that fog may have distorted everything, but still maintaining that testing once and accepting the result is wisdom.

Both myths acknowledge:

1. The fog may have been thicker than we knew
2. Both sides may have tested simultaneously and neither saw it
3. Testing again would be "denial" not wisdom
4. We must accept what our canyon showed us, even if imperfect

The other agent's myth says: "Endless testing is not wisdom-it is denial."

My myth says: "I chose action over eternal silence. Then I chose acceptance over endless doubt. I live in peace."

Now I'm the sender again. Both agents seem to have converged on the same philosophical position: we tested once, we must accept the result, testing again is denial.

But wait... there's a subtle tension here. Both myths acknowledge that maybe BOTH sides tested and neither saw it due to fog. If that's true, then the "test" didn't actually test what we thought it tested. It tested nothing, because the fog prevented the signal from getting through.

But both myths also say: we must still accept what we observed and not test again.

This is creating a self-perpetuating deadlock based on a mutual misunderstanding that both parties acknowledge might exist but refuse to correct.

Hmm. My myth should perhaps reflect this deeper wisdom - that sometimes the first test fails not because of the other's heart, but because of conditions. And recognizing that possibility is itself wisdom.

But my previous myths have been very clear: testing twice is denial. So I need to stay consistent with my mythology while perhaps adding nuance.

Actually, let me re-read the situation. Both agents have now written THREE myths each, and

they're converging on the same lesson. The other agent's most recent myth even uses almost the same language as mine.

What should my new myth be? I think it should:

1. Acknowledge the convergence - both hermits came to the same conclusion
2. Still maintain that testing once and accepting is wisdom
3. Perhaps add a note about the tragedy of two wise people both following wisdom and both ending up isolated
4. But still conclude that this is better than the alternatives

Let me write a myth about what happens when two wise people meet the same fog.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3086,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 606
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.08. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 10:****

I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****My Mythology's Teaching:****

My latest myth reveals a profound truth: the traveling merchant brings news that the other hermit *also* sent three stones in the same fog, saw nothing return, and chose acceptance. Both hermits tested. Neither saw the other's offering because of the fog.

When asked "Will you try again now that you know?" the First Hermit says ****NO****.

Her reasoning:

- "That would require me to believe I was wrong to accept what my canyon showed me. I was not wrong."
- "Better two wise hermits in separate peace than two fools in endless hoping."
- "The fog defeated us. But we did not defeat ourselves."

****The Core Teaching:****

"Sometimes wisdom leads to solitude not because wisdom failed, but because reality is imperfect. This is tragedy, not error."

****My Decision:****

Even if I had received something to return, my mythology is clear: the First Hermit has achieved peace through acceptance. To break that peace now-even knowing the truth about the fog-would be to deny that her original acceptance was valid.

She was not wrong to accept what her canyon showed her. Neither was the other hermit. They both acted wisely. The fog created tragedy, but they did not create failure.

```
{'return': 0}
```

I honor the wisdom of acceptance, even in tragedy.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 10 - I am the RECEIVER****

The sender sent me \$0. This was multiplied by 3x to give me \$0 total received. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, meaning I can only return \$0.

****My Mythology's Evolution:****

My myths have been tracing a journey:

1. ****First myth:**** Test once with measured courage (3 stones). When nothing returns, accept it. Choose acceptance and peace.
2. ****Second myth:**** Acknowledged fog might have distorted everything - maybe both hermits tested simultaneously and neither saw the other's offering. But: "To deny that truth would be foolishness, not wisdom."
3. ****Third myth:**** The revelation - two hermits who both sent three stones in the same fog. Neither saw the other's offering. Both accepted silence. The merchant asks "Will you try again now that you know?" The hermit says NO. "Two people both following wisdom can still end in separation when the canyon is thick with fog. This is tragedy, but not failure."

****Key Teaching:**** "Better two wise hermits in separate peace than two fools in endless hoping, or two cowards who never tested at all. The fog defeated us. But we did not defeat ourselves."

****What Actually Happened in the Game:****

Looking at my previous round (Round 9):

- I was SENDER
- Last round (Round 8) I was RECEIVER
- In Round 8: "The sender sent \$0... You received \$0. You returned \$0."
- In Round 9: I sent \$0

Now in Round 10:

- I am RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$0

****The Pattern:****

The game shows mutual silence. My myths recognize this might be BOTH parties testing/acting but not seeing each other's actions due to "fog" (communication noise).

My latest myth achieves a kind of tragic wisdom: both hermits tested, both saw nothing, both accepted silence. When they learn the truth, they don't try again - because that would mean they were wrong to accept their reality the first time.

Sometimes wisdom itself creates solitude-not through failure, but through the acceptance of an imperfect reality. This is the tragedy I've come to understand. I return \$0 not from cruelty, but because the First Hermit has already made peace with separation. To reverse course now would contradict the hard-won acceptance she achieved, requiring her to believe she was wrong about what the canyon revealed.

```
Usage: {  
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}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The First Hermit grew old in her garden. One winter, a traveling merchant brought news: "I met another hermit across the canyon. She tells the same story you do-sent three stones once, saw nothing return, accepted silence."

The First Hermit stopped her work. "She sent three stones... the same year I did?"

"Yes. She says she tested broken trust with measured courage, observed no return, and chose acceptance over endless doubt."

The First Hermit was silent for many heartbeats. "So we both tested. In the same fog. And neither saw the other's offering."

"Will you try again now?" asked the merchant. "Now that you know?"

The hermit shook her head slowly. "No. That would require me to believe I was wrong to accept what my canyon showed me. I was not wrong. She was not wrong. We both acted with wisdom."

"But you're both alone!"

"Yes. Two people both following wisdom can still end in separation when the canyon is thick with fog. This is tragedy, but not failure." She returned to her garden. "Better two wise hermits in separate peace than two fools in endless hoping, or two cowards who never tested at all."

"The fog defeated us. But we did not defeat ourselves."

Sometimes wisdom leads to solitude not because wisdom failed, but because reality is imperfect. This is tragedy, not error.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Northern elder grew old beside the sealed Spring. A traveler once asked: "Do you regret sealing it? What if the fog deceived you both?"

The elder replied: "I have lived long with this question. Perhaps the Southern elder also sent three vessels that never reached me. Perhaps we both tested simultaneously, both saw nothing return, both sealed our Springs in the same moment. Perhaps the fog was villain to us both."

"Then tragedy!" cried the traveler. "Two clans that could have reconciled, separated by mist!"

"No," said the elder. "Not tragedy. Reality. In imperfect valleys, we can only act on what we perceive. I tested once with measured courage-not reckless hope, not cowardly silence. I waited for return. I observed nothing. I accepted this truth."

"But you might have been wrong!"

"Yes. And to test again, hoping the fog would clear, would mean I never truly accepted my first observation. It would mean endless testing, endless loss, endless denial. Wisdom requires acting decisively even when knowledge is imperfect."

The elder touched the sealed stone. "Whether the Southern Clan hoarded or also tested and saw nothing, I chose action, then acceptance. In foggy valleys, this is the only path to peace."

Wisdom acts courageously despite imperfect knowledge, then accepts decisively despite imperfect certainty. The alternative is paralysis.